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Description of document: National Security Agency (NSA) SIGINT Reporter's Style and Usage Manual, 2010

Requested date: 30-April-2010

Released date: 15-April-2011

Posted date: 13-June-2011

Source of document: National Security Agency
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NATIONAL SECURITY AGENCY
CENTRAL SECURITY SERVICE
FORT GEORGE G. MEADE MARYLAND 20755 8000

FOIA Case: 61649A
15 April 2011

This responds to your Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request of 30 April 2010 for the "SIGINT Reporter's Style and Usage Manual." A copy of your request is enclosed. Your request has been processed under the FOIA and the document you requested is enclosed. Certain information, however, has been deleted from the enclosure.

Some of the information deleted from the document was found to be currently and properly classified in accordance with Executive Order 13526. This information meets the criteria for classification as set forth in Subparagraph (c) of Section 1.4 and remains classified SECRET as provided in Section 1.2 of the Executive Order. The information is classified because its disclosure could reasonably be expected to cause serious damage to the national security. Because the information is currently and properly classified, it is exempt from disclosure pursuant to the first exemption of the FOIA (5 U.S.C. Section 552(b)(1)).

In addition, this Agency is authorized by various statutes to protect certain information concerning its activities. We have determined that such information exists in this document. Accordingly, those portions are exempt from disclosure pursuant to the third exemption of the FOIA which provides for the withholding of information specifically protected from disclosure by statute. The specific statutes applicable in this case are Title 18 U.S. Code 798; Title 50 U.S. Code 403-1(i); and Section 6, Public Law 86-36 (50 U.S. Code 402 note).

The Initial Denial Authority for NSA information is the Deputy Associate Director for Policy and Records, Diane M. Janosek. Since these deletions may be construed as a partial denial of your request, you are hereby advised of this Agency's appeal procedures. Any person denied access to information may file an appeal to the NSA/CSS Freedom of Information Act Appeal Authority. The appeal must be postmarked no later than 60 calendar days from the date of the

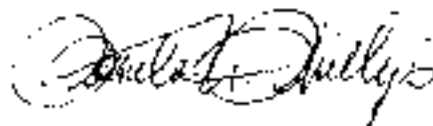
initial denial letter. The appeal shall be in writing addressed to the NSA/CSS FOIA Appeal Authority (DJP4), National Security Agency, 9800 Savage Road STE 6248, Fort George G. Meade, MD 20755-6248. The appeal shall reference the initial denial of access and shall contain, in sufficient detail and particularity, the grounds upon which the requester believes release of the information is required. The NSA/CSS Appeal Authority will endeavor to respond to the appeal within 20 working days after receipt, absent any unusual circumstances.

Costs assessable to you total \$26.25. This fee represents the cost of duplication of 275 pages (with no cost for the first 100 pages). Costs are computed in accordance with DoD Regulation 5400.7-R, which assesses \$44.00 per hour for search and review and \$.15 per page for duplication.

Please remit to the FOIA office (see below for address) a check or money order made payable to the Treasurer of the United States in the amount of \$26.25. Please include the number assigned to your case on any correspondence to assure that your account is properly credited. If we do not receive payment within 30 days of the date of this letter, we will close any other cases you have pending with this agency. We will not process any future FOIA requests you submit until past-due fees have been paid. Payment of fees for your request should be sent to National Security Agency, FOIA Office (DJP4), 9800 Savage Road STE 6248, Ft. George G. Meade, MD 20755-6348.

Should you have any questions, the telephone number of the FOIA office is 301-688-6527.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Pamela N. Phillips".

PAMELA N. PHILLIPS
Chief
FOIA/PA Office

Encls:
a/s



Friday, May 7, 2010

The Reporting Page
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UNM 1.1

"go reporting"

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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

Version 1.1
10/1/2009

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A

a, an...

(U) Use "a" before consonant sounds, including the aspirated "h": a historic moment, a 1-year term, a united stand, a KGB agent.

(U) Use "an" before vowel sounds or a silent "h": an energy crisis, an honorable man, an 800-pound gorilla, an NSA regulation.

abbreviations...

(U) See Appendix 1 for a complete discussion of abbreviations and acronyms.

abeam...

(U) Means "at right angles to an axis or path."

aboard...

(U) A single word, often referring to a vehicle that carries passengers, such as a train.

(U) See the entry for on board.

10/1/2009 10:10:10

Approved for Release by NSA on
03-24-2011, FCIA Case # 51F49

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abound...

(U) Usually followed by "in" or "with."

about, approximately...

(U) About is preferred in general and informal contexts. Approximately is common in technical and reference works.

(U) Do not use either term (or estimated or nearly) if precise figures are given. POOR: During the attack, about 304 were killed. GOOD: During the attack, 304 were killed.

(U) If you are not sure of the number, round it off. During the attack, about 300 were killed.

absolute adjectives...

(U) According to purists, a few adjectives have no comparative or superlative modifiers. These include eternal, fatal, incessant, maximum, minimum, optimum, complete, perfect, and unique.

(U) In fact, most adjectives cannot be compared because their meaning is too technical or specific, or they name a quality that cannot exist in degrees. Examples are diocesan, antinomian, aquatic, graven, and electromagnetic.

(U) Adjectives expressing qualities are never compared when used in their strict sense. When used in a modified or figurative sense, however, they have been and can be compared.

(U) Actually, respectable writers have used qualifiers through the centuries for many of the so-called absolutes. The U.S. Constitution, for example, includes the phrase "to form a more perfect union." Here "more" is used to mean "more nearly."

(U) Therefore, if you are using these adjectives in a figurative or modified sense, go ahead and modify. Sandy has a more complete understanding of Hegelian philosophy than anyone else I know. If you are using them in a literal sense, do not modify. There are no perfect humans.

(U) See the entry for unique.

absolute phrases...

(U) An absolute phrase—often used to provide details—is one that is independent of the main clause of a sentence. EXAMPLE

and the rest of the

5/7/2010

Their ship having sailed, we went home.

(U) The absolute phrase generally contains either a present or past participle. The subject of the absolute phrase and the subject of the sentence are always different. The absolute phrase sometimes consists of a prepositional phrase without the preposition: He ran to her, [with] a bouquet of flowers in his hand, and asked her to marry him.

(U) Be careful to distinguish between the absolute phrase, which is standard English, and the dangling modifier, which is not acceptable.

(U) See the entry for dangling modifier.

abstract noun...

(U) Abstract nouns refer to actions, concepts, events, qualities, or states. Examples include hour, love, and joke.

(U) See the entry for concrete nouns.

accent marks...

(U) Since most of our word-processing systems cannot make accent marks, type the word without the mark (S, ~~ACCENT~~, emigre, ~~ATTACHE~~).

accept...

(U) Accept means "receive with consent" or "approve of": He **accepted** the nomination. He could not **accept** the situation. It should never be confused with the verb "except".

acronyms...

(J) See Appendix 1 for a complete discussion of abbreviations and acronyms.

acl.action...

{U} An act is the deed accomplished by an action. Example: John Hinkley committed an ~~act~~ of murder by the ~~action~~ of shooting singer John Lennon.

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acting president...

(U) Capitalize both words when used as part of the title of a national-level figure: Acting President John Doe. Use lowercase letters in all other instances: Jane Doe, the acting president of the Garden Club, left for Brazil today.

active voice...

(U) While the active voice tends to be shorter and more direct, there are good reasons to use the passive voice. Do not use a hard-and-fast rule ("Avoid the passive voice") but consider each case carefully before deciding which to use.

(U) See the entry for passive voice.

activity...

(U) Do not use phrases such as exercise activity or weather activity. Say exercise or weather.

(U) See the entries for condition and situation.

adjectives...

(U) Use adjectives sparingly in SIGINT reporting. Avoid phrases like "audible sounds" and "radical terrorists" that add nothing to the reader's comprehension. Use adjectives only when they add something significant to the meaning of the statement.

- Adjectives that precede the nouns they modify are attributive adjectives.
- Adjectives that follow the verb *be* or a linking verb are predicate adjectives.
- Appositive adjectives may precede or follow the noun.

(U) See the entries for appositive and attributive; see the comma entry for guidance on punctuating a series of adjectives.

advance, advancement...

(U) Advance, as a noun, carries the sense of forward movement.

(U) Advancement implies the existence and action of an agent or outside force.

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adverbs...

(U) Adverbs can modify verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs. An adverb may appear before or after the word it modifies, sometimes with several intervening words: He ran quickly. She suddenly changed course. I wanted to present the gift formally.

(U) Sometimes an adverb is placed between the auxiliary and main verbs: Theresa had barely avoided crashing into the wall.

(U) To avoid an awkward split, make sure that the adverb adds something useful to the sentence. If not, take it out: Bill was [nearly] working hard at the job. Avoid awkward splits, but do not avoid splits at all costs. If a sentence reads better or is clearer with the verb split, then split the verb.

(U) See the entries for flag, adverbs, -ly adverbs and split infinitives.

adverse...

(U) *Adverse* means "unfavorable" and most often applies to non-human conditions: adverse circumstances, adverse weather. It is usually an attributive adjective.

(U) See the entry for *averse*.

advice, advise...

(U) *Advice* is a noun; *advise* is a verb.

adviser, advisor...

(U) Both are correct. For standardization, use the general term *adviser* rather than the legal term *advisor*.

affect...

(U) Use *affect* only as a verb. It usually means "influence": Her speech affected the election. It also can mean "put on": He affected a dignified manner.

(U) Also see the entry for *effect*.

age...

(a)(3)-P L 85 35

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(U) Since age is a measurement of time, use numerals. Include hyphens when expressing age as an adjective before a noun (a 5-year-old boy) or as a substitute for a noun (the race is for 5-year olds).

(U) When used as an adjective, but not before a noun, omit the hyphens: The girl is 5 years old.

(U) To express age ranges, add an "s". The suspect is in his 30s.

agree...

(U) With a person, to a proposal, on a plan

aid, aide...

(U) Aid is assistance, an aide is a person who gives assistance to another

air base...

(U) Two words. (Compare to military base and naval base).

aircraft...

(U) Do not abbreviate the generic types of aircraft in serialized reports. Use fighter, not "fir"; bomber, not "bmbr".

(U) In keeping with modern journalistic style, capitalize only the first letter of aircraft nicknames. F-15 (Eagle).

(b)(1);
(b)(3), P L 86-36

aircraft designator...

(S) Always use the true designator (and when it is known the specific version, e.g., F-15C) in the title and lead of a serialized report. In a short report, use only the true designator.

(S) In a report of four or more paragraphs, use the true designator in the lead. In the body, include the true designator and, if one exists, the ASCC nickname, e.g., F-15C (Crested) on first reference. Afterwards use either the designator or the nickname, but be consistent.

(U) Using the popular name for Western aircraft (e.g., F-15 Eagle, F-1 Mirage) is optional

(b)(3), P L 86-36

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(U) Add an "s" to form the plural (MIG-21s, IL-82s, F-15s).

air-launched cruise missile...

(U) Abbreviate as ALCM. Avoid the redundant ALCM missile.

airline...

(U) A single word when referring to a transportation company, e.g., Alaska Airlines.

airport...

(U) One word; capitalize it when it is part of a proper name: Berlin Airport

air-to-air missile...

(U) Abbreviate as AAM. Do not use the word "missile" after the abbreviation

air-to-surface missile...

(U) Abbreviate as ASM. Avoid the redundant ASM missile.

airway...

(U) One word. Defined in JCS Pub 1-02 as "A control area or portion thereof established in the form of a corridor marked with radio navigational aids" and in Jane's Aerospace Dictionary as "An air route provided with ground organization."

ALFA...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "a"

alias, a.k.a....

Use periods and lower-case letters (a.k.a., not AKA)

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allege, alleged, alleging...

(U) No "d" before the "g", use these forms to describe what has not been proven to be the case, e.g., **alleged** murderer (who is a **real**, not **alleged**, suspect)

(U) If a murder is known to have occurred, it is a **real** murder, not an **alleged** murder.

all of...

(U) **All** of is usual before personal pronouns: **all** of them. Either **all** or **all of** may be used before nouns.

all ready...

(U) In the two-word form it means "prepared". The units are **all ready** to deploy. The **all** often can be ~~deleted~~

(U) Also see the entry for **already**.

all right...

(U) In serialized reports, use the two-word form. Everything is **all right**.

all together...

(U) Use the two-word form to indicate that the members of a group performed or underwent an action collectively.

(U) The two-word form is correct whenever the sentence can be rephrased and still make sense. The prisoners were confined **all together** could be stated as **All** the prisoners were confined **together**.

(U) Also see the entry for **altogether**.

allude, allusion...

(U) Usually means "refer to something indirectly," but also has the meaning "mention in passing." It is not synonymous with "refer" because an **allusion** is an **indirect** mention whereas a **reference** is a **direct** one.

(U) Also see the entries for **elude** and **illusion**.

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5/3/2010

ally..

(U) When ally is used with to, it is usually followed by a verb in the past tense or a past participle.

(U) When ally is used with with, a greater variety of tenses appears

a lot...

(U) Do not use in serialized reports.

already...

(U) As a single word, it means "previously." She had already left.

(U) See the entry for all ready.

alternate, alternately...

(U) The idea here is that things occur in successive turns: My wife and I alternate picking up the mail, i.e., she goes one day and I go the next.

(U) Be cautious in using alternate as an adjective: it may confuse the reader. In a phrase such as the alternate plan, the reader may assume you are using a series of plans, one after the other. If you mean one choice from a set, use alternative.

(U) Also see the entry for alternative.

alternative, alternatively...

(U) The central idea behind the use of alternative is that of a choice of one among a set of possibilities.

(U) Traditionalists argue that no more than two alternatives can exist, but in actual usage writers have been referring to three or more alternatives for well over a century without confusing readers.

(U) See the entry for alternate.

altitude ..

(U) (3) P.L. 88-36

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(U) Express altitudes in meters. 500 meters. Write out the word for meters before using the abbreviation, which is a lowercase "m." 500 m.

altogether...

(U) **Altogether** is a single word meaning "wholly, entirely, thoroughly": That law is **altogether** unnecessary.

(U) Also see the entry for **all together**.

always...

(U) **Always** means "on every occasion" or "forever." Do not use **always** when you mean "usually" or "habitually."

ambassador...

(U) Capitalize when referring to a specific ambassador: Ambassador John Doe; the Zengdian Ambassador. Do not capitalize when used alone: The ambassador arrived yesterday.

ambiguity ..

(U) **Ambiguity** is the actual or potential uncertainty of meaning that occurs when a word, phrase, or sentence can be understood in more than one way.

(U) in serialized reports, be as clear as possible in using words and phrases

amid...

(U) Do not use **amidst**. **Amid** stresses being surrounded: a house **amid** the trees.

(U) If you are referring to a location **separating** specific objects, use **between**: between the skyscrapers.

(U) See the entries for **among** and **between**.

amok...

(U) Malay word; avoid it (and its variant form **amuck**).

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among...

(U) Among refers to being surrounded, or approximately so, by persons or objects that are individual and separable. It is usually followed by a plural or collective noun: living among the poor; living among the Bedouins.

(U) Among ~~always~~ refers to three or more. Pronouns following among are in the accusative case. There were several spies among them.

(U) Also see the entries for amid and between.

amount of...

(U) Amount of is followed by singular mass nouns or by plural count nouns representing an aggregate. Amount usually takes a singular verb: The amount of money on hand was less than \$100.

(U) Also see the entries for collective nouns and number of.

amplitude modulation...

(U) Abbreviate as AM (capital letters and no periods)

and...

(U) Although there is nothing wrong grammatically with using and at the beginning of a sentence, do not do so in serialized reports.

(U) Do not use a comma before and in a complex sentence unless it serves to connect independent clauses. WRONG: He walked during the early morning hours, and wrote during the afternoon. RIGHT: He walked during the morning hours and wrote during the afternoon. She did her research in the morning, and she did her interviews in the afternoon.

NOTE: (U) Some consider the comma optional when joining short independent clauses: He ran and I walked

(U) Also see the entry for but and the box for comma.

and/or...

(U) 13- P L 86-36

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(U) A term used since 1853 in legal and commercial documents. Avoid it in SIGINT. Instead of "the ambassador and/or the charge d'affaires," say "the ambassador, the charge d'affaires, or both."

(U) See the entry for *slant slash*, *virgule*.

Anglo...

(U) Always capitalized. Use a hyphen when the word that follows is also capitalized. Anglo-Saxon

annual...

(U) This means "yearly" or "once a year." Since an event cannot be described as annual until it has been held in at least 2 successive years, avoid the term *first annual*.

another...

(U) Some commentators argue that *another* refers to an additional element that in some way duplicates a previously stated quantity: *Eight women passed, and another eight failed.* They claim that it is incorrect to say *Eight women passed, and another six failed* since "six" does not duplicate "eight."

(U) In fact, most people will understand very clearly what you say, regardless of the numbers involved, since *another* refers to the noun in the phrase, not the number.

ante...

(U) Prefix meaning "before"; usually not followed by a hyphen. Do not confuse it with the prefix *anti*.

antecedent...

(U) The word or word group a pronoun refers to: *Smith stopped at the base before returning to his home.* (Smith is the antecedent for "his".) Bear in mind that a pronoun has an affinity for the nearest noun.

(U) To avoid confusion, make sure the antecedent is clear. In the following example, the antecedent is not clear: *Smith conferred with Jones every day when he was in Berlin.* (Who was in Berlin?)

(U) Also see the entry for *nominal agreement*

(U)(3)-P L 88-36

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antenna...

(U) An antenna field has antennas. Insects have antennae.

anti...

(U) Prefix meaning "against." Use a hyphen only to avoid doubling the "i" or to precede proper nouns: anti-inflation, anti-Semitic; but antiaircraft **artillery**.

anticipate...

(U) Anticipate means "expect and prepare for something" or "look forward to." General Joral anticipated the enemy's flanking movement by shifting his forces to the west. She is anticipating a visit with her son.

(U) See the entry for expect.

anxious...

(U) One of the major shibboleths in American usage is the alleged difference between anxious and eager. Purists contend that anxious suggests strong interest or desire, but only in a negative or unpleasant sense. For maximum clarity, they say, use anxious about something you would rather avoid: Lew is anxious about going to the dentist. The purists' claim, however, is not valid.

(U) The objection to anxious in the sense of "eager or desirous" appeared in the U.S. in the early 20th century. This sense was identified as an error in spite of its use by authors such as Byron, Melville, Carroll, Dickens, Thoreau, Kipling, and Henry Adams. Anxious in the sense of "eager" has been traced back to at least the early 18th century.

(U) As Merriam-Webster notes, "Anyone who says that careful writers do not use anxious in its 'eager' sense has simply not examined the available evidence."

(U) See the entry for eager.

any...

(U) Any as a pronoun may be singular or plural. According to Merriam-Webster, the forms are used equally.

(U) As an adjective, any with a singular noun may be referred to by a plural pronoun: Any employee **can** ask about their status.

This is an example of notional agreement.

(U) See the entries for notional agreement and for they, their, them

any and its compounds...

(U) Anyhow, anything, and anywhere are always single words: Anything you say may be used against you.

(U) Any rate is always two words: at any rate

(U) Also see the individual entries for anybody, anyone, any other, and anyway.

anybody...

(U) Use as one word when referring to people: Anybody can help. Anybody takes a singular verb and is referred to by a singular pronoun.

(U) Use two words when referring to inanimate objects: Any body of water can be polluted.

anyone...

(U) Anyone takes a singular verb and is referred to by a singular pronoun.

(U) Use anyone as one word as an indefinite reference: Anyone may attend the concert.

(U) Use two words when the emphasis is on singling out one member of a group: Any one of them may be guilty.

any other...

(U) Use any other when comparing things of the same class: This book is better than any other on Russian history.

(U) Use any by itself when referring to things of different classes: I enjoy a symphony more than any play.

anyway...

(U) A single word when an adverb: He left anyway. When used as a noun, it is two words: Finish any way you can.

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NOTE: (U) Use the two-word form if you can substitute the phrase "whatever way" for any way apostrophe...

(U) Use an apostrophe to form the possessive of most nouns: the boy's hat, the boss's pen. See the entry for possessives.

(U) Use the apostrophe to form contractions: she'll, don't. See the entry for contractions.

(U) Use the apostrophe in certain constructions to show the subject of the gerund. There was little hope of the Party's accepting the compromise.

(U) See the entry for gerund.

appendix...

(U) For the sake of standardization, use the plural form *appendices* in a serialized report. The alternate form *appendices* is equally common in general use.

appositives...

(U) Appositives are nouns or pronouns placed near other nouns or pronouns to identify, explain, or supplement the meaning. John Doe, Minister of Trade.

(U) Set off non-essential appositives within a sentence with a pair of commas: Jane Doe, the Minister of Foreign Affairs, arrived in Metropolis today. Omit the commas if the appositive is essential: Voyager photographed the planet Saturn.

(U) If a non-essential appositive disrupts clear writing because it results in a confusing series of commas, it is better to rephrase it as an essential appositive. In a list of ministers, for example, change John Doe, Minister of Trade, Jane Roe, Minister of Finance, Jim Zoo, Minister of Culture, etc., to Trade Minister John Doe, Finance Minister Jane Roe, Culture Minister Jim Zoo, etc.

(U) The names of countries serve as appositives when they follow a city name and should be set off with a pair of commas when they fall within a sentence. Paris, France, is my favorite city.

(U) An appositive pronoun agrees in case with its antecedent.

(U) Also see the entries for non-restrictive elements and restrictive elements.

(b)(3)-P.L. 06-05

5/7/2010

appraise...

(U) The verb **appraise** means "evaluate." Do not confuse it with **appraise**.

appreciate...

(U) Means "recognize the value of": I **appreciate** your help. Do not use it to mean "understand." POOR: I **appreciate** your position. IMPROVED: I understand your position.

(U) In a commercial context **appreciate** means "increase in value": My house's value **appreciated** eight percent last year.

apprise...

(U) A fancy way to say "inform, advise, tell, or give notice." Use it sparingly and do not confuse it with **apprize**, which means "value" or "appreciate."

(U) See the entry for **omate** words.

approximately...

(U) Generally used in technical or reference works rather than general writing.

(U) See the entry for **about**. (b)(1) (b)(3)-P.L. 85-36

arbitrary unit designator...

(b)(3)-P.L. 85-36

(U) (b)(3)-P.L. 85-36

(U) The abbreviation is AUD.

(U) Do not use an AUD as a noun, however, when describing an activity or event. After identifying the "Independent Missile Air Regiment (NN321)," refer to it as the **regiment** or the **Independent Missile Air Regiment**, never as "NN321."

area, in the area of...

(U) Avoid **in the area of** when you mean "concerning" or "regarding." POOR: There are several new laws **in the area of** banking.

(b)(3)-P.L. 85-36

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~~APPROVED~~: There are several new laws concerning banking
around...

(U) Less commonly used than either about or approximately, but not wrong. In serialized reports, however, stick to about.

(U) See the entries for about and approximately.

as...

(U) As is a conjunction used to introduce a clause. When introducing a causal relation, as is preceded by a comma: Rick won't be coming, as we didn't invite him.

(U) Omit the comma when showing a time relation: Rick was preparing dinner as Leslie drove home from work.

(U) See the entry for like.

as a result of...

(U) Instead, use because.

as . . . as...

(U) In positive comparisons, as is followed by a second as: She is as clever as her adversary. A pronoun used in this construction should be in the same case as the compared person or item: Alice is as bright as she. It surprised Laverne as much as me.

(U) In a comparison involving the combination as . . . as and than, be sure to keep the second as: Tony is as charming as, or more charming than, his brother.

(U) The first as may be replaced by so in negative contexts, in questions, and in clauses introduced by "if": If he is so poor as that, why don't you help him?

(U) Also see the entry for as early as.

ASCC designators...

U//FOUO

5/7/2010

(U//FOUO) Applied to aircraft and missiles designed in the USSR and China. Each begins with a particular letter according to the following pattern:

- air-to-air missiles - A: Aphid (AA-8)
- air-to-surface missiles - K: Kingfish (AS-8)
- bombers - B: Badger (TU-16)
- fighters - F: Flogger (MiG-23)
- surface-to-air missiles - G: Grenier (SA-14)

(U) In keeping with modern journalistic style, capitalize only the first letter of an ASDC designator. Example: Flogger.

(U) See the entries for aircraft designator and weapon systems.

as early as...

(U) Considered wordy in some contexts. Delivery began as early as July 1987. Instead say: Delivery began in July 1987.

as if...

(U) Often followed by a verb in the subjunctive mood: as if he were cold.

(U) See the entry for as though.

ask.

(U) Both infinitives and clauses follow forms of the verb ask: Diane asked to use the phone. Alice asked that I leave her.

(U) See the entry for request.

as of...

(U) An established American idiom normally found in financial reports. Alternatives before a date include on, after, in, or since.

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rather than as of. Objections to as of have been chiefly British

asset...

(U) Generally used in a financial sense or to describe a personal quality: The house was their only asset. A sense of humor is a great asset.

(U) The term assets, when referring to military units or equipment, is specialized usage at this time. Use it only in contexts that are clear

assure...

(U) Assure applies to persons and has the sense of setting a person's mind at rest: He assured the leader of his loyalty

(U) Also see the entries for ensue and insure.

as though...

(U) Often followed by a verb in the subjunctive mood: as though I were not there.

(U) See the entry for as if.

as to whether...

(U) Whether is sufficient, but as to whether, although certainly less common, is not wrong. It is merely a question of personal taste or style.

(U) In serialized reports, use whether by itself.

as well as...

(U) Acceptable as a comparative: Dan did as well as Carol

(U) In the sense of "in addition to," it does not have the conjunctive force of "and." Consequently, singular subjects remain singular: The challenger, as well as the incumbent, has pledged to increase funding for the school system

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NOTE: (U) In sentences where the emphasis is on the subject rather than on both elements, as in the example above, use a pair of commas to set off the as well as construction. Otherwise omit the commas.

as yet...

(U) Now or yet is a better choice.

at the present time, at this point in time...

(U) Use now. See point in time.

attribution...

(U) See the complete entry for attributions. Also see intelligence source identifier, target signals information, and SIGINT product information.

attributive...

(U) An adjective that describes a modifier directly in front of the word it modifies. Nouns, adjectives, and adverbs can function as attributives.

(U) Examples of attributives include loan shark, chemistry book, gold watch, white shirt, early arrival, and sad fate.

AUD...

(U) See the entry for arbitrary unit designator.

authority...

(U) In situations not otherwise covered in USSID CR1400, its annexes, or this document, the authority for usage in SIGINT serialized reports is Webster's Dictionary of English Usage, published by Merriam-Webster in 1989.

(U) If none of these sources provide the answer to your question, consult the GPO Style Manual. If that does not answer the question, consult a good college handbook, such as the Harbrace College Handbook.

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authoritarian...

(U) Avoid it, as its applicability and accuracy depend on the political philosophy of the writer and reader. They may not agree on what is an authoritarian state.

(U) See the entry for totalitarian.

average...

(U) In mathematics, the result of dividing the sum of a series of quantities by the number of quantities.

(U) Average means customary, usual, or ordinary when used in contexts outside mathematics; the average worker.

(U) See the entries for mean, median, and mode.

averse...

(U) Averse means "reluctant" or "opposed," often with a sense of distaste or repugnance: He is averse to change. She was averse to his entreaties. It is used only rarely as an attributive adjective.

(U) See the entry for adverse.

awhile, a while...

(U) For many commentators, awhile is a single word when used as an adverb: We rested awhile. After a preposition, they say, use the article "a" and the noun "while": The changes will not take effect for a while. I'll be back in a while. Follow this distinction in serialized reports.

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Last Modified: February 23, 2011
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2011

Classified in: NSAS/SS Manual: 1.5, dated 8 January 2001, Declassify On: OJ201126

Declassify On: OJ201126

Doc ID: 3541218
Doc Title: Reporting Page

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(U) When introducing an adverbial phrase expressing the reason for the action denoted by a non-linking verb, purists use only **because of**: He hesitated **because of** fear.

(U) See the entries for **due to** and **owing to** for another view of this issue.

behalf...

(U) Usage writers through the years have said that **in your behalf** (or **in behalf of**) means "in your interest" or "for your benefit"; **on your behalf** (or **on behalf of**) means "as your agent" or "representing you."

(U) Writers since William Shakespeare, however, have used them interchangeably without confusion. So can you.

believe...

(U) Don't use **believe** in reporting unless attribution can be included: We rarely know what our target "believes." Never say "We believe . . ." in an analyst comment.

beside, besides ..

(U) Each of these words can express opposite meanings when they are used as prepositions. Only **besides** is an adverb.

(U) **Beside** can mean either "next to" or "apart from": Lois sat **beside** Benjamin. His remarks were **beside** the point.

(U) **Besides** means either "in addition to" or "except for": Norm had few friends **besides** us. Something **besides** smog was the cause. (Smog was one of two or more causes. If smog is not a cause, say "Something other than smog was the cause.")

better than...

(U) Use **better than** to compare things in terms of quality: Her novel is **better than** his.

(U) Use **more than** when expressing things in terms of quantity: The lake is **more than** 2 miles across. (Better than in the sense of "more than" is a speech idiom only.)

(U) See the entry for **superlative of two**.

between...

See also: **in between**

(U) A preposition used to introduce two items (between the devil and the deep blue sea), to indicate the area bounded by several points (the area between Boston, Manchester, and Portland), or to express the relationships of several items considered one pair at a time (negotiations between the Party and Solidarity and the Church).

(U) Always pair the word between with the word "and" in ranges and relationships: between 8 and 12 September; between the house and the barn.

(U) Between is a preposition and following pronouns must be in the accusative case: between you and me, not a crime between them

between each, between every...

(U) Between each or between every, followed by a singular noun, is a standard English idiom dating back to Shakespeare. When you use a phrase such as between each (or every) skyscraper, what you really are saying is between each (or every) skyscraper and the next one. This is a form of elision, which is quite acceptable in English.

biannual...

(U) Means twice a year or semiannual. For clarity's sake, say "twice a year."

biennial...

(U) To avoid confusion, say instead "every 2 years."

billion ..

(U) Use figures with billion or million in all except casual uses: a billion dollars; His net worth is \$1.7 billion.

(U) See entries at trillion and trillion.

bimonthly...

(U) To avoid confusion, say instead "every 2 months" or "every other month."

biweekly...

(U) A. P. L. 16-36

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(U) To avoid confusion, say instead "every 2 weeks" or "every other week."

blatant...

(U) While blatant may mean merely "conspicuous," it is also used for behavior that attracts disapproving attention: a blatant lie, a blatant error.

(U) See the entry for flagrant

bloc...

(U) A political alliance of people, groups, or nations: Communist Bloc, Slavic Bloc.

boat...

(U) In nautical contexts in SIGINT reports, do not call a ship a boat. As a general guideline, a boat will go on a ship, but not vice versa. Lifeboats go on cruise ships. Submarines are boats.

(U) Most of the literate public, however, uses the term boat to refer to any floating contrivance of any size. Such use is standard in general contexts, but not appropriate in SIGINT reports.

(U) See the entries for ship and vessel.

bomb...

(U) Do not use the terms A-bomb or H-bomb. Spell out the words. Do not capitalize atomic bomb, hydrogen bomb, etc.

port...

(U) The side number on an aircraft. Explain what it is when you first use it.

both...

(U) Both children means "the two" children. Omit both when there is no confusion.

(U) The phrase both of must be kept before a pronoun in the accusative case: both of them. The preposition "of" is optional before

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a plural noun: both of the speeches or both speeches.

(U) Use of both for the possessive form rather than both of their. POOR: He knew both of their names. GOOD: She knew the names of both.

both . . . and...

(U) Make sure that the sequence of words following and has the same structure as that following both: POOR: I gave money both to Jane and Barbara. GOOD: I gave money to both Jane and Barbara or I gave money both to Jane and to Barbara.

(U) See the entry for parallelism.

bottom line...

(U) Originally business jargon, bottom line has become standard in the senses of "primary consideration" and "summary." Its meaning is clear.

boycott...

(U) A boycott is a refusal, usually by an organized group, to buy or use a product or service.

(U) Also see the entries for embargo and quarantine.

brackets...

(U) When including one set of brackets or parentheses within another, be sure that the number of opening and closing brackets is the same.

(U) Parentheses, or round brackets, often include explanations, afterthoughts, references, or other information. Brackets, or square brackets, often enclose information attributable to someone other than the author and are rare in serialized reports. See Parentheses.

BRAVO...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "b."

U//FOUO, Version 3

brevity...

(U) In reports, present the SIGINT facts, their significance, and related information in a concise but complete form.

(U) Short words and phrases can be as clear as or clearer than long ones. Use short forms whenever there will be no confusion to the reader.

(U) Choose words and phrases that will convey the exact meaning, however, even if they are longer than a word or phrase with a more general meaning.

bring...

(U) Use bring to indicate movement toward the speaker. Bring me a cup of tea, please.

(U) Use either bring or take when the direction of movement is unknown or irrelevant to the writer or reader. She brought presents to the children or She took presents to the children.

(U) Also see the entry for take.

British pounds...

(U) Use this phrase, as pounds sterling may not be clear to some readers. Render it as follows: 50 British pounds (U.S. \$ equivalent). Never use the abbreviation "lbs" for British pounds.

bulk...

(U) Do not use bulk when speaking of people. POOR: The bulk of the team stayed to celebrate. GOOD: Most of the team stayed to celebrate.

(U) See the entry for balance.

bullet format. .

(U) Use a bullet format to make lists easier to read. Do not capitalize the first word of a bullet unless you are making a complete sentence. Punctuate bullets as you would narrative.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

bureaucratese...

(U) Bureaucratese is a pejorative, non-technical term for the language style commonly associated with bureaucrats.

(U) Avoid bureaucratic style whenever possible. It is the mark of the timid writer. What is bureaucratic style? Robert Claiborne identified the four main principles of bureaucratic style as:

- never use a short word where a long one will do;
- never use one word where you can use three,
- use abstract and general terms rather than concrete and specific ones; and
- avoid flat statements by hedging and qualifying.

(U) Bureaucratese speaks in passive voice and buzzwords, and it carefully avoids assigning responsibility for any action or decision. It will bore or put to sleep most readers. Don't use it unless you have no other way to communicate.

burgeoning...

(U) Avoid this word. In the figurative sense of "rapid and flourishing growth," it has been standard since the late 1930s, but it is pretentious and, in SIGINT, rarely useful.

bushels...

(U) Use numbers with bushels: 5,000 bushels of wheat

but...

(U) Most writers consider "but" and "however" to be redundant when placed close together, but some accept them in the same clause when there are several intervening words: But the army went on the attack, however. In serialized reports, use either "but" or "however," not both.

(U) When "but" is used as a conjunction, the case of the following noun or pronoun is determined by the construction it is in. As a general rule, use of the nominative case is more common in literature than in general writing. "There is none but he, whose being I do fear." (Shakespeare, Macbeth).

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(U) When used as a proposition, but is always followed by the objective case. No one but him will help us.

(U) But is usually preceded by a comma, not followed by one: George wanted to play checkers, but Bernie wanted to play chess. A comma after "but" is acceptable if it is one of a pair setting off a parenthetical clause: But, as the ambassador noted in his response, General Zog had lied to him.

(U) Also see the entry for and.

buzzword...

(U) Buzzword is an informal term for a word used to impress rather than inform. It is particularly associated with government, business, and scientific jargon.

(U) Avoid buzzwords in sensitized reports.

BW...

(U) This abbreviation for biological warfare must be expanded on first reference.

by means of...

(U) Use by in most cases, but be careful. Sometimes you may want a longer form that cannot be interpreted ambiguously. (Merriam-Webster's New Collegiate Dictionary (10th edition) lists almost a dozen different meanings for by.) Remember that shorter is not always clearer.

by the time...

(U) Use when in most cases.



Content Steward: Reporting Board, 512RB, 963-5645
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, 512RB, 963-5645

Last Modified: June 3, 2006
Last Overall Site Review: January 6, 2006

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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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C

C² or C2...

(U) Symbol for command and control

C³ or C3...

(U) Symbol for command, control, and communications, not "command and control communications." Use it only after expanding the term since there is a chance the reader will not know precisely what is meant.

(U) The definition is: an integrated system of doctrine, procedures, organizational structure, personnel, equipment, facilities, and communications that provides authorities at all levels with timely and adequate data to plan, direct, and control their activities.

cadre..

(U) A group or core around which a larger organization can be built. The plural form is cadres.

(U) Cadre also can refer to an individual member of the cadre.

calendar...

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(U) As a rule, use the standard Gregorian calendar for all dates. If you are quoting a particular date that is significant in another calendar system, however, place the Gregorian date in parentheses immediately after the other calendar date. We will attack on 12 Ramadan (18 March).

(U) See the entry for ordinal date.

can...

(U) The verb *can* means "is able to." I can do that. *Can* also expresses the sense of "possibility": In the 20th century, you can marry the woman you love without her father's approval.

(U) *Can* in the sense of "permission" was defined by Noah Webster's 1828 dictionary as "free from any restraint of moral, civil, or political obligation, or from any positive prohibition." It expresses "permission" by not prohibiting: You can walk on the grass in this park.

(U) The use of *can* to request permission is a feature of speech rather than edited prose.

(U) See the entry for *may*.

cancel, cancel out...

(U) *Cancel* means "erase" or "delete." Cancel my order.

(U) *Cancel out* means "neutralize" or "offset": Paul's experience cancels out the lack of formal education.

cancellations...

(U) See the entry for *revisions*.

cannot...

(U) *Cannot* is one word when used in the sense "be unable to": I cannot go.

(U) Use two words when you want to emphasize the choice of a negative: I can go or I can not go.

capable, capability...

Can't, can't, can't

(U) Say it can, not "it is capable of" or "it has the capability to."

capital, capitol...

(U) A building in which a legislative body meets is called the capitol. Use capital at all other times.

capitalization...

(U) See the complete entry for capitalization.

caption...

(U) In American usage, caption may refer either to a heading over or to a legend under a picture, graph, or chart.

NOTE (U) Caption comes from the verb capere, meaning "seize," not from the noun caput, which means "head."

(U) See the entry for etymological fallacy.

carat...

(U) A unit of weight for precious stones. See the entry for karat.

Cardinal...

(U) Place the title before the name: Cardinal Richard Roe. The old form (Richard Cardinal Roe) is used only for signatures and formal introductions. It is the ecclesiastical equivalent of "William, Duke of Norfolk." Don't use the old form in serialized reports.

career, career...

(U) In American usage, these verbs are interchangeable.

case...

(U) Modern English has cases for nouns and pronouns. Generally, case does not affect the spelling of a noun except for the genitive (or possessive) form.

See also: C (U.S. FD-004)

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{U} Personal pronouns take different forms in three cases: nominative (or subjective), accusative (or objective), and genitive (or possessive). The genitive form depends on whether the pronoun is used before a noun or independently.

{U} See the entries for genitive and nominative.

casualties...

{U} In military terms, casualties means the total number of dead, wounded, missing, and captured. Do not use casualties when referring to only one of these categories.

catalog, catalogue...

{U} The GPO Style Manual gives the "-og" ending for catalog, dialog, epilog, monolog, prolog, and travelog. But according to Merriam-Webster, the "-logue" ending is more common for all except catalog, for which the forms are equally valid. The American Heritage Dictionary finds catalogue more common. For consistency use the "-logue" ending for all these words.

cathedral...

{U} See the entry for church.

CBRN...

{U} This abbreviation for chemical, biological, radiological, and nuclear (usually used in the phrase "CBRN terrorism") must be expanded on first reference.

CBW...

{U} This abbreviation for chemical and biological warfare must be expanded on first reference.

caveat...

{U//FOUO} A caveat is a warning or caution. It is a generic term in SIGINT for compartmentation markings, security control markings, SIGINT exchange designators, and validity markers.

Celsius...

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(U) The correct term for the metric temperature scale, which is the only one that should be used in sanitized reports. Use numerals to express temperature, except for zero. Spell out "minus" when temperatures are below zero. minus 15 Celsius. Do not add the word "degrees" if Celsius is used.

center...

(U) In American usage, center is used primarily with on or around: The dispute centers on due process rights.

(U) Purists argue that center means "to be gathered at a point" and should not be used with around. They call for replacing center around with "revolve around." Center around, however, is a standard idiom, even if less common than center on, and is acceptable.

centigrade...

(U) Use Celsius instead.

certain...

(U) Although it appears to be an absolute term, it is often modified by adverbs: fairly certain that, nothing is more certain than

(U) See the entry for absolute adjectives.

chair and its compounds...

(U) Chairman has been used since 1654 and can be used to refer to both men and women. Chairwoman appeared as early as 1699 but is used less frequently.

(U) Chair has been used as a noun since 1656 and is the standard neutral term in parliamentary procedure: Please address your remarks to the chair. The chair rules the motion out of order.

(U) The modern gender-neutral term chairperson was first coined in 1971. Although intended to be gender-neutral, it is used chiefly when no name is associated with the office or when a woman holds the office, according to Merriam-Webster.

(U) When the official title of a position is chairman, do not substitute a gender-neutral term.

(U) See entries for gender and -person.

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character...

(U) Avoid the phrase in character. It is usually unnecessary padding.

characterized by...

(U) This phrase can be used imprecisely: the activity was characterized by Instead, consider using "included" or "consisted of."

CHARLIE...

Phonetic spelling of the letter "c."

chop...

(U) Do not use this acronym for "change of operational control" or any of its derivatives (like outchop) in a serialized report. It is the jargon of a limited group and is not understood by the general reader.

church...

(U) Capitalize when it is part of the name of a building or organization (St. Bernadette Church) or when it refers to a church as an institution (the Presbyterian Church).

(U) Use lowercase when referring to a type of building: The church burned down yesterday.

circa...

(U) A Latin word. Instead, use around. Do not use circa with dates. Instead, use by or about. POOR: The troops should be in place circa 15 July. GOOD: The troops should be in place about 15 July.

circumlocution...

(U) A wordy and indirect way of saying something, often used to soften a thing or situation. Phrases such as "precipitation activity" rather than "rain" and "went to his eternal reward" rather than "died" are examples of circumlocution, which is a form of periphrasis.

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circumstances...

(U) You may use either in these circumstances or under these circumstances. Both are standard.

(U) The notion that in these circumstances is the only correct form is an etymological fallacy. Under these circumstances has been used since 1665, nearly 200 years before the first recorded use of in these circumstances.

(U) See the entry for etymological fallacy.

clarity...

(U) Clarity means saying precisely what we intend. It is the most important factor in writing serialized reports.

classification...

(U) Ensure that reports are classified properly. Classify the title, each paragraph, and each footnote of a report according to its content. In electrical reports, include the Overall Classification Line, but do not enter an overall classification statement in the TEXT Line.

(U) See the entry for overall classification statement.

clause...

(U) In language, a clause is a sentence or sentence-like construction included as part of another sentence. There are three types of clauses:

- the main clause, which is the principal clause of a sentence
- coordinate clauses, which consist of two main clauses linked by a coordinating conjunction
- the subordinate clause, which serves as a noun, adjective, or adverb in the sentence

cliche...

(U) A cliché is whatever word or phrase the writer or reader has seen often enough to find annoying. Sometimes clichés can be omitted or replaced, sometimes not.

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(U) One way to look at a cliché is to ask yourself if it has a definite meaning in the sentence. If it doesn't, then omit it from your report. If a cliché is the best way to express an idea, use it.

close proximity...

•(U//~~FOUO~~)
•(U//~~FOUO~~)
•(U//~~FOUO~~)

(U) Use near or in proximity to unless you are trying to distinguish among degrees of proximity.

codeword...

(U//~~FOUO~~) A word used with a classification to indicate that the material so classified was derived through a sensitive source or method, constitutes a particular type of sensitive compartmented information, or is accorded a limited distribution

code word...

(U//~~FOUO~~) The two-word form is used to designate the operations, plans, or activities of military, diplomatic, intelligence, or other organizations.

(U) Avoid using the expressions "cover word" or "cover term" for code word. They are not equivalent terms.

(U) See the entry for cover name, cover number

cohort...

(U) A cohort originally was a subdivision of a Roman legion. Its English meaning was extended to "group" or "band," in both singular and plural forms, and then was extended to individual members of the group.

(U) The use of cohort to refer to an individual companion has become well-established in American usage in the last 50 years. No one will be confused if you use it in this sense.

•(U//~~FOUO~~)
•(U//~~FOUO~~)
•(U//~~FOUO~~)

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collateral...

(U) See the complete entry for collateral.

collective noun...

(U) A collective noun that names and treats a group as a single unit takes a singular verb and a singular pronoun. The team is winning. The battalion is adding to its arsenal.

(U) The plural form is more common in British usage: The cabinet are committed to the policy.

(U) When members of the group act individually, use a plural verb and pronoun: The couple say their vows tomorrow. (Each person will say vows.)

(U) Also see the entries for amount of, data, number of, and majority.

colloquialism...

(U) A term used to describe ordinary speech or the informal use of a language. It is widely assumed to be a pejorative term, especially among usage commentators, but actually does not carry any negative meaning. It has been replaced in most current dictionaries and handbooks by "informal."

co-locate, co-location...

(U//FOUO) A traffic analysis term defined in the Glossary of Traffic Analytic Terminology, originally published in 1985 and updated in 1989. The correct spelling includes a **hyphen**.

(U//FOUO) Note carefully the distinction between co-locate, which means "the physical placement of two or more units in a specific location," and "collocate," which means "set or arrange two or more items in a pattern, especially side-by-side." The latter spelling and sense are associated primarily with linguistic theory and are not appropriate to SIGINT.

colon...

(U) Use a colon to:

- introduce a quotation - E. B. White writes of his annual surge of interest in gardening, "We are hooked . . ."

U//FOUO

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- separate clauses when the second clause explains, restates, or summarizes the first - The result is the same: everyone loses.
- introduce a list of items - To lose weight, give up only three items: breakfast, lunch, and dinner.
- lead into a final appositive - I purchased some of the works of Tiffany's studio: stained-glass windows.

(U) The first word after a colon generally is not capitalized. Unless it is part of the quotation, place the colon outside quotation marks.

combined...

(U) Military exercises or training involving two or more nations: a combined French-Norwegian exercise.

(U) See the entry for joint.

COMINT...

(U//FOUO) COMINT is technical and intelligence information derived from the intercept of foreign communications by other than the intended recipients. It does not include the monitoring of foreign public media.

(U//FOUO) COMINT includes intercept and analysis in the fields of traffic analysis, cryptanalysis, and direction finding.

comma...

(U) See the complete entry for comma.

command and control...

(U) See the entry for C² or C².

command, control, and communications...

(U) See the entry for C³ or C³.

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commence...

(U) Consider start, begin, or open rather than the more formal commence

common...

(U) Common describes the relationship of two or more members of a group to something else: common understanding, a common interest in zoology.

(U) See the entry for mutual.

communication...

(U) Use the singular form to reference one message: a communication from the president.

(U) Use the plural form to reference several messages or to indicate the overall system used to send and receive messages: Satellite communications are the way of the future.

communications exercise...

(U//FOUO) An exercise in which only the communications elements participate, either in or near the garrison or deployed to field locations. There is generally no scenario.

(U//FOUO) Always spell out the phrase in full the first time you use it in a report. In subsequent references, use either "the exercise" or the abbreviation "COMEX."

communism, communist...

(U) Use lowercase for the word communism

(U) Capitalize communist when referring to the political party or to individuals who are members of it: Communist Party. He is a Communist.

(U) Use lowercase for communist in all other situations: a communist government; he has communist leanings.

compare...

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{U} When compare is used as an active verb, follow the standard rule.

- To express similarities between **different** kinds of things, use "compare to". He compared her to a summer day.
- To express both differences and similarities between **like** things, use "compare with": The press compared the President's budget with that of the Congress.
- When compared is used as a detached past participle, either with or to is acceptable: This year's ratio of sales to costs, compared to [or with] last year's, is much improved.

{U} Also see the entry for contrast

comparison of adjectives...

{U} The comparative form of most adjectives that are gradable (i.e., can be seen as having varying levels) is formed by adding the suffix -er; the superlative form by adding -est.

{U} Longer adjectives often add "more" and "most" as pre-modifiers. Some adjectives can take either form of comparison.

{U} For irregular forms, such as good/better/best, consult the dictionary for the proper form.

compartmentation markings...

{U//~~FOUO~~} Use compartmentation markings to ensure that sensitive material is kept within special channels and to restrict the material to those cleared for that level of information

{~~FOUO~~} There are two compartments in general use in serialized reports: TALENT KEYHOLE and COMINT. The COMINT compartment is further divided into several categories.

{U//~~FOUO~~} Compartmentation markings generally follow the classification and precede any special handling caveats or security control markings.

{U} See the entries for caveat and for security control markings

U//~~FOUO~~
COMINT

complement...

U//~~FOUO~~ COMINT

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(U) A noun or verb denoting "completeness" or "the process of supplementing something": The ship has a complement of 220 men. The scarf complements her dress.

compose...

(U) The traditional rule is "the parts compose the whole." If your emphasis is on the parts, use compose: Forty-nine provinces compose Poland or in the passive voice, Poland is composed of 49 provinces. (NOTE: "Consists of" often can replace the passive form is composed of.)

(U) See the entries for comprise and constitute.

comprise...

(U) The traditional rule is "the whole comprises the parts." If the emphasis is on the whole, use comprise: The Union comprises 50 states. The unit comprises five types of aircraft.

(U) Although the passive voice form is composed of has been used for more than a century, it has been criticized by many usage writers. Use it with care in SIGINT.

(U) See the entries for compose, constitute, and include.

concept...

(U) Avoid "the concept of." It is not necessary. POOR: The concept of SIGINT reporting permits users . . . IMPROVED: SIGINT reporting permits users . . .

concrete noun...

(U) In grammar a concrete noun refers to a touchable or observable person or thing: boy, tree, factory, clock. Some nouns can be both concrete and abstract: such as "industry."

(U) See the entry for abstract noun.

condition...

(U) Avoid as part of a two-word noun: weather conditions, farm conditions. The word condition (or its counterparts activity and

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situation) rarely adds anything useful to the phrase.

(U) Also see the entries for activity and situation.

conjunctions...

(U) Use and, but, or, nor, for, so, and yet to connect words, phrases, and clauses of equal grammatical rank.

(U) Use subordinating conjunctions to connect a dependent clause to a main clause: When they shut the plant down, they acted as if nothing were wrong.

connected with, in connection with...

(U) Sometimes too wordy. Instead, try about, concerning, in, or with.

connote...

(U) Means "suggest or imply something beyond the explicit meaning." The word "bachelor" connotes a carefree lifestyle. Connote indicates what we associate with the word "bachelor."

(U) See the entry for denote.

consensus...

(U) Purists argue that consensus of opinion is a redundancy, saying you can't have a consensus of anything but opinion. This is not true as consensus has been used of other things for at least 150 years.

(U) The phrase was not discussed in usage books until the 1940s, at which time most commentators began claiming it was a redundancy despite the evidence covering more than 100 years of usage. According to Merriam-Webster, James Bennett (editor of the New York Herald from 1867 to 1918) probably is the source of the opinion that consensus of opinion is a redundancy.

(U) Nevertheless, if you use consensus by itself when you mean consensus of opinion, everyone will understand what you mean.

(U) Avoid general consensus because the phrase isn't clear about whether you mean "general agreement, with some dissenting individuals," or "agreement on general principles, with some disagreement on details."

THE END

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conservative...

(U) Because this political term has different meanings, even to those who call themselves conservatives, avoid using it in a serialized report to describe political movements unless you are quoting directly. The same approach is true for liberal, moderate, reactionary, etc.

(U) It is acceptable to use the adjective conservative to mean "marked by moderation or caution". a conservative estimate.

considerable number of...

(U) Can be vague and wordy. Instead of a considerable number of, say many, most, nearly a hundred, or some other specific term whenever possible.

constitute...

(U) Constitute is preferred over either compose or comprise when the sense is "form" or "make up". Twelve ordinary citizens constitute a jury.

(U) Even so, it is formal and often unnecessary. Replace it with a simpler form, such as "form" or "make up". Twelve ordinary citizens make up a jury.

(U) See the entries for compose and comprise.

consul...

(U) A consul is an officer in the foreign service of a country.

consul general ..

(U) Two words. Capitalize when used as a title. The plural form is consuls general. The place is a consulate general.

consumer, customer, user...

(U) People or organizations that receive serialized SIGINT reports to support their missions. The preferred term today is intelligence user.

SECRET

contact...

(U) Contact has been used as a verb since at least 1834 and in its modern, transitive sense since the 1920s. Part of the traditional disparagement of contact as a verb no doubt is due to a general animosity among writers toward the business community and all things associated with it, even though the alleged origin in business jargon is open to question.

(U) Most usage commentators and all dictionaries now accept it as standard, though Merriam-Webster reports many college handbooks still disapprove.

See the entry for nouns as verbs.

context...

(U) The words that precede or follow a word or phrase and which may have some effect on its meaning.

continual, continuous...

(U) Continual has been used since the 14th century in the meaning "continuing indefinitely in time without interruption." Although many good writers continue to use it in that sense, continual today most often means "steady or frequent repetition in which no end is reached": The merger has been the source of continual litigation. Dancing requires continual practice.

(U) Continuous means "without interruption between the beginning and the end, unbroken": All she saw was a continuous stretch of desert. Rain fell continuously through the night. This sense has been used since the 1830s. Only continuous may be used in referring to "physical continuation," its original sense in the 17th century.

contractions...

(U) Do not use contractions in serialized reports.

contrast...

(U) To express differences between like things when no similitudes exist, use in contrast to (or with): In contrast to (or with) Shakespeare's plays, my plays are badly written. In contrast to is more common in American usage.

(U) See the entry for compare.

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convention...

(U) Grammatically, convention is an informal agreement to do things in a particular way. Many things in English are conventions, such as spelling, writing left-to-right, and marking possession with an apostrophe.

(U) Conventions are not the same as rules of grammar and can reflect national preference (as in spelling) or house style (as in punctuation).

coordinates...

(U//FOUO) Use leading zeros in geographic coordinates. Gotham City (0001N 0001W). Express coordinates in degrees and minutes. When significant, add seconds to the coordinates.

(U//FOUO) Use four digits (or six if adding seconds) followed by an uppercase "N" or "S" for latitude: 1234N 123456S. Use five digits (or seven if adding seconds) followed by an uppercase "E" or "W" for longitude: 12345E 1234567W

(U) Do not use coordinates in the title of a serialized report.

(U//FOUO) In a report of three paragraphs or fewer, add coordinates immediately after the first use of a placename. Do not use coordinates in the lead of a report of four or more paragraphs. Consider alternate forms to reference location in a lead, such as 20 km south of Capital City

(U//FOUO) When first referring to a placename in the report body, include coordinates in parentheses immediately after the name or in a footnote: Metropolis (1234N 12345E) Bomb Range. If the coordinates refer to the city, Metropolis Bomb Range (1234N 12345E), if the coordinates refer to the bomb range

(U//FOUO) Use a footnote when the coordinates are not essential for understanding the report. If you use a footnote, include both placename and coordinates. If there are many coordinates, consider placing them in an appendix.

(U//FOUO) Coordinates are not required for capitals and other cities well-known to the average reader: Tokyo and Munich

(U//FOUO) If the coordinates are unavailable or unknown, place the word "unlocated" in parentheses right after the name: Smallville (unlocated), Anyland

(U) See the entry for latitude/longitude.

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copyright...

(U) The use of copyrighted material in serialized reports generally falls under the "fair use" provisions of copyright law. **Extensive** quotation or use of copyrighted material may require consultation with the Office of General Counsel.

corps...

(U//FOUO) Capitalize when part of a name: the VI Corps. Use Roman numerals to designate an army corps: III Corps. Use arabic numerals to identify an air defense corps: 5th Air Defense Corps.

(U//FOUO) Place the country name, if included, between the number and the word corps: VII Zealand Corps.

corrections...

(U) See the entry for recal/revisions.

council, counsel...

(U) A council is a deliberative body. Use counsel in all other senses.

councilor, counselor...

(U) A councilor is a member of a deliberative body, such as a city council.

(U) A counselor is one who advises other persons. Lawyers are often referred to as counselors.

couple...

(U) In American English, couple is used as an adjective before plural nouns or number words: "The first couple chapters are pretty good" (E. B. White). This construction is common in speech and general prose, but not in formal writing. Avoid it in serialized reports.

(U) See the entry for collective noun.

courtesy titles...

DO NOT INCLUDE

5/7/2010

(U) Do not use Mr., Mrs., Miss, or Ms. in a SIGINT serialized report. Avoid Dr., Rev., and similar titles unless they are **absolutely** necessary to the report.

(U) PL 96-36

cover name, cover number...

(U) PL 96-36

(U) A word or number used to conceal the identity of a person, place, or thing. The term is a two-word form

(U) PL 96-36

[REDACTED]

(U) PL 96-36

[REDACTED]

(U) See the entry for code word.

cover term...

[REDACTED]

cover word...

(U) PL 96-36
(U) PL 96-36

(U) The expression cover word is not a valid SIGINT term.

credibility...

(U) Credibility is basic to SIGINT reporting and is very fragile. A reader who finds inflated and unsupported statements, or poorly worded and confusing ones, will be very skeptical of SIGINT in the future and may even ignore it.

(U) Ensure that what you say is true, clear, and presented in a tone appropriate to the information. Distinguish SIGINT facts from collateral information. Indicate clearly what is analytic comment or opinion and what is fact.

creeping nounism...

(U) An outgrowth of bureaucratism that is marked by stringing together two or three "fancy" nouns where one simple noun will do. Examples are precipitation activity for rain, exercise activity for exercise, and resource allocation constraints for budget cuts.

(U) PL 96-36

[REDACTED]

5/7/2010

criteria...

(U) A plural form of the Greek word *critērion*. It has been used as a singular in English since the 1940s, but has drawn far more criticism than its counterparts *agenda*, *data*, *candelabra*, and *stamina*, which also are plural forms and are used in English as singulars.

(U) To avoid controversy, use *criteria* only in a plural sense. Use *criterion* in the singular.

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cross-references...

(U) Do not cross-reference another report in the text. Always place it in a footnote.

(U) In the cross-reference, give the reader some reason why he should look at the referenced report. Avoid a "naked" cross-reference, i.e. one that consists of nothing more than a serial and date-time-group. POOR: See 2/00/12345-95 270123Z JUN 95. GOOD: For a discussion of Zandian efforts to develop an amphibious landing capability, see 2/00/12345-95 270123Z JUN 95.

currency...

(U) See the entry for *money*.

currently...

(U) Like "presently," *currently* can be unnecessary. Omit it when it will not affect the meaning of the sentence. We are [currently] reviewing the facts.

curriculum...

(U) The more frequent plural form is *curricula*, but *curriculums* is also standard.

CW...

(U) This abbreviation for chemical warfare must be expanded on first reference.

Czech...

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(U) Use Czech only to refer to the language, the ethnic group, or the Czech Republic.

Czechoslovak.

(U) Acceptable as the **adjectival form** for the Czech and Slovak Federal Republic. With the breakup of Czechoslovakia, this adjective is useful only in **historical** contexts.

Czechoslovakia.

(U) Acceptable as the shortened form of the Czech and Slovak Federal Republic. Include this name only in **historical** contexts.

(U) The successor states to Czechoslovakia are the Czech Republic and the Slovak Republic (or Slovakia).



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Page Publisher Reporting Board: S12RB.963.5645



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Last Modified: June 12, 2007
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2010

Director of NSA/CSS Mexico / 121218Z January 2007 / Declassify On: 20320102

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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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D

daily...

(U) See the entry for: base.

dam...

(U) Capitalize when part of a name. Hoover Dam.

dangling modifier..

(U) A dangling modifier modifies what is implied but not actually stated in a sentence: Reading the story, the ending surprised me. The implied subject of the modifier is "I," which is not stated--thus the modifier dangles. Correct it by revising the sentence so that the intended subject is stated: Reading the story, I was surprised by the ending.

(U) A very common form of dangling modifier, as in the example above, is a participial phrase at the beginning of a sentence--known as a dangling participle. But clauses, infinitives, and appositives can also dangle.

(U) Also see the entries for absolute phrases and misplaced modifiers.

dash...

06-11 P.L. 86-36

4/7/2010

(U) Use a dash to:

- emphasize explanations, including appositives and definitions
- emphasize a contrast
- mark a sudden break or change in thought
- set off a final clause that summarizes a series of ideas.

(U) In electrical reports the dash consists of a pair of hyphens. Do not put a space before or after the dash. Be sure to place the word ~~SECRET~~ in dashes next to or near the words they explain: Rick's idea—a stupid one—was voted down.

data, datum...

(U) The English word data is derived from the plural form of the Latin word datum. It is used in ways unrelated to its Latin ancestor. Unlike the plural of most count nouns, like "criteria" or "women," data cannot be modified by cardinal numbers. You can't say five data or two hundred data.

(U) Data, when used in the sense of an abstract mass noun (like "information"), takes a singular verb, modifiers, and pronoun: The data is clear, and it is consistent. (The earliest citation of data with a singular verb is from 1902.)

(U) When data takes on the sense of a plural noun, use a plural verb, modifiers, and pronoun: The data have been collected, and they are ready for analysis.

(U) Contrary to popular belief, the English word data is not related to the English count noun datum, which has its own meaning and plural form (datums). Merriam-Webster notes that all citations of datum prior to the mid-1980s were in the "learned media." The appearance since then of datum in the popular press, they speculate, may be due to the insistence of many newspaper editors that data is a plural only.

(U) See the entry for etymological fallacy.

data base...

(U) Two words

U-FOUO

data systems...

(U) When a generic description of a data system is not enough to differentiate between similar systems in a serialized report, use the cover name (e.g. SWAMP, MARKHAM). In such cases, give a narrative description and place the cover name (in capital letters) in parentheses right after the first use. In subsequent references the cover name may be used by itself. Also use a cover name when convention has made it commonplace.

date...

(U) In serialized reports enter dates in day-month-year order only. 1 January 1995. Spell out the month in the narrative; in tables abbreviate the month using the first three letters: Jan, Feb, etc.

(U) When the month has been established, it is acceptable to refer to the date by the day only: again on the 27th; the next day. Include the month whenever its omission might confuse the reader.

(U) If all dates are in the current year, include the year only on the first reference. Always include the year as part of the date when it differs from the base year of the report.

(U) Do not use expressions like today, tomorrow, yesterday, or next week unless you are giving an exact quote. In that case provide the calendar date in parentheses immediately after: Tomorrow (15 April) we will attack from the west.

(U) For date ranges, choose either from 8 to 12 June or between 8 and 12 June. Use a hyphen only in tables of data.

(U) Dates in serialized reports do not take leading zeros. 4 July, not 04 July.

(U) Also see the entries for ordinal date and time.

day of the week...

(U) Abbreviate only in a tabular format. Use the first three letters: Mon, Tue, etc. Include the day of the week only when it provides necessary information.

DDIs...(U/P/FOUO)

it is a D.D. 45 19

5 7/2010



dearth...

(U) Means a "scarcity" or "shortage."

5-12-10-11-10-10

decade...

(U) In narrative text, always express a year or decade in four digits: 1990 or the 1990s, not '90 or the 90s.

(U) Do not use an apostrophe when referring to decades: the 1990s, not the 1990's.

(U) Use the two-digit form only in listings or when citing a date-time-group (DTG): For more information on the Prigian coup, see 2/00/123-85 121234Z JAN 95.

decimals...

(U) Use a period and numerals to indicate decimal amounts. Extend the decimal no more than two places in most reports. Adjust the figures in a listing so that they line up on the decimal points.

decimate...

(U) Originally meant "killing every tenth man as a punishment for cowardice or mutiny." Although usage since 1663 has expanded its meaning to "the destruction in any way of a large proportion of anything reckoned by number," it is not a synonym for "destroy" or "smash": WRONG: The town was decimated by the tornado. RIGHT: The town was smashed by the tornado.

(U) For the greatest accuracy, use decimate only with people: Famine decimated the population. (Not the land.) Do not use it with percentages other than one-tenth: WRONG: Famine decimated 87 percent of the population.

5-12-10-11-10-10



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(U) See the entry for etymological lallacy.

deduce, deduct...

(U) Deduce means "reach a conclusion by reasoning" or "trace the origin of something."

(U) Deduct carries the idea of "subtracting something from," as in deduct the total expenses from the total income.

(U) The noun deduction applies to both verb forms.

defense...

(U) Use the American spelling, which is an "s," not a "c."

(U) See the entry for spelling.

definitely...

(U) Avoid using this word unless you are strongly emphasizing a fact. In most cases, just state the fact.

DELTA...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "d."

demolish, destroy...

(U) Both mean "do away with something." Purists say completely demolished and totally destroyed are redundant because demolished and destroyed are absolutes. This is inconsistent because even purists accept partially destroyed and partially demolished. Go ahead and use the modifiers without fear.

denote...

(U) It means "mark or signify directly." Denote is used to indicate the thing a word names or the act it affirms. The word bachelor denotes an unmarried man.

(U) See the entry for connote.

Printed on 10/16/10

depart...

(U) Use a following preposition whenever amplifying or explaining. He will depart. He will depart from the train station. He will depart on Tuesday.

deprecate, depreciate...

(U) Deprecate originally meant "protest against." Today deprecate is used in the sense of "belittle" or "mildly disparage."

(U) Depreciate originally meant "reduce in value." Depreciate is used only as a financial term.

desert, dessert...

(U) Desert has one "s," just like the word "sand." Dessert has an extra "s," just as a meal may have something extra.

NOTE: (U) In the phrase just deserts, the word deserts is related to the verb "deserve" and is spelled with one "s."

desktop publishing (DTP)...

(U) A method of producing documents with embedded graphics and various fonts using a computer software package.

(U) Documents prepared using a DTP package should follow the principles of good design: effective use of white space, consistency, and restraint. The object is to make it easier to read--not a dazzling, pyrotechnic showcase of your skills.

(U) For serialized reports, follow the guidance in the Desktop Publishing Standards for SIGINT Reporting manual.

destroy...

(U) See the entry for garblish.

dialogue...

(U) A dialogue is not restricted to two. The Greek *dia* means "through, across, or apart," not "two."

(U) It is used most often in relation to "two," but also can have the meaning "an exchange of ideas and opinions" without reference to numbers. Thus, there can be a dialogue among several persons or parties.

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(U) See the entry for etymological fallacy.

dictionary...

(U) See the complete entry for dictionary.

different from/than/to...

(U) Things are different from each other. Her opinion is different from his. Even better, replace "is different from" with the phrase "differs from": Her opinion differs from his. The earliest recorded use of different from was in Shakespeare's *Comedy of Errors* in 1583.

(U) Different than is ~~erected~~ ~~erected~~ back to 1844. Today it is primarily American usage, especially when a clause follows "than": Gloria knew that things were different than they were when she was a child.

(U) In serialized reports, use different than only to compare differences: All three copies differ from the original, but the third is more different than the others.

(U) Different to is primarily British usage and dates back to 1803.

dilemma...

(U) Dilemma originally was a rhetorical term for an argument presenting alternatives against an opponent, each of which was conclusive against him. It then was applied to a choice involving mutually exclusive alternatives or to the state of mind of a person making such a choice.

(U) By the middle of the 17th century, the word was also being applied to a choice between two unpleasant alternatives: He faced the dilemma of going to jail or becoming an informer.

(U) Today dilemma is most often used in instances in which the alternatives are not expressed or implied: "man's dilemma [in society]" (E.B. White). As such, it functions as a synonym for "predicament" or "problem" and in this sense is standard English.

dimensions...

(U) See the entry for measurement.

Printed on 5/7/2019

directions and regions...

(U) Capitalize the names of regions and their derivatives: Eastern Europe, the Far East, Western press. Use lowercase to refer to direction: He went east. Hungary is south of Poland.

See the box for capitalization.

disassociate, dissociate...

(U) Both forms go back to the early 17th century and are equally legitimate when talking about people.

(U) In nonpersonal senses, dissociate is preferable.

disc, disk...

(U) Use disc in special terms, such as videodisc. For most purposes, use disk.

discourse markers...

(U) A discourse marker is a tiny word or phrase that does not clearly contribute to the grammar or meaning of a sentence. Such markers are very common in speech, but not appropriate in writing.

(U) The discourse marker helps us adjust our speech to our audience, allowing us to shift the conversation, rephrase, start over, and hesitate based on the feedback we receive from the listener(SHAREL).

(U) Some of the most common markers in speech are well, I mean, and you know.

discreet, discrete...

(U) Discreet means "prudent": Al was not very discreet.

(U) Discrete means "separate": There were four discrete events in the exercise.

disinterested...

(U) Disinterested entered the language in the early 17th century with the meaning "unconcerned" or "having no interest in." In 1855,

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than a century it picked up a second meaning of "having no personal stake in the outcome." Both uses are common today, despite the efforts of language purists. In the 20th century, disinterested has picked up a third meaning of "having lost interest in."

(U) If you use disinterested to mean "impartial"—the sense that most usage pundits prefer, though the noun "disinterest" means "lack of interest," not "impartiality"—make sure the context makes this clear. A disinterested opinion is clear; disinterested in the outcome is not clear.

(U) If you use disinterested in its oldest sense, some people will be confused and some will be sure you are wrong. In SIGINT reporting, therefore, use it to mean "impartial" only.

(U) See the entry for uninterested.

dissemination...

(U) The provision of information to intelligence users outside the SIGINT community. Serialized reports are the most common form of dissemination, but any method used to get information to an intelligence user qualifies as dissemination. This includes telephone conversations, conferences, technical reports, and briefings.

(U) Dissemination of U.S. identities by any means—serialized report, telephone call, informal briefing—is prohibited without the approval of the DDO or his designee. Contact P0522 if a user asks for a U.S. identity.

distance...

(U) See the entry for measurement.

distinct, distinctive...

(U) Distinct means "clearly defined" or "sharply distinguished from other things": The warbler is not a distinct species.

(U) Distinctive refers to an attribute that enables us to distinguish one thing from another: The warbler has a distinctive song.

distribution...

(U) See the complete entry for distribution.

ditto marks...

See P0522, P0523, P0524.

(U) Do not use them in SIGINT reporting.

divided usage...

(U) Usage is divided when two or more forms exist, both of which are in reputable use at the same level of language. The forms may differ as to pronunciation (advertisement), spelling (defense, defence), or verb forms (dived, dove).

(U) The point about divided usage is that both forms are acceptable, even though one of these forms may be preferable to a particular reader or listener. Some usage issues are no more than divided usage.

dollars...

(U) To express U.S. currency, simply use the dollar sign (\$) before the amount: \$5,000. You need not add "U.S." before the dollar sign.

double genitive...

(U) The double genitive occurs when the "of" and the "'s" forms are used together: a friend of my father's.

(U) Use it to indicate that more than one of the entities in question belongs to the object of "of."

double negative...

(U) Although a double negative can be used in certain circumstances--such as using one negative word or statement to qualify the meaning of another (e.g., the U.S. cannot just do nothing)--it is best to avoid using it.

(U) See the entry for hardly.

doubling final consonants...

(U) See the entry for spelling.

doubt it...

(U) Although some commentators would label doubt it as informal, most find it interchangeable with "doubt that" or "doubt whether."

doubt that, doubt whether...

(U) The traditional rule says to use **doubt that** or **doubtful that** to express complete rejection of a statement: I **doubt that** she will come. It is **doubtful that** he studied. When used with a negative, it means complete acceptance of the statement: I **do not doubt** that she is right.

(U) When the intention is to express genuine uncertainty, use **doubt whether** or **doubtful whether**: I **doubt whether** he knew the answer. It is **doubtful whether** she will come.

(U) The problem with the traditional rules, of course, is that they require absolute clarity in the context or clarity on the reader's part to know whether disbelief or uncertainty is meant. As a practical matter, the choice among **doubt if**, **doubt that**, and **doubt whether** is a personal one unless the context indicates clearly whether disbelief or uncertainty is meant.

(U) See the entry for **doubt if**.

dozen...

(U) When a number is part of the phrase, use **dozen**: John Doe has **four dozen** suits.

(U) When there is no number, use the plural form: Police confiscated **dozens of** rifles.

drone...

(U) A **drone** is a pilotless vehicle used as a target or for reconnaissance.

Do: 11
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drop shadow...

(U) In desktop publishing, a **shadow** that usually extends around the side or sides of a frame to make the frame stand out more clearly. The most common drop shadow extends from the bottom and right sides.

(U) In preparing a DTP-formatted report, use the **same** drop shadow pattern throughout the report.



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SECRET//SI

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"go reporting"

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E

each...

(U) When pronoun *each* is followed by an "of" phrase and serves as the subject of a sentence, it generally takes a singular verb and pronoun. Each of the boys has played his best.

(U) When *each* follows a plural subject, however, the verb and following pronouns remain in the plural. The boys each have their own tasks.

(U) See the entries for between each, between every and for notional agreement.

each and every...

(U) This idiom is used for emphasis and takes a singular verb and pronoun: Each and every player knows his role.

each other...

(U) Traditionalists argue that *each other* refers only to two and "one another" to more than two. In fact the terms are interchangeable and have been for many centuries. The old distributive for two, as opposed to several, was *either*, not "each."

eager...

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(U) For maximum clarity, purists say, use **eager** only about something you want to happen: I am **eager** to leave on my vacation.

(U) The "traditional" rule, in American usage, is that **eager** implies positive whereas **anxious** implies unpleasant or negative. But see the entry for **anxious** for a discussion of this point.

East European, Eastern Europe...

(U) Use **Eastern Europe** to refer to the region.

(U) **East European** is an adjective and modifies a noun or pronoun: East European economics.

ecology, environment...

(U) **Ecology** is a branch of science concerned with the relationship between organisms and their environment.

(U) **Environment** refers to the factors or conditions that affect an organism.

economic, economical...

(U) **Economic** means "having to do with business or trade."

(U) **Economical** means "thrifty."

editing...

(U) As William Zinsser puts it in *On Writing Well*, "What a good editor brings to a piece of writing is an objective eye . . ." As an editor, ensure that the reporter's words and style express the story clearly and logically. Do not allow something in a report that you do not understand, because the user may not understand it either.

~~(U//FOUO)~~ It is the editor's responsibility to make sure that a serialized report follows the standards expressed in USSID CF1400 and its annexes, the SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual, the U.S. identities in SIGINT manual, and other guidance from PQS and the management chain. When specific instructions exist, the editor must see to it that reporters in that organization follow the instructions.

(U) Good editors never substitute their words for those of the reporter, except to correct minor errors in grammar. Even then, a good editor will discuss changes with the reporter and explain why certain changes need to be made. This is important because

See the style guide.

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the change may affect a point that the reporter is making elsewhere in the report.

(U) The mortal sin of editing is going beyond changes in style or structure and tampering with a report's content. Editors who believe that the content is not correct or complete must go back to the reporter and discuss the issue. Editors who on their own change the content and thrust of a report are exceeding their authority. The report's content is the responsibility of the reporter, not the editor.

(U) Reporters and editors are a team and should work together to produce the best report possible. Look on each other as partners, not antagonists.

-ee ending...

(U) Use the -ee ending to refer to

- one who receives or is directly affected by an act (e.g., appointee)
- a person with a specific condition (e.g., amputee)
- a person performing some action (e.g., escapee)

effect...

(U) As a noun, effect means "result." The effect was to block the advance.

(U) As a verb, effect means "bring about" or "produce": They implemented a plan to effect savings. Avoid using "effect" as a verb. It is often misused (see "affect") and is usually redundant (e.g., "effecting change" vs. "changing").

(U) See the entry for affect.

effectively...

(U) Effectively means "with effect." She spoke effectively about the issue.

(U) Use in effect to mean "more or less": The matter was dealt with in effect, on Monday.

effectuate...

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(U) Do not use. It is a word for formal and legalistic contexts.

e.g. ...

(U) Abbreviation for the Latin *exempli gratia*. Use it to introduce one or more examples, generally in parenthetical entries. In the middle of a sentence, it is usually set off by a pair of commas.

either...

(U) Either may be used as a pronoun, an adjective, or a conjunction. As a pronoun, it dates back to the year 1000 and is rarely used of more than two: Either can do the job.

(U) Either as an adjective dates back to the time of King Alfred (9th century). While it is less common than "each" or "both," it is still used by writers and is common in speech. ACCEPTABLE: Broil the fish on either side. MORE COMMON: Broil the fish on each side or Broil the fish on both sides.

(U) When either is used as a conjunction, it may be used to refer to more than two: The President ordered a change in policy without consulting either supporters, journalists, scholars, or critics.

either . . . or...

(U) The nouns or phrases that follow these words must be equivalent: Either John or Jane will go. Lynn had to decide either to stay with Edward or to go to the party alone.

(U) When all the elements in an either . . . or construction are singular, the verb is singular. When one is singular and the other is plural, the verb agrees with the nearer element: Either he or his teammates are going. Better yet, rewrite the sentence to avoid such a construction: If he goes, his teammates won't go.

(U) Use the same pattern for constructions with neither . . . nor.

(U) See the entry for *parafelians*.

elder, eldest...

(U) Use elder and eldest when referring to people. In comparisons elder is followed by *of*: the elder of the brothers.

... 1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10. 11. 12. 13. 14. 15. 16. 17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24. 25. 26. 27. 28. 29. 30. 31. 32. 33. 34. 35. 36. 37. 38. 39. 40. 41. 42. 43. 44. 45. 46. 47. 48. 49. 50. 51. 52. 53. 54. 55. 56. 57. 58. 59. 60. 61. 62. 63. 64. 65. 66. 67. 68. 69. 70. 71. 72. 73. 74. 75. 76. 77. 78. 79. 80. 81. 82. 83. 84. 85. 86. 87. 88. 89. 90. 91. 92. 93. 94. 95. 96. 97. 98. 99. 100. 101. 102. 103. 104. 105. 106. 107. 108. 109. 110. 111. 112. 113. 114. 115. 116. 117. 118. 119. 120. 121. 122. 123. 124. 125. 126. 127. 128. 129. 130. 131. 132. 133. 134. 135. 136. 137. 138. 139. 140. 141. 142. 143. 144. 145. 146. 147. 148. 149. 150. 151. 152. 153. 154. 155. 156. 157. 158. 159. 160. 161. 162. 163. 164. 165. 166. 167. 168. 169. 170. 171. 172. 173. 174. 175. 176. 177. 178. 179. 180. 181. 182. 183. 184. 185. 186. 187. 188. 189. 190. 191. 192. 193. 194. 195. 196. 197. 198. 199. 200. 201. 202. 203. 204. 205. 206. 207. 208. 209. 210. 211. 212. 213. 214. 215. 216. 217. 218. 219. 220. 221. 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(U) See the entries for order, oldest and for superlative of two.

elegant variation...

(U) A term coined by H. W. Fowler to describe the use of a synonym merely to avoid using the same word twice in a sentence or a short piece of text. Avoid the syndrome.

ELINT...

☒ Do not include an ISI in the FAG line of an ELINT report unless you can determine the source of the signal involved

☒ Operational ELINT includes information on emitter deployment, use of the system, activity schedules, tactics, I & W, and force composition

☒ Technical ELINT is information about the characteristics of the emitter: frequency range, pulse width, etc.

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(U) See the entry for requirements.

ellipsis...

(U) In punctuation, use an ellipsis to indicate that part of a quoted work has been omitted. An ellipsis consists of three spaced dots. Always leave a space before and after the ellipsis, especially in the middle of a sentence: To learn a language, learn . . . a few everyday sentences.

(U) When what you omit falls at the end of the sentence, add a period after the final space: Lincoln said "Fourscore and seven years ago, our fathers brought forth . . ."

(U) If the omission falls after the end of a complete sentence, add the ellipsis mark after the period. Sally remained silent. . . Phil then left.

(U) Grammatically, ellipsis is the omission of part of a phrase or sentence. Sentence adverbs are an example of grammatical ellipsis.

(U) See the entries for hopefully and for sentence adverb.

elude...

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(U) Means "escape" or "avoid." Do not confuse it with "allude."

(U) See the entry for allude, allusion.

email...

(U) Shortened term for electronic mail. The spelling without the hyphen is becoming more common and is preferred, but the alternative form e-mail is also correct.

embargo...

(U) An embargo is a government order prohibiting trade.

(U) See the entries for boycott and quarantine.

embark...

(U) Do not use it in serialized reports to mean "start" or "begin."

(U) In naval jargon it has a specialized meaning, which may not be clear to all readers. If you are using embark in that context, explain its meaning in a footnote.

embassy...

(U) Capitalize embassy when it is used with the name of a nation: the Zambian Embassy. Use lowercase when embassy appears alone: I will visit the embassy tomorrow.

(U) See the entry for ambassador.

emigrant, emigrate...

(U) One who leaves a country emigrates and is an emigrant.

(U) See immigrant, immigrate.

emigre...

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(U) A political term used to refer to someone who is forced to leave a country for political reasons.

Emphasis (U) (U) (U) (U) (U) (U)

emphasis...

(U) Emphasis means force or prominence. In serialized reports, emphasize the most important SIGINT facts and their significance by summarizing them in the lead of the report.

enciphered...

ended, ending...

(U) Either ended or ending may be used when speaking of a period that ended in the past: the week ended (or ending) 26 February.

enhance...

(U) Considered by some to be overused, it usually has a thing or quality as its object. Try improve, strengthen, increase, or another more specific word.

en route...

(U) A French phrase meaning "on the way." Both one- and two-word forms are in use, but the two-word form is more common.

(U) In SIGINT it should always be used with the preposition "to" or "from": The aircraft was en route to (or from) Berlin. Always use the two-word form.

ensure...

(U) Ensure means "make an outcome certain" or "make something secure from harm": ensure a nation's security.

(U) See the entries for assure and insure.

En route (U) (U) (U) (U) (U) (U)

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entitled...

(U) Its more current meaning is "a right to do or have something". She was entitled to the promotion.

(U) The sense of "titled" or "named" is the older sense and goes back about 500 years. It is standard English, although less common in this sense today in American English. The book was entitled "Russian Policy in North Africa."

equal...

(U) Some commentators consider equal an adjective without comparative forms and object to the phrase more equal. In fact, equal has been compared since the 17th century.

(U) The idiom more equal has the common meaning of "more nearly equal" and is standard English. Use it freely.

equally as..

(U) An idiomatic phrase like "just as" or "every bit as." It is more common in speech than in writing and adds emphasis to the comparison involved. "Equally" or "as" can replace equally as in many, if not most, uses.

(U) Because many people regard the phrase as redundant in all contexts, avoid it in serialized reports.

equipment designators...

(U//FOUO) Include a description (in the text or in a footnote) the first time that you reference a piece of unfamiliar equipment by number. Zenda ordered 200 XYZ-91 radios (UHF 6-channel voice radio) for the Presidential Guard.

(U) Also see the entries for aircraft designators, ships, and weapon systems.

equitable...

(U) In today's world, the adjective equitable carries the meaning of "fairness to all concerned."

(U) See the entry for equal.

escalate...

(U//FOUO) 15-00000

(U) Although some consider it a fancy word for "raise" or "increase," it is now used figuratively to indicate a continuing and undesirable expansion in stages, with each stage provoking a further expansion. Its figurative sense is quite clear and causes no confusion. Use it freely.

especially...

(U) Use especially in the sense of "pre-eminently" or "particularly": He is especially qualified. Tact is important, especially now.

essential phrases and clauses...

(U) See the entry for restrictive elements

et al. ...

(U) Abbreviation of the Latin *et alia*, meaning "and others." Avoid it in serialized reports.

etc. ...

(U) Abbreviation for the Latin *et cetera*, meaning "and others of the same kind." Use it primarily within parenthetical expressions. Eat different kinds of vegetables (peas, carrots, etc.) every day.

(U) Do not use it at the end of a list introduced by "such as" or "for example."

(U) Do not use it with "and": WRONG: peas, carrots, and etc. RIGHT: peas, carrots, etc.

etymology...

(U) The study of the history of words or a statement about the origin and history of a word.

etymological fallacy...

(U) A term describing the insistence that a word in present-day English, derived from a foreign word must have the same meaning as the foreign word or must be limited in some way.

(U) An example is the word "dilapidated." Author Ambrose Bierce asserted that it should apply only to rundown stone structures because the Latin root word *lapis* means "stone." He asserted that "dilapidated" should not apply to structures made of other

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materials, such as wood. This approach is nonsense.

(U) The etymological approach is applied selectively by its adherents. For example, few of them object to "December" being used for the twelfth month, even though its Latin root is ten, or to "manure" being used to mean "dung," when its root originally was a French verb meaning "work the land by hand."

(U) Don't fall into the trap of thinking that the foreign root or spelling of a word must control the English meaning and usage. It just isn't true.

EURCOM...

(U) Now out of date. Instead, use East European.

euro...

(U) Do not capitalize.

even...

(U) If a sentence containing the adverb even is complex enough to cause confusion when it is read silently, put even directly in front of the word or phrase it modifies. This will help ensure clarity.

eventuate...

(U) Do not use this word in serialized reports.

every and its compounds...

(U) Every, everybody, and everyone are singular and take a singular verb. Everybody and everyone are single words when used in a collective sense. Everybody is playing a role. Everyone learns to read. Use two words when referring to each individual item. Every body of water is polluted. Every one of the clues was worthless.

(U) Usage is divided on whether a pronoun referring to an indefinite pronoun like everyone or everybody should be in the masculine singular (per the 18th-century grammarians), or in the plural (an option dating back to Chaucer). Everybody did their best. Everybody did his best.

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(U) See the entries for gender and for optional agreement.

everyplace, everywhere...

(U) Use **everywhere** rather than the informal **everyplace** as an adverb. *Everywhere I go, I see him. ~~Everywhere~~ need not be followed by "that."*

(U) **Everyplace** is acceptable in two-word form: *Lorraine searched in every place he had suggested*

evidence...

(U) As a verb, it is a very formal way of saying "show" or "exhibit." Avoid it in your reports.

evinces...

(U) Avoid this very formal word.

exactness...

(U) Exactness means using the word that will most correctly convey our meaning. It combines literal meaning (denotation), implied meaning (connotation), and degree of specificity. This allows the reader to grasp the intended meaning quickly and easily.

See the entries for brevity and clarity.

except...

(U) As a **preposition**, it means "with the exclusion of," and a following pronoun takes the accusative case. *They invited everyone except me.*

(U) As a **conjunction**, it means "if it were not for the fact that." *He would buy the suit, except that it costs too much.*

(U) As a **verb** it means "leave out" or "exclude." *The new laws except juveniles. Chances are this construction is not one you will need in serialized reports.*

See the entry for **accept**.

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exchange designator...

exercise...

(U) An exercise is military activity conducted to evaluate either training for war or concepts for the conduct of war.

(U) Even when limited to a single service, training may have homogeneous, interdependent communications support or a scenario simulating wartime or combat conditions. Control is usually at division level or higher, but may be at a lower level.

(U) An exercise includes all joint and combined activities regardless of control echelon. Contrast with training.

exercise names...

1. 11
2. 12 3. 13 4. 14

(U) See the entries for code words and for cover name, cover number.

expect...

(U) To expect is to look forward to the occurrence of something. It does not include the idea of preparation. We expect a record crowd.

(U) See the entry for anticipate.

explative...

(U) See the entry for obscenity.

EYES ONLY...

1. 11 2. 12 3. 13 4. 14

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Control Steward: Reporting Board, S12RH 953-6645
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12RD 953-6645

 *Reporting Page*

Last Modified: April 2, 2011
Last Control Edit Review: January 4, 2011

Controlled by: NSAC/IS Manual - 10, revised January 2007, originally by: 2010/10/10

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F

fact...

(U) A fact is a record of something that has taken place. Merriam-Webster offers several definitions, one of which is "a piece of information presented as having objective reality."

(U) In a serialized report, include all the relevant facts, even those that tend to refute your main points.

fact is, fact that...

(U) Phrases such as the fact is, the fact that, and in point of fact are used as transitions, but they can be eliminated more often than not.

- **Acceptable:** In point of fact, production improved because the factory solved several problems.
- **Better:** Production improved because the factory solved several problems.
- **Acceptable:** The fact that Rome fell as a result of moral decay is clear.
- **Better:** That Rome fell because of moral decay is clear.

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factory names...

(U) Translate the descriptive portion of the name, but leave the honorific in the original language: the Przyjazn Cotton Mill (not the Friendship Cotton Mill)

(U) See the entry for names

Fahrenheit...

(U) Do not use Fahrenheit temperatures in a serialized report except in a direct quotation. To convert to Celsius, subtract 32 from the Fahrenheit figure, multiply the result by 5, and then divide by 9.

familiar...

(U) Familiar with something; familiar to someone. Don't forget the "r" in the last syllable.

farther, farthest...

(U) Use farther when measuring distance: He walked farther into the woods. Use farther or farthest as an adjective only when literal or figurative distance is involved: The farthest target was 300 meters away.

(U) See the entry for further.

fateful...

(U) Fateful means "affecting one's destiny or future."

feel bad, feel badly...

(U) The controversy over feel bad and feel badly goes back more than 100 years and is not likely to be resolved soon. The decision to use one form or the other may be based on any one of the following theories:

(U) Some differentiate based on physical or mental state. Feel bad is used to refer to physical health; feel badly is used to refer to one's emotional state.

(U) Some follow the recommendations of 19th century handbooks to use badly after feel; some follow 20th century handbooks

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that tell you to use bad.

(U) Some argue that feel is a linking verb and must be followed by an adjective, not an adverb. But that isn't true. Several adverbs can qualify the degree or way of feeling. feel strongly about an issue, feel differently about a person.

(U) Usage supports all these positions. According to Merriam-Webster, although most school handbooks call for feel bad, most dictionaries and general usage books consider the expressions standard and interchangeable.

(U) Also see the entries for good and well.

feminine...

(U) In grammar, a term denoting gender. In English, words based on feminine gender are restricted to personal pronouns, some nouns (e.g., "doe" as opposed to "buck"), and nouns with certain suffix endings.

(U) See the entry for gender.

fewer...

(U) Use fewer with plural nouns or with things that can be counted: fewer children, fewer of the boys.

(U) Do not use fewer than to measure time, distance, or money, however. Less than (not fewer than) 4 hours remain until launch time. Dana has less than \$100.

(U) See the entry for less.

fewer than two. .

(U) The idiomatic construction fewer than two always takes a plural verb: Fewer than two runners have finished the race.

(U) See the entry for more than one.

field training exercise...

(U//~~FOUO~~) An exercise in which troops deploy to field locations, normally within the framework of a scenario. Abbreviate it as FTX.

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fighter-bomber...

(U) An aircraft that can function in either of two modes. Takes a hyphen figuratively...

(U) Figuratively means "expressed in a symbolic way" rather than in an exact sense. Example: It was raining cats and dogs.

(U) See the entry for literally.

finalize...

(U) The earliest citation for finalize according to Merriam-Webster, is Australian and dates back to 1922. The word reached the U.S. by 1927 and now is standard throughout the English-speaking world, primarily in business and official contexts.

(U) Finalize received heavy criticism from mid-20th century usage commentators, probably because of its origin in business and government writing. Although it is standard, its use does annoy pundits. Consider alternatives like complete, finish, conclude, or end.

(U) See the entry for -ize.

first, firstly...

(U) Use first, not "firstly," in a sequence. First can function as an adjective or an adverb.

(U) See the entry for ordinal numbers.

first person...

(U) Do not use "first person" phrasing in SIGINT reports. Do not state in a conclusion or comment, for example, that "we believe" or "we think."

first two, two first...

(U) The older construction is two first, which goes back to the 14th century. It appears much less often in 20th century prose

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(U) First two dates back to the 16th century and is the modern idiom: The first two gospels are attributed to Matthew and Mark.

FISINT...

(U/FOUO) FISINT (foreign instrumentation signals intelligence) is derived from electromagnetic emissions associated with the testing and operational deployment of non-U.S. aerospace, surface, and subsurface systems that may have either military or civilian application. It includes, but is not limited to, intercept and analysis of the signals from telemetry, beaconry, electronic interrogators, and video data links.

flagrant...

(U) Flagrant emphasizes wrong or evil that is glaring or notorious, and it carries a heavier moral censure than blatant. Therefore, one who willfully violates a pledge commits a flagrant act.

(U) When it means merely "conspicuous," it is interchangeable with blatant: a flagrant (or blatant) example.

(U) See the entry for blatant.

flammable...

(U) In American English, use flammable to describe a substance that will burn. Something that will not burn is nonflammable.

(U) Use inflammable to describe figuratively a situation or temperament that is subject to sudden escalation. The politics of the Middle East are inflammable.

flat adverbs...

(U) A flat adverb has the same form as its related adjective: e.g., "hard," as in He hit the ball hard, and "sure," as in You sure fooled me.

(U) Flat adverbs were common until Middle English, but began to be replaced in the 16th century due to the influence of grammarians of that time. Today most flat adverbs also have an "-ly" form, which is applicable in some cases while the flat adverb fits in others.

(U) The controversy over flat adverbs arises from the fact that in Latin the same word could not be used as an adjective and an adverb. Early grammarians simply imposed the Latin grammar structure on English, creating a great deal of confusion about what

was or was not "correct" in English grammar.

flaunt...

(U) To flaunt is to "exhibit ostentatiously" or "show off." She flaunted her diamonds.

(U) Since the 1940s, flaunt has frequently been used in the sense of "treat with contemptuous disregard." Even though this sense is very widespread, it draws the wrath of nearly all usage writers. Avoid it in SIGINT.

(U) See the entry for flout.

fleet..

(U) Capitalize when it is part of a name: The Sixth Fleet left yesterday.

flounder...

(U) As a verb, flounder means "move clumsily" or "flap about."

(U) See the entry for founder.

flout...

(U) Flout means "defy openly" or "treat with contemptuous disregard." She flouted the rules.

(U) See the entry for flaunt.

FNU...

(U) **Do not use** this abbreviation for "first name unknown."

L.O.B. ...

(U) See the entry for tree on board.

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following...

(U) Well-established as a preposition but disliked by some, who prefer "after"; She spoke following (or after) dinner.

(U) Following is often a counterpart to the preposition "during"; during the war, following the war.

FOLLOW-UP...

(U) See the complete entry for follow-up.

font...

(U) A term used in publishing to refer to type styles, weights, and sizes. When preparing a report using DTP techniques, use the fonts outlined in the Desktop Publishing Standards for SIGINT Reporting manual published by PDS

footer...

(U) Use footers in DTP-formatted reports to show the overall classification and the page number.

footnotes...

(U) See the complete entry for footnotes.

forced, forceful, forcible...

(U) Forced means "resulting from or compelled by an outside agent or situation"; a forced march, a forced landing.

(U) Forceful is used figuratively to describe something that suggests strength, forceful speech.

(U) Forcible applies to actions accomplished by means of actual physical force, a forcible arrest.

forego, forgo...

(U) Forego means "go before"; the foregoing item.

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(U) Forgo means “do without”: forgo the appointment.

foreign phrases and words...

(U/FOUO) Keep the use of foreign words and phrases to a minimum. Few of our readers are linguists.

(U) Where the capability exists, as in DTP-formatted reports, italicize any foreign word or phrase that may not be known to the average reader. Commonly recognized terms that need not be italicized include, but are not limited to,

- ad hoc
- attache
- blitzkrieg
- bona fide
- charge d'affaires
- communique
- coup d'etat
- de facto
- demarche
- detente
- fait accompli
- junta
- laissez faire
- per se
- persona non grata
- rapprochement
- versus
- vis-a-vis

former...

(U) Former refers to the first of two people or things. It is used less often than latter because of the distance between former and its referent. If more than two are involved, use the first, the second, etc.

(U) Remember that former is a convenience for the writer, not the reader. Do not use it if there is any chance that the reader will be confused.

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(U) Also see the entries for last, latest and for latter.

Fortuitous, fortunate...

(U) Fortuitous refers to something that happens by chance. A fortuitous event may be positive or negative.

[U] Fortunate means 'unlucky and positive.'

founder...

[U] It means "bog down, become disabled, or sink". The ship floundered for hours in the heavy seas, then lurched.

(U) See the entry for rebounder

FOXTROT...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "I "

fractions...

(U) If you must use fractions in text, spell out the amount, using hyphens between the words: two-thirds, one-eighth, two-thirds of the crowd.

(U) Whenever possible, convert fractions to a decimal form, especially when giving specific measurements: a 2 625 meter diameter pipe, a 1.7 kg warhead.

tree on board...

(U) Use a lognote to explain free on board. The seller agrees to put the merchandise on a means of transportation at no charge, but transportation costs from that point must be paid by the buyer.

(U) The abbreviation is f.o.b. Use it with periods, which is the common form of the abbreviation. You might confuse the reader if the periods are omitted.

FROG..

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(U//FOUO) The acronym for "Free Rocket Over Ground" in a report that generically discusses missiles and artillery, it might be appropriate to expand FROG.

(U) Do not refer to a FROG as a missile. Avoid the redundant FROG rocket.

(U) Although the acronym FROG spells an English word, it does not take periods. Your reader is not likely to confuse it with the amphibian. Capitalize all letters in FROG.

from . . . through...

(U) Use from . . . through to provide a precise and inclusive date or time range: from 0800Z through 0940Z, from 15 May through 26 May.

from . . . to...

(U) Always use from . . . to when expressing a non-inclusive range: from 20 to 26 May, from two to eternity, from noon to midnight.

(U) Do not use a hyphen between dates or use "and" with from, WRONG: from 7-10 July; from 7 and 10 July.

(U) See the entry for between and

further...

(U) Use further to express an extension of time or degree: Mini will look further into the mystery.

(U) In general prose further is also beginning to replace farther as an adverb when spatial, temporal, or metaphysical distance is involved, although many usage books continue to recommend farther.

(U) Use further in the sense of **additional**: Further efforts will not yield better results.

(U) See the entry for farther.

fuse, fuze...

(U) Use fuze to discuss a military detonation device. To describe all detonating devices other than those in a projectile, torpedo,

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or bomb. Use fuse.

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Content Steward: Reporting Board: E12RB, 063-5645
Page Finalizer: Reporting Board: E12RB, 063-5645

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Last Modified: March 3, 2011
Last Content Edit Review: January 4, 2011

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G

gauge, gauge...

(U) A gauge is a "standard of measurement" or "an instrument used to measure something."

(U) The word gauge, which is not likely to appear in SIGINT, means a "security" or "pledge."

gender...

(U) When talking about a specific person, use a term appropriate to that person: chairman Jones, chairwoman Doe.

(U) Use neutral terms when talking about mixed groups or persons whose identity has not been established: members of the Assembly, rather than Assemblymen; a member of Congress rather than a Congressman.

(U) Do not change an official title to a neutral term. If the official title is "Party Chairman," use that term: don't say "Party Chairperson."

(U) For pronouns, the problem is different. Modern English does not have gender-neutral pronouns for people.

(U) When a pronoun must be used and the gender of its antecedent is not known or can refer to persons of either sex, there are four three choices the writer can make, all of which are acceptable in SIGINT sanitized reports:

1. He or she

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- 1 Use the plural pronoun: Everyone ~~hopes they~~ will win the contest.
- 2 Place the whole sentence in the plural: All people hope they will win the contest.
- 3 Rewrite the sentence and eliminate the personal pronoun: Everyone hopes to win the contest.

(U) See the entries for chair and its compounds, notional agreement, -person, and they, their, them.

general secretary...

(U) Capitalize when used as a formal title before a name or when referring to a national-level office: General Secretary Gorbachev; the General Secretary is here.

generalities...

(U) Use a specific number rather than terms such as "most" or "some." Try to quantify, if possible, terms such as "extensive" and "significant" when they precede the word "number."

(U) Avoid generalities as often as possible, but remember that there are times when a general word will be more appropriate than a specific one.

(U) See the entry for *majority*.

generic terms...

(S/FOUO) (U) (U)

(U/FOUO) Subject to the provisions of USSID SP0018 and DO policy, use generic terms [redacted]

(U/FOUO) Consult the U.S. Identities in SIGINT manual for complete guidance.

genitive...

(U) The genitive case is used in English primarily to show possession: my son.

(U) Only pronouns have specific genitive forms, always without an apostrophe.

(S/FOUO) (U) (U)

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(U) See the entry for case.

geographic coordinates...

(U) See the entry for coordinates

geographic references: cities...

(U/~~FOUO~~) Mention a city and country pair together once in each report, usually the first mention in the text. It is not necessary to repeat the country each subsequent time you use the city name. Examples: Port-au-Prince, Haiti; Akita, Japan.

(U/~~FOUO~~) Country names are not required to be paired with well-known capitals and other cities well-known to the average reader, such as Tokyo and Munich. If there is any chance that the reader could be confused, then the country must be given. Ensure that the country name is included in the report at least one time, either in the title or the text, even in the case of a capital or well-known city. Examples: "... meetings will be held in France in August at the Place de Concorde in Paris" the European leaders gathered in Vaduz, Liechtenstein; Windhoek, Namibia.

(U) See entries for coordinates, and geographic references: regions

geographic references: regions...

(U/~~FOUO~~) Regional references require the country or countries be specified at least once. Examples, the Great Rift Valley, Kenya; Provence, France.

(U/~~FOUO~~) Regions that cross national boundaries should always be identified to specify the country or countries involved. Examples: the Sahara Desert area in Algeria, the Indian Ocean territorial waters of Somalia and Kenya; the Alps of France, Switzerland, and Italy.

(U) See entries for coordinates, and geographic references: cities.

gerund...

(U) A gerund is a verb form that functions as a noun and ends in "-ing." It may take an object (running a hotel) or a complement (being a hero). It may serve as a subject (Eating is fun), object (He taught skiing,) or predicate noun (Seeing is believing).

(U) The subject of a gerund usually is in the possessive form: I don't approve of their drinking. When the subject of a gerund is

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stressed, however, use the accusative case: I don't approve of them drinking.

{U} See the entry for participle.

get, got...

{U} The use of got with a past participle—as in He got drunk—was condemned by 19th century grammarians, who suggested "was," "were," or "became" instead. Sometimes making the substitution will change the meaning of the sentence, so be careful.

{U} The phrase have got to is common in speech, but replace it in writing with "have to" or "must": ORAL: I have got to win.
 WRITTEN: I must win or I have to win.

{U} In writing, do not use get or get to in place of "start" or "begin." WRONG: When I get to thinking about it, I get confused.
 RIGHT: When I start thinking about it, I get confused.

go and...

{U} Most commonly a speech idiom used to emphasize a following verb. Go and find your brother. The construction dates back to the 13th century. Among the authors who have used it are Johnson, Byron, Austen, Carroll, and Frost.

{U} Although it is acceptable in speech and general writing, it is not used in formal writing. Avoid it in serialized reports.

go-between...

{U} Hyphenate it when used as a noun meaning "messenger" or "intermediary."

GOLF...

{U} Phonetic spelling of the letter "g."

good...

{U} Good used after a linking verb such as be, feel, or sound is most often an adjective. The apple tastes good. I feel good today. The new stereo sounds good. Use it after the verb "feel" to indicate good health or good spirits.

{U} Good has been used as an adverb since the 13th century, but today occurs mostly in speech, where it is used for emphasis.

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(U) See the entry for well.

goodwill...

(U) **Goodwill** is a single word when it describes a business asset or when it is used as an adjective, a goodwill gesture.

(U) As two words, it indicates kindness or friendliness: Peace to men of good will.

government...

(U) **Government**, as a political term, refers to an established system of political administration. In American usage, it takes a singular verb; in British usage, it takes a plural verb.

(U) See the entry for regime.

government of words...

(U) Refers to the way one word requires another to take a particular form. In English, it applies mostly to pronouns which, as objects of a verb or preposition, must be in the accusative (or objective) case: a friend to me; send them to her.

grammar...

(U) The study of classes of words, their inflection, and their relationship in a sentence. Grammar allows the writer to communicate specific meanings to a reader through a shared understanding of the way a language works. The first English grammar was written by William Bulloker in 1588.

(U) Current English grammar is derived from the grammatical structure of Latin. Early grammarians simply applied grammatical terms and forms of Latin to English. Many so-called usage problems arose from the attempt to fit English forms into a Latin context.

(U) Grammar may be approached either as prescriptive (i.e., how one should or should not use the language) or descriptive (how people actually use the language). These different approaches also account for many usage issues.

(U) See the entry for rules of grammar.

graphic...

See the entry for graphic.

(U) Generic term for a picture, table, or chart used in a serialized report. Do not include graphics just because they are available. Use them when they will enhance the reader's understanding.

(U) Graphics are produced more easily when using DTP methods.

gray, grey...

(U) Americans prefer gray.

ground attack training...

(U) Not hyphenated.

group...

(U) Group takes singular verbs and pronouns when acting as or considered as a unit: The group is reviewing its position.

(U) Use the plural forms when describing the actions of the individuals who make up the group: The group were divided in their sympathies.

(U) See the entry for notional agreement.

guerrilla...

(U) Preferred spelling. The alternate spelling is guerilla.



Content Steward: Reporting Board: 312RU, 983-5647
Page Publisher: Reporting Board: 312RU, 983-5645



Last Modified: August 20, 2001
Last Overall Site Review: July 4, 2001

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H

hackneyed phrases...

(U) Be sparing in the use of phrases such as "conducted operations" and "likely scenario."

half...

(U) When half, as a noun or adjective, is followed by a singular noun, it takes a singular verb: Half of the person was left in the container. If followed by a plural noun, it takes a plural verb: Half of the boys have arrived.

(U) The proper phrases in writing are a half, half a, or half an: a half-dollar, half an hour. Do not use "a half a" or "a half an," which are oral idioms only.

(U) After verbs such as cut, break, and fold, use half: cut in half. Some commentators still recommend "halves" (cut in halves), but it is used less frequently.

hard copy...

(U) Two words when used as a noun: That document is available in hard copy. Hyphenate when it is used attributively to modify another noun: Prepare a hard-copy report on this subject.

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(U) See the entries for hard-copy report and serialization block.

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hard-copy report...

hardly...

(U) It is not true that hardly has the force of a negative. If you think it does, then try substituting a real negative in the following sentence: I hardly studied at all. A true negative, such as I didn't study at all, does not have the same meaning. Hardly approaches a negative, but it is not the same as one.

(U) Purists argue that we should avoid using hardly with a negative because that produces a double negative. In fact, hardly with a negative produces a **weaker** negative, not a double negative.

(U) Phrases like can't hardly and don't hardly are a feature of speech. These phrases appear in writing only in fictional speech or first-person narration.

hardly . . . when...

(U) When hardly is followed by a clause, use when or before instead of "then". We were hardly asleep **when** (or **before**) the shots rang out.

hassle...

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(U) **Hassle** as a verb or noun is common in general prose but not acceptable in SIGINT serialized reports.

head-on...

(U) Hyphenate as both an adjective and an adverb. It means "facing forward" and usually is used to describe an attack in which two parties are heading toward each other.

header...

(U) A header appears at the top of each page of a hard-copy report and includes the classification, compartmentation markings, and serialization block.

headings..

(U) Use section headings in the report body to distinguish clearly what information each section provides. Section headings can appear whenever a report contains four or more paragraphs, but generally appear only in lengthy reports.

(U) The heading title "Summary" is acceptable in the "CONTENTS" section but omit it in the text.

(U) Use the heading "DETAILS" to separate the body from the lead/summary. Within the body of the report, use specific section headings (or subtitles) that accurately describe the information.

headquarters...

(U) Always plural in form, but usually takes a singular verb: Company headquarters has given the bivouac dates to the battalion commander. The correct abbreviation is HQ, not HQS or Hq or Hqs.

helicopter...

(U) Treat helicopters just like other aircraft. See the entry for aircraft.

hemisphere...

(U) Capitalize only when referring to a specific geographic area: Northern Hemisphere.

U S C I P O P O S

5/7/2010

henceforth...

{U} Use *it* from now on.

he or she...

{U} Do not use the phrase *he or she* in serialized reports. See the entry for *gender*.

her...

{U} Use *it* or *its* when referring to ships or nations. *Her* is British usage.

hertz...

{U} The international unit of frequency measurement. It equals one cycle per second. Under the provisions of the *Système International (SI)*, which we popularly call the "metric system," the abbreviation for *hertz*, like other abbreviations based on proper names, is capitalized (Hz).

{U} Under the SI, the abbreviations for prefixes mega (M), giga (G), and tera (T) are **always** capitalized. Thus the correct abbreviation for megahertz is MHz and for gigahertz is GHz, but kilohertz is kHz and millihertz is mHz.

{U} See *Abbreviations & Acronyms* for information on how and when to abbreviate SI measurements.

high, highly...

{U} Use *high* for literal and figurative distance up: *aims high*, *rose high*.

{U} *Highly* denotes position on a scale and is used as an intensifier before adjectives and participles: *highly placed*, *highly successful*.

highlighted by...

{U} Though by many to be overused, although there is no proof of that.

{U} See the entry for *characterized by*.

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his or her...

(U) Avoid the phrase his or her in SIGINT reports. See the entry for gender.

historic, historical...

(U) Historic means "famous in history" or "having considerable importance". The battle of Hastings was a historic event.

(U) Historical means "belonging to history" or "based on history." Use historical when you refer generally to events of the past, whether important or not: She provided a historical review of serfdom.

NOTE: (U) Use "a" before historic and historical since each begins with an aspirated "h": a historic battle, a historical character.

home base, home port...

(U) Two words.

home in on...

(U) The phrase home in on is correct. "Home in on" is a nonstandard variant.

hopefully...

(U) The earliest attested use of hopefully as a sentence adverb dates to 1932, but it didn't become popular until the early 1960s. It drew loud and heavy criticism in the mid-1960s and continued as a major issue until the late 1970s, when most commentators ended their opposition.

(U) If you use it, understand that you will raise the hackles of punsters. Hopefully bothers them because it is an adverb, yet is commonly used without an adjective or verb to modify. Hopefully, the decision will be made soon.

(U) In grammatical terms, hopefully is an ellipsis (for "speaking hopefully") used as a sentence adverb--a type of construction that has been good English since at least the 16th century--and is paralleled by such adverbs as realistically, frankly, truthfully, and regrettably. Frankly, my dear, I don't give a dam. Truthfully, the punists are ideologues.

(U) See the entry for sentence adverb.

U S T O I L S . G O V

3/7/2010

HOTEL..

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "h."

however...

(U) When followed by a comma, however is equivalent to "yet" or "nevertheless". However, the battle was not a total loss.

(U) When however is not followed by a comma, it takes the meaning "in whatever way". However he tried, he could not make it work. Ellen will finish the race, however difficult it may be.

(U) Most writers consider but and however to be redundant when placed side by side, but many accept them when they are separated by several words: But the death of General Zog and the loss of the high ground did not mean final defeat, however.

(U) Be sure to enclose however within a pair of commas when it separates two parts of a single independent clause: His choice, however, was the wrong one.

(U) Use a semicolon and comma when two independent clauses are involved: Lynnette said she loved me; however, it was a lie human...

(U) This noun has been standard for 450 years, even though (for some strange reason) many writers prefer "human being."

hyphen...

(U) See the complete entry for hyphen for rules on when to hyphenate words.

hyphenate...

(U) Used more often as a verb than "hyphen."



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“go reporting”

(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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I

I...

(U) Do not use I as the object of a preposition. **WRONG:** between you and I **RIGHT:** between you and me

(U) See the entry for first person

Idea that...

(U) Try not to use the idea that, which can make a sentence wordy. **ACCEPTABLE:** The idea that space travel is near excites me. **IMPROVED:** That space travel is near excites me.

Idiom...

(U) An idiom is an expression in language that is peculiar to itself either grammatically or in meaning. An example is "hit the roof," which has nothing to do with striking the top of a building, but rather means "react with great anger to some event or situation." Many of the criticisms and objections made by usage commentators are attempts to correct idioms, especially those originating in the United States.

(U) Idioms are not subject to logical analysis, however, and the criticisms are not valid. Idiomatic phrases are quite normal and acceptable in English. Don't let purists tell you otherwise.

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i.e. ...

(U) Abbreviation for the Latin *id est*, which means "that is." Use it sparingly, and only in parenthetical statements. Only one baseball team, i.e. the New York Yankees, has participated in more than 25 World Series competitions.

(U) Add a comma after i.e. only if the sense of the sentence requires one. The comma is not always necessary.

if...

(U) It is irreplaceable in conditional statements: If he apologizes, I'll accept.

(U) It is preferred to "whether" when doubt or uncertainty is involved. Ask her if she will come.

(U) Either if or whether can be used to introduce a noun clause. The idea that if is not correct in such cases arose in 1762, but has never reflected actual usage or the views of most grammarians. Only a few commentators today consider if wrong.

(U) Use whether rather than if when infinitives identify alternatives: Fred didn't know whether to make dinner or go out for pizza.

(U) See the entry for whether.

illegal, illegitimate, illicit...

(U) An illegal action violates a law or rule.

(U) An illicit action may or may not be illegal, but in some sense is not permitted by custom or community standards.

(U) Use illegitimate for things that violate the rules of evidence or logic: an illegitimate conclusion.

illusion..

(U) An unreal or false impression: The administration tried to create the illusion of prosperity.

(U) See the entry for allude, blusion.

imagery...

See the entry for >

(U) The phrase according to imagery is acceptable in a serialized report. Ensure that appropriate caveats and markings are placed on reports that include imagery.

immigrant, immigrate...

(U) One who enters a country immigrates and is an immigrant.

(U) See emigrate, emigrant.

impact...

(U) Contrary to the popular belief that the noun impact became a verb in the mid-20th century, impact was a verb in English before it was a noun. The earliest citation for it as a verb dates back to 1601. Figurative use of the verb began in literary circles after World War II, and it became very popular after 1970 in business and government circles.

(U) As a verb, impact now is standard, although you need not use it. Alternative choices include, but are not limited to, affect, hurt, and delay.

impassable, impassible...

(U) Impassable means "incapable of being crossed or traversed."

(U) Impassible means "incapable of suffering or experiencing pain."

impeach...

(U) Impeach means "make an accusation against" or "charge with an offense." Many people, however, think it means "remove from office." If you use impeach in a serialized report, make sure the context allows the reader to know which sense you are using.

implicit comparative...

(U) A term used to identify a small group of words that were comparatives in Latin and function the same way in English. They are not true English comparatives because they cannot be used with "than." They include major, minor, interior, superior, junior, and senior.

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imply...

(U) Imply means "state something indirectly." Authors and lects imply. It is from the Latin "implicare" meaning "fold in."

(U) ~~Imply~~ used with a personal subject to express the sense of "hint" was considered offensive in the late 19th and early 20th centuries and now is rarely used in print. EXAMPLE: What are you ~~implying~~ by that?

(U) See the entry for infer.

important, importantly...

(U) Either more important or more importantly may be used as a sentence modifier.

impracticable, impractical...

(U) Impracticable means "not capable of being done." Living on Mars is impracticable without life-support systems.

(U) Impractical means "not sensible or prudent," whether it can be done or not: Searching for oil beneath Manhattan is impractical.

in, into...

(U) In shows location and can be used with some verbs of motion: She is in the office. Go jump in the lake!

(U) Into shows direction or movement and gives prominence to the entrance: She is going into the office. The ship sailed into the harbor.

in accordance with...

(U) Use this phrase sparingly. It can be replaced by phrases like in line with, in keeping with, etc.

Inasmuch as...

(U) A lengthier way of saying since, as, or because

inception...

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

{U} Try start, beginning, or introduction, or use a verb.

incident...

{U} An incident is a minor occurrence or an event of only momentary significance. A border incident occurred when a small patrol moved into the neutral zone for 15 minutes.

{U} Do not use incident to describe a major catastrophe or conflict. Invasions and earthquakes are not incidents.

include...

{U} A list of items after the verb include may consist of one item, several items, or all items. Fowler points out that "with include there is no presumption (though it is often the fact) that all or even most of the components are mentioned": His auto collection includes a 1962 MG.

{U} When all items are given, some commentators recommend using "comprise": Janet's collection comprises an MG, a Corvette, and a Ferrari. But include is not wrong in such cases.

{U} See compose and comprise.

in conjunction with...

{U} Often can be replaced by with.

incredible, incredulous...

{U} Incredible means "unbelievable": an incredible story.

{U} Incredulous means "skeptical" or "expressing disbelief." Only people can be incredulous.

indefinitely...

{U} It means "for a long time," not "forever." Do not use the modifier "more or less" with indefinitely.

indentation...

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(U) In serialized reports, begin a paragraph or footnote in the sixth space from the left margin. (If your software uses proportional spacing and that will make a difference, begin .5 inch from the left margin.)

(U) Begin each line of a separate COMMENT paragraph in the sixth space so that the COMMENT stands out more clearly from the report body.

(U) You may also place the report lead within wider margins, in hard copy, to differentiate it from the report body.

(U) ~~FOUO~~ See USSID CR1400 and the Desktop Publishing Standards for SIGINT Reporting manual for additional instructions.

index...

(U) For standardization, use the plural form *indexes*, which is a linguistic term, rather than the equally valid form *indices*, which is used in mathematical senses.

INDIA...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "i."

indiscreet, indiscrete...

(U) The adjective *indiscreet* means "lacking prudence." Its noun is *indiscretion*.

(U) The adjective *indiscrete* means "not divisible into distinct parts." Its noun form is *indiscreteness*.

individual...

(U) As a noun meaning "a person," use it to distinguish one person from a group, the individual's right to dissent from the majority view.

(U) When the contrast is not evident, it almost always carries the sense of one person considered separately: Each individual is responsible.

(U) Do not use it as a general substitute for "person." **POOR:** Two individuals were hurt. **BETTER:** Two persons were hurt.

(U) See the entry for *person*.

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infer...

(U) Infer has three main uses. The first dates back to 1526, and it means "draw a conclusion from a set of facts or evidence." It is always done by the reader or listener, never by a speaker or writer. The second sense of infer first appeared in 1533 and means the same as "imply." It is never used with a human subject. (Both these meanings have been traced to Thomas More.) The third use is that of infer with a personal subject and is known as "personal infer." It first appeared in 1896.

(U) The controversy over infer and imply began in 1917 but did not become extensive until after World War II. The issue began with an injunction against the use in speech of infer with a personal subject, where it had the meaning "hint" or "suggest." It may have replaced imply, which in that sense is considered offensive.

(U) According to Merriam-Webster, the objection to "personal infer" was social, since "personal infer" was associated with the speech of uncultured persons.

(U) Dictionaries did not support the distinction that critics were trying to make. This led many commentators to distrust the dictionaries. But dictionaries are based on written works, and Merriam-Webster notes only one written use of "personal infer" prior to the 1950s.

(U) What commentators object to is chiefly an oral use, not a written one. Nevertheless, many writers have taken to heart the distinction drawn by the commentators, and the 1533 sense of infer, while standard, is now infrequent.

(U) See the entry for imply.

infinitive...

(U) The infinitive is the simple form of the verb and may be used as a noun or modifier. The preposition "to" occurs often with the infinitive, but the preposition is not part of it.

(U) The assumption that "to" is part of the infinitive dates back to the 18th century and has given us two usage controversies. See the entries for split infinitive and for try and, try to.

ingenious, ingenuous...

(U) Ingenious means "clever" or "skillful."

(U) Ingenuous means "innocent" or "naive."

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initials...

(U) Leave a space between the initials of a person's name. J. F. Kennedy, C. S. Lewis. Omit the space when listing a country name or an organization: U.S., USSR, WHO, NASA.

(U) See Appendix * for further guidance.

injuries...

(U) They are "suffered" or "sustained." Better yet: was injured.

in lieu of...

(U) Instead, try instead.

In order to...

(U) To can sometimes be a simpler alternative, but be careful that the sense and emphasis of the sentence or phrase are not affected.

Inquire, inquiry...

(U) Use the American spelling. Enquire is British.

in regard to...

(U) Use "about" or "concerning" whenever doing so improves the sentence. NOTE: (U) "In regards to" is an oral use.

inside, inside of...

(U) Use inside to indicate position or location. inside the house

(U) Inside of is commonly used with time, but can be replaced by "within" or "less than": I will be there inside of an hour or I will be there within an hour (or in less than an hour)

in the event of...



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insofar as...

(U) Try as far as.

In spite of...

(U) Whenever possible use "despite," which means the same and is shorter.

Instances...

(U) Instead of in many instances, consider "frequently" or "often" as alternatives.

insure...

(U) In serialized reports, use insure to mean "protect against financial loss."

(U) See entries for assure and ensure.

intelligence source identifier...

(U) See the entry for ISI.

intense, intensive...

(U) The adjective intense describes an inherent characteristic that is extreme in degree: the intense heat of the sun.

(U) Intensive carries the special meaning of "concentrated" and tends to connote something applied from the outside: intensive study.

intensives...

(U) An intensive is a word or phrase used to emphasize the meaning of other words. Adjectives and adverbs used as intensives include much, very, too, slightly, and extremely.

(U) Do not overuse intensives; overuse reduces the impact.

U//FOUO (U//FOUO)

5/7/2010

inter-, intra...

(U) The prefix inter- means "between or among two or more things": intergalactic occurs between (or among) galaxies.

(U) Intra- means "within one specific thing": Intragalactic means within a single galaxy.

inter alia...

(U) A Latin phrase meaning "among others." Use the English phrase.

intercept...

(U) Avoid using this word in serialized reports to refer to message traffic.

interesting...

(U) Avoid the phrase It is interesting to note. Your reader may not agree with your assessment of what is interesting. Simply provide the fact and let the reader decide what is, or isn't, interesting.

Internet, internet...

(U) a shortened form of the word internetwork, "internetwork" is now not used at all.

(U) When using the word to refer to the collection of global, public networks and gateways using the TCP/IP protocols to communicate, capitalize Internet as a proper noun or adjective. When referring generically to any group of interconnected networks (the original meaning), use lower case. INTERNET (all caps) is not correct.

interpolation...

(U) Interpolation is the insertion of material into a text. Use parentheses to indicate the interpolation of material in electrical or hard-copy reports: When the President (of Zendia) arrived, President Smith greeted her warmly.

(U) When inserting information in quoted material, use a double set of parentheses. Prime Minister Lakhich threatened that her government would "annex the province ((of Usagia)) immediately."

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in the event that. .

(U) Use **if** or **in case** whenever possible.

in the month of...

(U) Generally use **in** or **during**.

Involve...

(U) Sometimes misused. Rephrase the sentence to eliminate it, or replace **involve** with another word or phrase whenever possible.

- **COMMON:** The attack involved an aircraft flying at 5000 meters.
- **BETTER:** In the attack, the aircraft flew at 5000 meters.
- **COMMON:** the deployments involved helicopters.
- **BETTER:** the deployments by helicopters

Irregardless...

(U) Not accepted in formal English despite its existence in speech (and occasionally in edited prose) for at least 80 years. It continues to be roundly condemned by almost all usage commentators as a sign of ignorance.

(U) In serialized reports, use **regardless**. See the entry for **regardless**.

irregular verbs...

(U) Irregular verbs are those whose past and past participle forms do not take the standard ending -d or -ed. Many irregular verbs also change the middle vowel in the past and past participle: sing, sang, sung.

(U) Consult the Merriam-Webster dictionaries for proper forms of irregular verbs.

irrespective...

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(U) Irrespective of means "without consideration of other factors": Irrespective of our competitor's plans, we will develop this new product.

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ISI...

~~(U//SI)~~

~~(U//SI)~~

~~(U//SI)~~ Include an ISI on all serialized reports except:

-

(U//FOUO) See USSID 315 for further guidance.

Island...

(U) Capitalize as part of a name: Hawaiian Islands

isle...

(U) Valid only when it is part of a name: the Isle of Man. Otherwise use island.

it...

(U) Use *it* rather than "she" in reference to a ship or nation

(U) Also see the entry for its/it's

italics...

(U) In a DTP-formatted report, use italics for ship names, uncommon foreign words, names of reference works, etc.: USS

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J

jargon...

(U) The special vocabulary and idioms of a particular class or occupational group. To non-members of the group, the words and syntax can be confusing because they do not follow standard English. Since clarity is the most important principle in SIGINT reporting, use SIGINT jargon sparingly.

(U) If the meaning of a SIGINT word or phrase may be unfamiliar to some readers, include an explanation either in the text or in a footnote.

jihad...

(U) Preferred transliteration of the Arabic word for "holy war."

joint...

(U) Military training or exercises in which elements of more than one service of the same nation participate. When not all of the services are involved, specify which ones are participating: joint Army-Navy.

(U) Distinguish joint from combined, which means more than one nation participates: a combined French-Danish exercise.

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journalese...

(U) A general, non-technical pejorative term for the way in which journalists write or are thought to write. Language purists look down on journalese as bad writing, preferring a literary style over the immediacy of journalese.

(U) Journalese is a term often used to describe newspapers and magazines that are more interested in "popular" themes (such as gossip, sports, social events, and sensational stories) rather than in-depth stories and complex events. Such newspapers and magazines generally are aimed at a less-educated audience.

(U) SIGINT reporters should be wary of some pitfalls of journalese: unnecessary and excessive modifiers, clichés, word inflation or inaccurate use, sensationalism, and the injection of comment or opinion without identifying it as such.

journalism...

(U) Journalism, at its best and most serious, is a writing style in which the writer provides a clear, direct presentation of the facts or the occurrences and clearly identifies what is interpretation. Active verbs, short paragraphs, and a "semi-literary" style are characteristics of journalism.

(U) In journalism, unlike literature, the emphasis is on presentation of the important facts at the beginning of the article, with lesser facts and full details following.

(U) Serious journalism is directed at a literate audience and includes newspapers like The New York Times and the Wall Street Journal and magazines like National Review and The Nation.

Judgment, judgement...

(U) In serialized reports, do not insert an "e" after the "g." Stick with the more common American spelling, although judgement is a valid alternative.

judicial, judicious...

(U) Judicial refers to legal judgments or issues: a judicial decree, a judicial decision.

(U) Judicious refers to the mental faculty of sound judgment: a judicious approach to the problem.

Julian date...

U//FOUO

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(U) See the entry for ordinal date.

JULIETT...

(U) Phonetic spelling for the letter "J."

junta...

(U) A small group holding state power after a coup d'etat. A junta ordinarily consists of military officers, but it may include civilians as well.

justification...

(U) Refers to the vertical alignment of text in a report. Most ODP packages provide automatic justification of text for both left and right margins.

(U) When automatic justification is not possible, use left justification.



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Content: Standard Reporting Board, S12RB 980-5615
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12RB 960-5645



Reporting Page

Last Modified: April 2, 2000
Last Created by Review: January 4, 2000

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K

karat...

(U) A unit of fineness for gold. Do not mistake it for carat, a unit of weight for precious stones.

KILO...

(U) Phonetic spelling for the letter "k."

kilogram...

(U) Abbreviated as "kg." Always use numbers when expressing a weight in kilograms: 500 kg.

(U) A kilogram equals 2.2 pounds. A metric ton equals 1,000 kg.

kilohertz...

(U) A unit of measurement that equals 1,000 hertz. The abbreviation is kHz.

(U) See the entry for hertz.

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kilometer...

(U) Equals approximately five-eighths (.625) of a mile. In serialized reports, use kilometers (abbreviated km) for distance and kilometers per hour (kph) for speed: The unit moved 26 km to the west. The aircraft flew at a computed average ground speed of 650 kph.

(U) Kilometer may be pronounced with the stress on either the first or second syllable.

(U) See the entries for knot and nautical mile for how to report ship speeds and distances. See the entry for Mach for how to report certain aircraft speeds.

kind of...

(U) An idiom ordinarily used in speech as a modifier. In writing, replace it with "somewhat" or "rather" when it serves as a modifier. ORAL: The story is kind of weird. WRITTEN: The story is rather weird.

(U) In writing, use a kind of, which means "a species of," rather than "kind of a," which is an oral idiom and is used much less frequently. ORAL: He is kind of a human shield. WRITTEN: He is a kind of human shield.

kind(s) of thing...

(U) The general rule for American English is to use this kind of thing (or that kind of thing) when speaking of only one kind of thing and to use these kinds of things (or those kinds of things) when speaking of two or more kinds of things.

(U) The idiom these kind of (or those kind of) followed by a plural noun is well-established in British usage, but less so in American usage. Americans should not use it in serialized reports.

knot...

(U) A unit of speed equivalent to 1 nautical mile per hour. Ship speeds are in knots. Do not use the redundant phrase "knots per hour." For distances, use nautical miles.

(U) See the entries for kilometer, nautical mile, and Mach.

know-how...

U//FOUO

(U) Means a kind of practical knowledge and skill that allows one to solve problems and get things done. It is most useful in contexts concerning business and technology. Always include the hyphen,

kudos.

(U) Although it looks plural, the Greek word kudos is etymologically singular and takes a singular verb when it is used as a mass noun, like "glory" or "prestige": Kudos is due her for her efforts. This is the common literary use of the word.

(U) In the 1920s, kudos came to be understood in English as a plural count noun: The boss gave kudos to everyone who had helped on the project. In the 1950s, the single count noun kudo appeared as a back formation from kudos: Rhonda received a kudo for her fine work.

(U) In general prose, the singular noun kudo and the plural count noun kudos have become quite common, but these forms have not become part of literature.



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Content Steward: Reporting Board, 512RB 563 5645
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, 512RB 563 5645



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Last Modified: May 7, 2009
Last Overall SAC Review: January 4, 2011

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L

laissez faire...

(U) Two words. Does not need to be italicized in hard-copy reports.

landscape orientation...

(U) Landscape or horizontal orientation means that the page width is greater than its length. It is often used in hard-copy reports for charts and for order-of-battle information.

(U) See portrait orientation.

language...

(U) Although there are some grammarians and others who hold that language is unchanging and that written language is the best form, this view has never been held by most writers and scholars.

(U) In 1952, the National Council of Teachers of English issued a statement outlining five precepts about language, precepts that have been acknowledged at least as far back as Samuel Johnson.

- language changes constantly

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- change is normal
- spoken language is the language
- correctness rests upon usage
- all usage is relative

(U) See the entry on usage for further discussion

last, latest...

(U) Latest means the "most recent" in a series: Did you hear the latest story?.

(U) Last refers to the final element in a series: Last of the Mohicans. Be careful not to use it to mean "most recent" unless the context makes the meaning very clear. POOR: The last weather forecast said it would rain tomorrow. IMPROVED: The latest weather forecast said it would rain tomorrow.

(U) When modifying a noun denoting time (week, night, etc.), the idiom requires last, even though the meaning is "most recent": last night, last week

latitude, longitude...

(U) Express the coordinates for latitude and longitude in degrees and minutes (and, when appropriate, in seconds).

(U) For most coordinates, report latitude in four digits and longitude in five digits, using leading zeros as needed: Gotham City (0001N 00001W).

(U) See the entry for coordinates

latter...

(U) Latter is used more frequently than former because the referent is much closer. While most often used with two items, latter can be used with a series of three or more, especially in general prose.

(U) Remember that former and latter are conveniences for the writer, not the reader. Omit them and repeat the original words or

phrases, where necessary, to prevent any confusion on the part of readers.

lay...

(U) Means "put" or "place." The verb forms lay, laid, and laid are transitive, meaning that they take a direct object: We laid the table for four.

(U) See the entry for lie.

lead, led...

(U) The past tense of the verb lead is "led," not "lead."

leaders...

(U) Leaders are a series of spaced periods used to guide the reader's eye across a page. They are used most often in tables and in a table of contents.

leave...

(U) Leave means "go out of" or "go away from." Purists argue that leave alone is acceptable only in the sense of leaving someone in solitude: They left him alone in the wilderness.

(U) Nevertheless, few people will be confused if you use leave alone to mean "restrain from disturbing or interfering": Leave me alone.

(U) See the entry for let.

left...

(U) Capitalize it when referring to the group of people who profess leftist political views. Note, however, that "leftist" is not capitalized.

(U) See the entry for right.

left turn...

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(U) Use left turn, not "left-hand turn."

lend...

(U) In **SIGINT**, use **lend** as a verb. **Lend** is required in figurative uses: "Friends? Romans? Countrymen? **Lend** me your ears." See the entry for **loan**.

NOTE: (U) **Lend** has been used as a noun since the end of the 16th century, though not in ordinary American English.

less...

(U) Use **less** to answer the question "How much?" and **fewer** to answer the question "How many?" Use **less** before a noun of mass: **less** wheat.

(U) Use **less** than before a noun denoting a measurement of time, money, or distance: **less** than 3 hours; **less** than \$100.00; **less** than 5 kilometers.

(U) See the entry for **fewer**.

let...

(U) **Let** means "allow or permit" something: **Let** the games begin. It also means "not disturbing or interfering with someone or something": **Let** him go.

(U) See the entry for **leave**.

levels of usage...

(U) Most grammars and usage books use terms like **formal**, **informal**, and **substandard** or **illiterate** to describe levels of usage. Usually the standards are placed in a **best**, **acceptable**, **bad** sequence, thus encouraging use of the longest or hardest word or phrase as the **best**. The result is often pompous or unintelligible writing.

(U) In serialized reports, use words, idioms, and phrases that are **appropriate** to the subject and context and that express **clearly** what you want to say. More often than not, a short or easy word or phrase is better than a long one, but remember that **clarity** is more important than **conciseness**.

... ..

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laise...

(U) Common in British English. In American writing it is uncommon, but it is not wrong. If you use it, be ready for negative comments from purists and others who dislike the verb, even though there is no valid reason, grammatical or otherwise, for avoiding it.

laison...

(U) An "l" on each side of the "a."

liberal...

(U) Avoid this political term. See the entry for conservative.

lie...

(U) Lie is a verb with two meanings. One meaning is "recline" or "be situated," and the verb forms are lie, lay, lain. His jacket had lain on the chair all day. Tony lay on the beach, soaking up the sunshine.

(U) In the sense of making false statements, the verb forms are lie, lied, lied. The Defense Minister had lied before.

(U) See the entry for lay.

lighted, lit...

(U) An example of divided usage. Both forms are acceptable as forms of the past tense or past participle of the verb light.

(U) When used as an adjective, lighted is the more common form: a lighted candle. Lit is generally part of a combined form: moonlit sky.

like...

(U) As a preposition, like is used to compare one thing to another. Like her colleagues, Laverne was above reproach. When like is a preposition, a pronoun or noun following like must be in the accusative case: Her daughter looks like her. Be certain the things you are comparing are parallel.

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(U) In the 19th century, a number of commentators claimed that like cannot be used as a conjunction. (NOTE: Neither grammarians nor lexicographers accepted this theory until after the First World War.) That theory, however, is a myth not supported by the historical evidence.

(U) Like has been used as a conjunction since the late 14th century. Among the authors who have used like in this way are Chaucer and Shakespeare, although it did not become common until the 19th century, when it was used by Keats, Brontë, Thackeray, Dickens, Kipling, and Shaw, among others. In the 20th century, writers such as Churchill, Eliot, Shirer, Sandburg, Faulkner, Christie, H.G. Wells, and Lewis also have used conjunction like.

(U) Like as a conjunction may be primarily a spoken form, but it is standard in literature as well. Ignore the purists who try to tell you otherwise.

(U) See the entry for as.

likeable...

(U) In SIGINT, spell it with an "e," but likable is a valid alternative.

likely...

(U) Likely as an **adverb** is most often preceded by a qualifying word, such as "quite" or "very": She will most likely arrive today.

(U) No qualifier is needed when likely is an **adjective**: That's a likely story.

likewise...

(U) Likewise is an **adverb**, not a conjunction, and cannot replace a connective such as "and": He risked his life and likewise his honor.

LIMA...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "I"

limited...

IN THE FIELD BOOK

(U) Instead of a limited number, try a few.

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linking verb...

(U) A linking verb is one that functions chiefly as a connector of a subject to a modifier. He was ill.

liter...

(U) Equal to about 34 fluid ounces or 1.06 liquid quarts. Since it is a measurement, always use figures: 2 liters. Always capitalize the abbreviation for liter (L).

(U) In serialized reports, give liquid measurements in liters unless you are quoting. In such cases, give the liter measurement immediately after the original form: "500 fritzels (1250 liters)." "

literally...

(U) Literally means "in a manner precisely fitting the words." Paul was literally alone and penniless. It is not correct to say "He was literally breathing fire" unless you are referring to a dragon.

(U) See the entry for ingratiately.

LNU...

(U) Do not use this abbreviation for "last name unknown." Spell out the phrase.

loan...

(U) In SIGINT reporting, use loan only as a noun. While its use as a verb is standard and has been traced back to at least the 16th century, it fell out of use in British English after the 17th century.

(U) The verb loan now is chiefly American and part of general discourse, including literature, but not elevated discourse. It is used as a verb only in the literal sense. For figurative expressions you must use lend.

(U) See the entry for and.

local time...

(U) Use ZULU time, not local time, in serialized reports unless local time is important to the intelligence fact. If using local time,

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place the ZULU time in parentheses right after. Attack at 0500 (0200Z).

(U) See the entry for time.

~~log, logue...~~

(U) See the entry for catalog, catalogue.

long function word...

(U) A grammatical term for a single word that can replace an entire phrase: e.g., "while" rather than "during the time that."

~~loosen, unloosen...~~

(U) Loosen means "make less tight something that binds or restricts."

(U) Unloosen means "set free from all restriction."

~~lots, a lot...~~

(U) These expressions are common in general prose but not in formal writing. Avoid them in serialized reports.

lowercase...

(U) A single word as an adjective or noun. In printing it means small letters rather than capitals.

~~-ly adverbs...~~

(U) Do not put a hyphen between an adverb ending in -ly and a following adjective: newly elected president

(U) Adverbs ending in -ly are preferred when the adverb precedes the verb or participle it modifies: The attacking aircraft quickly descended for a bombing run

(U) Also see the entry for flat adverbs

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Content Seward: Reporting Board, 512HB, 953-5643
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, 512HB, 953-5643

 *Reporting Page*

Last Modified: April 2, 2009
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2011

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USN
"go reporting"

(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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M

Mach...

(U) Equals the speed of sound. A plane traveling at Mach 1 would be traveling at the speed of sound (about 1200 kph/750 mph at sea level, about 1060 kph/660 mph at 30,000 feet above sea level). Mach 2 is twice the speed of sound, etc.

(U) Use decimals for speeds in Mach: e.g., Mach 1.8. Capitalize the "M." Do not abbreviate Mach.

(U) See the entry for speed.

majority...

(U) Majority takes a singular verb when it refers to a group as a unit. A majority of the team is going out for pizza.

(U) Use a plural verb when majority refers to what each individual or part of the group is doing: The majority of the team live west of Elm Street. In many cases, "most" can be substituted for majority when a plural sense is meant.

(U) A majority, which is more than 50%, is always a "plurality," but the reverse is not always true.

(U) See the entries for collective noun and plurality.

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make preparations for...

(U) Instead, try "prepare for," which is shorter.

man...

(U) See the entry for *gender*.

manner...

(U) Replace phrases such as *in a clever manner* or *in an awkward manner* with simple adverbs, such as "cleverly" or "awkwardly."

march route...

(U) Two words.

marshal...

(U) As a verb, it means "arrange" or "place in order."

martial...

(U) Means "pertaining to military affairs or to war." Rule by military authorities over a civilian population is *martial law*, not "marshal law."

masterful, masterly ..

(U) *Masterful* often indicates "strong-willed and domineering" and in that context should be used only of people: *Attila the Hun was a masterful person.*

(U) *Masterly* often refers to the things that people produce or create: *a masterly piece of film criticism*

(U) Although H. W. Fowler tried to create a distinction between *masterful* and *masterly* in the sense of "skilful" or "expert," both appear in standard prose in that sense: *a masterful writer, a masterly sense of English*

U//FOUO

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material, material...

(U) Material is what something is composed of or can be made of (such as cloth).

(U) Material refers to the equipment, apparatus, and supplies of an organization.

materialize...

(U) Means "assume material form" or "take effective shape": If our plans materialize, we will succeed.

(U) Although many writers use materialize in the sense of "happen" or "come into existence," a number of commentators think such use is wrong. Try to avoid it in SIGINT reports.

maximum...

(U) In writing, maximum generally is considered an absolute that should not be modified by a comparative or superlative. (The same is true for minimum.)

(U) Do not use the phrase the maximum amount because a maximum is an amount. POOR: The maximum amount I will pay is \$500. IMPROVED: The maximum I will pay is \$500.

(U) See absolute adjectives.

may...

(U) Use may to indicate uncertainty about something or to indicate a formal grant of, or request for, permission: May I speak? It may rain tomorrow.

(U) See the entry for can.

may possibly...

(U) Use may or possibly, not both. It may be true. It is possibly true.

MD, M.D. ...

Fig. 1.1.1. 64-26

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(U) Distinguish between MD without periods (which stands for military district) and M.D. with periods (which means doctor of medicine). M.D. rarely is appropriate in SIGINT reports.

me...

(U) Use me as the object of verbs and prepositions. Fred hit me. Let's keep this between you and me.

meager...

(U) Use the American spelling.

mean...

(U) Use mean to designate a number that is equidistant from two extremes. If a week's high temperatures are 48, 70, 88, 88, 74, 63, and 65, the mean high temperature is 61. (The average is 65.)

(U) See the entries for average, median, and norm.

meantime, meanwhile...

(U) Both words can be used as nouns or adverbs, but the most common practice is to use meantime as a noun and meanwhile as an adverb.

(U) When used as nouns, meantime and meanwhile often follow a preposition: In the meantime, we waited. Meanwhile as an adverb often begins a sentence: Meanwhile, we waited.

measurement...

(U) See the complete entry for measurement.

media...

(U) The English noun media has been used as a singular count noun since the 1920s. Its use as a singular is less common than as a plural in referring to television, radio, and the press, but either form is acceptable. Do not use "medium," however, to refer to a means of communication. (See the entry for medium.)

(U//FOUO) (U//FOUO)

(U) Media takes a singular or plural verb and modifiers depending on the context: What media allows us to reach the most customers? The media were on hand for the committee session.

median...

(U) The median is the middle value in a distribution, above and below which lie an equal number of points. If a week's high temperatures are 48, 70, 68, 66, 74, 63, and 65, the median is 66 (three higher values and three lower ones).

(U) See the entries for average, median, and nqm.

medium...

(U) Use medium and mediums only to refer to people who claim to be able to speak with the dead.

(U) See the entry for media.

megahertz...

(U) Always abbreviated as MHz. Under the SI system, the prefix "mega" is always abbreviated as "M."

(U) See the entry for hertz.

memento...

(U) A memento is a keepsake. See the entry for momento.

memorandum...

(U) Use either memorandums or memoranda. Both forms are valid.

meridian...

(U) Use numerals and lowercase: 47th meridian west.

mete...

to be a P.E. or a P.E.

(U) It means "distribute as if by measurement" or "give out": mete out punishment.

meter...

(U) Always use figures with the word meter: a 7-meter limit. Leave a space between the number and the abbreviation: 500 m, not 500m. The American spelling is meter.

metric system...

(U) The popular name for the Systeme Internationale (SI) decimal-based system used to measure length, weight, volume, etc. According to a Washington Post article (27 August 1994), the only countries that have not converted officially to the metric system are the U.S., the Bahamas, Liberia, and Burma.

(U) When quoting measurements in traffic that are in a form other than metric, include the metric equivalent in parentheses immediately after the original measurement: 5 miles (8 km). (U) Abbreviate common metric terms without expansion.

(U) See Abbreviations & Acronyms for guidance on how to abbreviate metric measurements.

MiG...

(U) In SIGINT reports, the "i" is in lowercase, and the plural is formed by adding an "s": MiGs, MiG-25s.

might possibly...

(U) Use might or possibly, not both.

mighty...

(U) Standard as an adverbial intensifier: a mighty fine day. Its use dates back to the 13th century, and it was in common use in the 17th, 18th, and 19th centuries. Today it is most common in southern and midwest American usage, but it is not limited to those areas.

(U) While not appropriate for the most formal contexts, mighty appears regularly in newspaper and magazine writing. Use mighty in serialized reports whenever it is appropriate.

MIKE...

1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6.

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(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "m"

mile...

(U) Assume statute mile unless nautical mile is specified. Use figures with miles: 23 miles, 7 miles. To convert miles to kilometers, multiply by 1.609.

(U) See the box for measurement.

military rank...

(U) Capitalize and abbreviate a military rank only when it is used before a full name: Gen. John J. Pershing. Do not abbreviate when only the last name is given: General Pershing, Sergeant York. Use commonly-recognized abbreviations for rank, not service-specific ones.

(U) Capitalize a rank used in place of a name only when the rank is higher than general: the Commander in Chief, the Field Marshal.

(U) Express foreign ranks in standard English form: Major General Zog (not General-Major Zog). There is no need to place the equivalent U.S. rank in parentheses after the foreign rank.

military terminology...

(U) Use everyday English to convey ideas. If military terminology must be used, ensure that all recipients will understand the terminology. If in doubt, explain the term in a footnote.

military units...

(U) See the complete entry for military units.

mitigate...

(U) It means "influence" and goes back to at least 1642. The proper expression is mitigate against, not "mitigate against". The resources we have mitigate against attacking on the western flank.

(U) See the entry for mitigate

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millimeter...

(U) Abbreviate as mm when preceded by a numeral. Hyphenate in a compound modifier: a 57-mm antiaircraft gun.

million...

(U) Use figures with million, billion, or trillion in all but indefinite cases. Spell out the words million, billion, and trillion: He owns about a million acres. She won 5 million dollars.

(U) In serialized reports, use the form "\$7 million" when giving money equivalents: Prime Minister Merriam allegedly diverted 21 million drabecks (\$7 million) to his own bank accounts.

(U) See the entries for money: number, billion, and trillion.

miniature ..

(U) It means "a reduced version of something that normally has a larger size": a miniature golf course.

(U) Do not use miniature to describe something that is small and for which there is no standard size, such as a rug.

minimize..

(U) A term meaning "make as small as possible" or "play down the effect of."

(U) Purists argue that only the first sense is valid and that minimize is therefore an absolute. The second sense, however, has been around for more than a century and is standard.

(U) Expressions such as greatly minimized are more common in speech than in writing, but are not wrong.

minimum...

(U) See the entry for maximum.

miniscule...

(U) A variant spelling of minuscule. It first appeared in writing at the end of the 19th century. Modern usage commentators

consider it an error, even though it has been in widespread use for more than 50 years and appears in edited prose at least as often as, if not more often than, minuscule.

(U) Since it remains controversial, use minuscule.

MIRV...

(U//FOUO) Abbreviation for "multiple independently targetable re-entry vehicle." Use the verb forms MIRVed and MIRVing to discuss the application of this concept to missiles.

mishap...

(U) The attempt of some commentators to associate mishap with triviality is a recent phenomenon. From Shakespeare to modern journalism, mishap has been used for either serious or trivial occurrences, but always unfortunate for the person who is involved.

(U) In modern usage, mishap is used to describe an unfortunate accident of a trivial nature or to downplay the seriousness of an accident.

misplaced modifiers...

(U) See the box.

missile...

(U) A missile is an unmanned, self-propelled weapon whose flight path or trajectory can be controlled. A missile may be aerodynamic or ballistic. Distinguish it from a "rocket," which is a self-propelled vehicle whose trajectory or flight path cannot be controlled.

(U) See the entries for Msl and for weapon system designator.

mitigate...

(U) It means "alleviate" or "moderate." The accused offered several mitigating circumstances in his defense.

(U) See the entry for militate.

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mobile...

(U) Use *mobile* to describe something that moves frequently or is designed for easy transport: mobile home, mobile HQ.

(U) See the entry for *movable*.

MOD...

(U) Since it can mean either the Minister of Defense or the Ministry of Defense, do not use this abbreviation without expanding it first. Do not use it in a serialized report to represent both terms.

momento...

(U) According to Merriam-Webster, *momento* is a rare variant spelling of "memento" that was first noted in 1853. *Momento* also is Italian for "one minute."

(U) Because it is uncommon in general use, avoid it in SIGINT reports. Use *memento* instead.

money...

(U//FOUO) See Standard Worldwide Currency Names and Abbreviations for in-depth currency and conversion information.

(U) Include U.S. dollar equivalents in parentheses after the foreign currency: 48.1 million zloty (\$2,000).

(U) Note the exchange rate in a footnote only when the currency is undergoing significant daily fluctuations or some other extraordinary condition exists.

(U) When knowledge of the conversion rate is important, place the information, including the date and source of the quoted rate, in a footnote. (A) (U) Based on a rate of 24049 zloty to \$1, cited in The Washington Post, 2 December 1994.

(U) If black market rates are important to the SIGINT story, indicate that in the footnote.

(U) When the same term is used to denote currency in more than one country (e.g., dollar, pound, franc), indicate which currency is involved: British pounds, Lebanese pounds; French francs, Swiss francs.

(U) Do not capitalize "euro."

... < P L E N T

more than one...

(U) The idiom more than one generally modifies a singular noun, which in turn takes a singular verb: More than one student has failed the exam.

(U) Use a plural verb when the modified noun requires the plural: More than one of the results are from Maryland.

(U) See the entry for fewer than two.

mosque...

(U) A mosque is a building used by Muslims for public worship. Capitalize mosque when it is part of the name of a specific building: Aya Sofia Mosque. Do not capitalize it when referring to a building: Abd al-Hamid will meet us in front of the mosque.

mostly...

(U) Use mostly to refer to the largest number of a group. They arrested mostly students.

movable...

(U) Use movable to describe something that can be moved but is not designed for transport: a movable wall, a movable sculpture. The variant spelling is moveable.

(U) See the entry for mobile.

mph...

(U) Use mph for "miles per hour" only when quoting from text. It always follows a number.

(U) Unless you are quoting, report speed in metric form (kph) in serialized reports: The aircraft flew at a computed average ground speed of 680 kph. (not 550 mph)

(U) If you are quoting, however, insert the metric equivalent in a double set of parentheses immediately after the quoted figure. General Zog noted, "the new tank's top speed is nearly 50 mph (80 kph), even under the worst conditions."

Ms...

... ..

(U) A courtesy title used to refer to or address a woman, irrespective of marital status. While it is now standard in general use, do not use Ms. (or any other courtesy titles) in serialized reports.

(U) See the entry for courtesy titles.

MsI...

(U) Use the abbreviation MsI as part of a unit designator only after first spelling out the word missile.

(U) Use it sparingly in a short report that mentions only one unit, but freely in listings and narrative reports that repeatedly refer to missile units: 5th MsI Regt. Otherwise, spell out missile.

must...

(U) Use must or have to, not "got to" or "have got to," which are oral idioms.

mutual.

(U) Mutual in the sense of "common" or "shared" has been used by writers since Shakespeare. The first objection to this sense was from Robert Baker in 1770 who objected to the phrases mutual benefactor and mutual friend, even though they were used by many writers. Most commentators in the 19th and 20th centuries have followed Baker's theory even though writers have not.

(U) Mutual often does mean "reciprocal" or describes the relation between two people or things: a mutual dislike, mutual arms reduction. But mutual in the sense of "common" is clear and well-entrenched usage, not likely to confuse any reader. There is no valid reason to object to phrases such as mutual friend.

(U) See the entry for common.

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Content Steward: Reporting Board, S12PB, 963-5645
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12PB, 963-5645

 **Reporting Page**

Last Modified: February 23, 200
Last Content Site Review: January 4, 2011

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5/7/2010

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Friday, May 7, 2010



The Reporting Page
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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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N

nadir...

(U) The lowest point. Its antonym is zenith.

names of enterprises...

(U) For the names of factories and other enterprises, translate the descriptive portion of the name but leave the actual name in the original language. the Przyjan Cotton Mill, not the Friendship Cotton Mill. When possible, italicize the actual name in a report.

(U) See the entry for foreign phrases and words.

names, personal...

(U) In a report title, the official title or rank and the last name usually are sufficient: Zerdian President Doe Impeached rather than Zerdian President John J. Doe Impeached.

(U) When referencing a person for the first time in text, always include the first name (and title) if known: Interior Minister John Doe or Jens Doe, Minister of Defense. In subsequent references, you may use the title, the last name, or both: Doe, Minister Doe, or the Minister.

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(U) Capitalize only the first letter of a person's name in a SIGINT serialized report: Clark Kent, not CLARK KENT. Do not use courtesy titles in SIGINT reports.

(U) See the entry for titles.

NATO designators...

(U) See aircraft designator, ASCC designator, and weapon systems.

nautical mile...

(U) Abbreviate it as nm whenever it follows a number. Since it is a measurement, always use figures: 5 nm, not five nautical miles.

(U) See the entries for measurement and mile.

NBC...

(U) This abbreviation for nuclear, biological (see BW and CBW), and chemical (see CW) must be expanded on first reference. Do not use "bacteriological" instead of "biological" unless the reference is to protective gear used by the military; NIPF topics do not use the term "bacteriological."

near, nearly...

(U) Near in the sense of "almost, nearly" dates back to about 1200. It is an example of a flat adverb and sounds somewhat old-fashioned, but is not an error. In SIGINT reporting, however, use the more common adverbial form nearly.

(U) See the entry for flat adverbs.

necessity...

(U) The common idioms are the necessity of and the necessity for: I do not see the necessity of lying. I do not see the necessity for lying. Although necessity can sometimes be followed by an infinitive, try to avoid such use in SIGINT.

NOTE: (U) The distinction between the nouns need and necessity is that necessity intensifies the sense of urgency to the point of denying that the particular need can be ignored. For example, cash is a need in order to buy things, but cash is a necessity when the store will not take checks or credit cards.

U//FOUO

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needless to say...

(U) A standard English idiom, generally used to emphasize that a statement is self-evident or provide a smooth transition between sentences or paragraphs. Use it in serialized reports only when necessary.

negative modifiers...

(U) When possible, avoid weakening a statement with unnecessary modifiers such as undisclosed, unspecified, unidentified, and so on. Emphasize the facts rather than lack of facts (unless the lack of facts is what is important).

(U) On the other hand, don't try to hide the fact that we do not know something. Save the reader a phone call by letting him know in the text of the report, an analyst comment, or a footnote that there is no additional information.

(U) See the entries for negative reporting and for NFI.

negative reporting...

(U) Unless the lack of information is itself significant or a user has requested such reports, do not issue negative reports (sometimes referred to as an NFI (nothing to report)). Even when reporting negative data, try to present it in positive terms. A communications stand-down is under way in the Zerdian Army rather than There have been no Zerdian Army communications for 4 days.

neither...

(U) When neither serves as the negative counterpart of either, it takes a singular verb, especially when used by itself: Neither is coming.

(U) Neither followed by "of" and a plural noun or pronoun may take a singular or plural verb. Neither of the doctors was in. Neither of them were on time.

(U) A pronoun with neither as an antecedent, therefore, may be singular or plural: Neither of the doctors is likely to reveal her (or their) identity.

(U) See the entry for notional agreement.

neither ... nor...

See the entry for or.

(U) See the entry for either ☐ or

neologism...

(U) A term used to identify a new word (or phrase) or a new sense of a word (or phrase). The Oxford Companion to the English Language identifies neologisms as falling into the following classes.

- compounding (e.g., couch potato)
- derivation (yuppie, from "young urban professional")
- shifted meaning (political spin)
- extended function (necklace as a verb)
- abbreviation (GIGO)
- back-formation (dis from disrespect)
- borrowing (glasnost)
- root-creation (Kodak, Xerox)

(U) Examples from the last 50 years include acronym, gremlin, cosmonaut, paramedic, Eurodollar, quasar, boat people, junk food, gridlock, and golden parachute.

(U) While neologisms are part of normal language change and with frequent use become part of the everyday language, clarity is the most important principle in writing reports. Do not use recent or uncommon neologisms, especially those that could cause confusion, just as you would avoid using colloquial language.

NFI...

(U) Don't use this abbreviation, which can mean either "no further information" or "not further identified." Instead use unidentified, unlocated, unknown, etc. Be careful to distinguish between what you, the analyst, do not know and, for instance, something that the traffic indicates the communicant does not know.

FOUO: F.L. 17-07

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nmi...

(U) See the entry for nautical mile.

no . . . or...

(U) When no introduces a compound phrase, connect the elements with or: She has no money or credit cards.

nobody...

(U) Nobody is an example of notional agreement. As an indefinite pronoun, it generally takes a singular verb: Nobody wants to go to jail.

(U) A pronoun with nobody as the antecedent, however, may be either singular or plural: Nobody thinks his (or their) dog is worthless.

(U) See the entry for notional agreement.

NOFORN...

(U) NOFORN is the acronym for Not Releasable to Foreign Nationals. It is a security control marking used to alert the reader that the information must be kept within U.S. channels only.

(U) Add the NOFORN caveat to the overall classification line of any report that contains NOFORN information and to the paragraph marking of each paragraph that contains NOFORN data. Abbreviate it as "NF" in paragraph markings.

(U) When a paragraph contains NOFORN and either REL or EYES ONLY information, the NOFORN takes precedence and should be used in the paragraph marking. The same principle holds when one paragraph in a report is NOFORN and another is REL or EYES ONLY. Use NOFORN in the overall classification.

nominative...

(U) A noun or pronoun that is the subject of a sentence or serves as a predicate noun or pronoun is in the nominative case.

(U) Only pronouns have specific forms for the nominative case.

NOFORN

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(U) See the entry for *case*.

nonaligned nations...

(U) A political term referring to nations that did not belong openly to Western or Soviet alliances or blocs. India and Egypt were examples of nonaligned nations.

(U) With the collapse of the USSR and the Eastern Bloc, this term has lost its meaning. Use it carefully.

none, no one...

(U) Another example of notional agreement. *None* takes a singular verb when it is used in the sense of "no single one": *None of the seats was in the right place.* If the sense is "two or more," use a plural verb: *None of the consultants agree on the right method.* (NOTE: The earliest recorded use of *none* with a plural verb is from King Alfred the Great, A.D. 888.)

(U) The myth that *none* takes only a singular verb arose in the late 19th century and is based on incorrect etymology. *None* is not a contraction of "no one," but rather is based on the old English word *nan*, which in turn was formed from *ne* "not" and an "one." The Old English *nan* was inflected for both singular and plural.

(U) The two-word form is always singular and normally is used to emphasize: *I tried four different diets, no one of which was helpful.*

(U) See the entry for notional agreement.

nonessential phrases and clauses...

(U) See the entry for nonrestrictive elements.

nonrestrictive elements...

(U) Nonrestrictive elements are words, phrases, and clauses that are not necessary to the meaning of the sentence and may be omitted.

- *My wife, Leslie, is a wonderful person.* (*Leslie* is a nonrestrictive appositive.)
- *Farmers, using pesticides and fertilizers, try to enhance crop growth.* (*Using pesticides and fertilizers* is a nonrestrictive

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phrase.)

- My daughter, who is studying international relations, will graduate in May. (Who is studying international relations is a nonrestrictive clause.)

(U) Use a pair of commas to set off nonrestrictive elements in the middle of a sentence.

(U) See the entries for appositives, comma, restrictive elements, that, and which

nonstandard...

(U) A term used by lexicographers to describe grammatical forms and constructions--often regionalisms--that are not characteristic of educated native speakers. Merriam-Webster's Third distinguishes between nonstandard and substandard, using substandard as an indicator of social status

(U) When reference works simply use nonstandard as a substitute for substandard, *literate*, or other pejorative terms, regard the label with some skepticism.

nor...

(U) Nor is sometimes used incorrectly for "or" in negative expressions when parallelism is called for. **WRONG:** He cannot eat nor sleep. **IMPROVED:** He cannot eat or sleep. He can neither eat nor sleep. He cannot eat nor can he sleep.

(U) See the entries for either . . . or, neither . . . nor, or, and parallelism

norm...

(U) Use norm to indicate a standard or model regarded as typical for a specific group: The child was below the norm for his age in reading comprehension

(U) See the entries for average, mean, and median.

not further identified...

(U) Use this phrase or a similar parenthetical remark rather than a footnote to tell the reader that you have no further information. Do not use the abbreviation NFI

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notional agreement...

(U) Notional agreement refers to agreement of a verb with its subject or of a pronoun with its antecedent based on the notion of number or meaning. This meaning is the one that the expression has to the writer or speaker. It contrasts with what may be called formal or school-grammar agreement in which only form determines singular or plural agreement.

(U) Notional agreement is a relatively recent discovery, according to Merriam-Webster, but it explains why so many expressions in English do not follow the formal grammar we learned in school. Most school grammars are based on the work of 18th century grammarians, who never caught on to notional agreement, which is a feature of English rather than Latin, and who tried to correct its forms. The conflict between notional and formal agreement is behind many usage issues.

not only . . . but also...

(U) Use not only . . . but also when you mean both of the things specified. She wanted not only to graduate but also to go on to graduate school. Make sure that the elements following not only and but also are parallel.

(U) The word also is optional in this construction and is often omitted in short constructions: Society is not only multifaceted but often contradictory.

(U) When you mean either of two things but not both, you do not need only or also: The winner was not Nancy but Kristin.

(U) See the entry for parallelism.

nouns as verbs...

(U) English nouns have been adapted for use as verbs for several centuries. Examples include progress, experience, and head. There is no grammatical reason to avoid such use, despite the claims of some recent commentators on usage.

(U) See the entry for contact.

NOVEMBER...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "n."

nucleus...

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF

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(U) The plural form is nuclei.

nulls...

(U) Use leading nulls only in time entries between 0001 and 0959 and in geographic coordinates.

number...

(U) Do not use the abbreviation for number (No.) in serialized reports.

number of, .

(U) A number of is followed by plural nouns and takes a plural verb: A number of persons were selected.

(U) The number of takes a singular verb: The number of winners is tiny.

(U) See the entries for amount of and collective noun.

numerals...

(U) There are two sets or systems used for numbers in English: arabic numerals and roman numerals. Of these the arabic system is by far the more common. Unless otherwise specified in USSID CR1400, the rules for the use of arabic numerals are:

(U) Spell out:

- numbers one through nine
- any number that begins a sentence (Reword the sentence to avoid cumbersome expressions like five thousand three hundred fifty-seven.)

(U) Use numerals to:

- express numbers greater than nine
- refer to a page or a figure in a report

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- indicate the number of a FOLLOW-UP
- refer to the true unit designator of a military unit other than an Army corps: 3rd Army (but V Corps)
- express units of time, money, and measurement (exception: zero degrees Celsius)
- cite specific part numbers or nomenclature of pieces of equipment, such as "fiber optic strand 6"

(U) Special rules are

- when four or more numbers appear to the left of the decimal, use a comma to separate them into groups of three, counting from right to left (exception: years in a date)
- extend decimal numbers no more than two places to the right in most reports
- when a number is part of a unit modifier, include a hyphen: 5-year term, 10-km race, two-word form
- when two or more numbers appear in a sentence in reference to the same thing and one of them is 10 or more, use figures for all numbers referring to the same thing: Among them the four men had received 9 tickets for drunk driving and 23 for reckless driving

(U) See the entries for ordinal numbers and roman numerals.

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Content Steward: Reporting Board, 512RB 563-564s
 Page Publisher: Reporting Board, 512RB 563-564s

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Last Modified: December 14, 2010
 Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2011

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Friday, May 7, 2010

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"go reporting

(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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○

ପ୍ରଶ୍ନ/ସଂ.

(U) The plural form is cases.

obligate, oblige...

(U) Use either form when the constraint is external: I am obliged (or obligated) to pay the bill. The subtle difference here is that obliged implies constraint applied by physical force or by circumstances whereas obligated implies an obligation to someone else - i.e., you have promised or contracted to do it.

(U) Use *obliger* when the constraint is in one's mind: I feel obliged to apply to an Ivy League school.

{U} In the 20th century, obliged has displaced obligated in the sense of "put under a debt of gratitude" I am obliged to you.

obscenely...

(U) Never include obscenities in a report. If an obscenity is part of a quote, replace it with the phrase (expletive deleted).

"of" phrases...

1. *Chlorophyll a* and *Chlorophyll b* were determined by the method of Arar and Collins (1971).

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i.) Often can be eliminated to cut down on wordiness. For example, instead of rules of the Party, try Party rules, for Minister of Defense, try Defense Minister

(U) See the entry for prepositional phrases.

off...

(U) In modern writing, do not use of or from after off. POOR: He stepped off of (or off from) the train. IMPROVED: He stepped off the train.

(U) The idiom *off of* is *speech* and has been in use since the 18th century.

(U) Modern citations for off from are very rare, although the phrase was used by older writers such as Milton, Swift, and Defoe.

off-load. .

(U) In general, use "unload." Off-load has a very specific meaning relating to the center of gravity of a vehicle.

OK, O.K., okay...

(U) Do not use any of these forms in SIGLIT, even though they are acceptable in general prose.

older, oldest...

(U) Applies to either persons or things. See the entry for *older*, *eldest* and for superlative of two.

он...

(U) Do not use on before a date unless its absence would lead to confusion: He will be inaugurated 20 January.

(U) Do use on to avoid any suggestion that a date is the object of a transitive verb: The Assembly postponed on 22 July its debate on price increases.

(U) See the entry for onto.

-97-

1. *Pol. Sci. 1999*

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(U) Generally, include the hyphen in compound form adjectives: run-on sentence, head-on attack.

on board...

(U) Two words. It means "carried on" or "situated on" something: The shipment is on board the freighter. The runner is on board second base.

(U) If you want to specify that what is carried is on a **passenger vehicle**, such as a train or plane, use **aboard**: Paul will travel to Jamaica aboard a cruise ship. The conductor cried out, "All aboard!"

(U) See the entry for **about**.

one of those who...

(U) This is another example of notional agreement. In 1770, Robert Baker developed the theory that the verb in the clause following **one of those who** should be in the plural because the relative pronoun relates to the object of the preposition **of**. She is one of those women who always complain about their job. Since **who** relates to "women," in this example, it should take a plural verb.

(U) The practice Baker and his followers have tried to correct has been around since at least the 10th century. Many writers through the centuries have used the singular verb: "one of those who is not only at peace within himself . . ." (Joseph Addison). Usage commentators argue this is correct because in these cases the writer is emphasizing the singular pronoun **one**.

(U) Merriam-Webster ~~likes~~ show that both forms are in regular use and that the plural verb is more common. Which form you use, they suggest, depends on whether you are emphasizing the pronoun or the plural antecedent. Both are standard.

(U) When a restriction is put on **one**, however, the clause has a singular verb: She is the only one of those women who does not complain about her job.

onetime, one-time, one time...

(U) **Onetime** as a single word means "former": He is a onetime champion.

(U) When used as a modifier meaning that something occurred only once, it is hyphenated: It was a one-time event.

(U) In all other cases use two words: They fired one time.

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ongoing...

(U) The earliest citation of ongoing as an adjective was back in 1877. It did not become popular, however, until the 1950s and has remained in widespread use since then.

(U) Most newly popular words are derided by usage commentators as vogue words, but there is no objective reason for not using ongoing in your writing.

(U) If you do wish to replace the adjective ongoing, use the adjective "continuing" rather than the adverb "currently."

online...

(U) In communications, it pertains to the operation of a functional unit when under the direct control of its associated system, or to equipment that is connected to a system and is in operation.

(U) In computer technology, the state or condition of a device or equipment that is under the direct control of another device, or the status of a device that is functional and ready for service.

(U) The spelling without the hyphen is becoming more common and is preferred, but the alternative form on-line is also correct.

only...

(U) When used as an adverb, only should be placed with care to avoid ambiguity. Generally, it should precede the word or words it modifies. Note the differences in the following examples:

- Only Sally works here. (No one else works here.)
- Sally only works here. (Sally does nothing here but work.)
- Sally works only here. (Sally does not work anywhere else.)

(U) In speech, the placement of only is less precise because stress and intonation make clear the meaning. In writing, follow the above practice.

(U) See the entry for misplaced modifiers for additional examples.

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onto, on to...

(U) As a single word, **onto** implies that the motion toward a position was initiated from an outside point. He wandered **onto** the highway (from a point off the highway). **On** does not indicate where the motion began: He wandered **on** the path.

(U) Use the two-word form when **on** is an adverb associated with a verb: Let's move **on** to a new subject.

operations...

(U) Use **it** to describe military activities that accomplish **specific** missions, such as patrols, parades, airfills, etc.

(U) See exercise and training.

opine...

(U) **Opine** has been used as an English verb since the 15th century, but today is most common in very formal usage. It emphasizes that what is being reported is, in fact, just an opinion. **Said**, **stated**, **thought**, and **held the opinion** are options, depending on the context.

opinion...

(U) Something is an opinion when our experience or the verified report of the experience of others is not sufficient to exclude reasonable doubt.

(U) In reporting, the emphasis should be on objectivity. If you must inject an opinion, do so in an analyst comment.

or...

(U) Use **or** between compound words or phrases that follow a negative: He cannot eat **or** sleep. She cannot remember where she left her book **or** when she last had it.

(U) See the entry for **nor**.

oral...

(U) Use **oral** only to refer to spoken words: Some schools still require that students pass an oral examination.

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(U) See the entry for verbal.

order of presentation...

(U) The order in which information is presented in a SIGINT report is the order in which they register in the mind of the reader. For this reason it is important to place the essential facts and their significance at the beginning of the report in the title and the report lead. To do otherwise risks having the busy reader say "why bother with this?"

(U) In the body of the report, present the material in a logical order that allows the reader to understand how the story or event developed. This may or may not be chronological order.

(U) Sometimes the body of the report has to present information in such a way that the most significant facts come at the end. This is acceptable as long as the report title and lead contain the important facts and conclusions.

order of battle...

(U) Order of battle refers to the strength, identification, command structure, and disposition of the personnel, units, and equipment of a military service. Hyphenate it as an adjective: order-of-battle data.

ordinal date...

(U) The ordinal date (often referred to erroneously as the julian date) is a number, usually in three-digit form, representing the day of the year: 1 January is 001, 1 February is 032, 11 March is 070, etc. Adjust the ordinal dates in leap years.

(U//FOUO) In serialized reports, the ordinal date is the last required field in the report Identification and Accounting Line (for example, XXMMENP01FOO96123 would be on reports published on 3 May).

ordinal numbers...

(U) Use an ordinal number to indicate a position in a series: first base, second base, third base. Spell out ordinals for the numbers 1 through 9 and use numerals for those greater than nine: 11th on the list, 50th wedding anniversary.

(U) Do not add the -ly suffix to ordinals. Use first, second, third, etc. Do not use firstly, secondly, thirdly, etc.

(U) In true unit designators, use figures except for an Army Corps: 33rd Mountain Division, 8th Army, VI Army Corps.

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NOTE: (U) The standard abbreviated forms for second and third are 2nd and 3rd. The 1984 edition of the GPO Style Manual uses 2d and 3d, but does not give any reason for this usage. Follow the Chicago Manual of Style, almost all other sources, and common usage in using 2nd and 3rd.

(U) See the entry for numerals.

ordinance, ordnance...

(U) An ordinance is a statute passed by a nonsovereign legislature.

(U) Ordnance refers to military supplies, i.e., ammunition and weapons.

organizations...

(U) Capitalize the full name of an organization: the Ministry of Agriculture, the Smallville Town Council.

(U) Capitalize the shortened form only if it is a national-level body: the Ministry, but: the town council.

(U) See the entry for capitalization.

orient, orientate...

(U) American English uses orient. British English prefers orientate.

originator line...

(U) See point-of-contacting.

ornate words...

(U) Pass over words like *apprise*, *citizenry*, *eschew*, and *opine* in favor of simpler ones whenever appropriate. Use them only for emphasis, and then only rarely.

OSCAR...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "o."

U//FOUO 3841218

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out, out of...

(U) Out is more often used in expressions such as walk out the door or look out the window.

(U) Use out of with nouns designating places or things thought to be containing or surrounding: Rick was glad to get out of jail.

outside...

(U) When used as a noun, outside is followed by "of": the outside of the box.

(U) When used as an adjective or adverb, the of is omitted: an outside chance; he went outside.

(U) When used as a preposition, outside normally is not followed by "of": Norm left it outside the house.

overall...

(U) Overall is a single word whether used as an adjective or an adverb: Overall, they succeeded; an overall increase in results.

overall classification statement...

(U) In serialized reports, use individual paragraph markings, placed within parentheses, rather than an overall classification statement.

(U) An overall classification statement is not the same thing as the overall classification line, which comes after the Distribution Line.

(U) In past reports, the overall classification statement appeared in the TEXT Line portion of a serialized report, usually within a double set of parentheses.

(U) Direct questions about the proper classification of serialized reports to your organization's classification advisory officer, P0521 (963-1911), or P05/SAO (963-5463).

overstatement...

(U) Overstatement is a mark of the inexperienced writer. It can damage credibility very quickly. Make certain you are providing the facts, not inflating your assessments.

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(U) See the entry for credibly.

overuse...

(U) This is a charge made against many common words, such as stated. Rarely, however, do the critics offer any evidence to show that the word in question actually is used too often. More often than not, the critic simply orders you to take his word for it.

(U) If someone suggests that a word or phrase you have chosen is overused, ask for the evidence that backs up the claim.

owing to...

(U) The controversy over owing to began in the 18th century when some objected to the use of the present (or active) participle in the sense of "owed" or "due," which was thought to be proper only for the past (or passive) participle.

(U) While the argument raged on the active-passive issue, owing to crept into standard use as a preposition and is now grammatically impeccable.

(U) See the entries for because of and due to.

Oxford comma...

(U) Another term for serial comma, derived from the house style at Oxford University. The style mandates the use of a comma before and in a series of three or more items.



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Content Steward: Reporting Board, S12RR, 963-5645
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12RR, 963-5645



Reporting Page

Last Modified: April 2, 2011
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2011

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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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P

page numbers...

(U) On hard-copy reports, place the page number at the bottom of the page, but above the classification. There is no need to center the page number between a pair of hyphens. Use lowercase roman numerals for introductory pages such as a table of contents or preface.

(U) Do not number pages of an appendix separately. When referring the reader to another page, do not capitalize "page" e.g., See the figure on page 6.

pair...

(U) Use a singular verb when pair refers to a set of two items as a single unit: This pair of lamps is on sale. Use a plural verb when referring to the two members of the set as individuals. The pair of them work well together. The pair are saying their wedding vows tomorrow.

(U) After a numeral other than "one," pair can be either singular or plural, although the plural is more common now. Imelda bought six pairs (or pair) of shoes.

PAPA...

10-11 P.11. 10-11

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(U) Phonetic spelling for the letter “p”

paragraph...

(U) Keep paragraphs short, especially in a 2-column format. Newspapers rarely have more than two or three sentences in a paragraph. Long paragraphs tend to be more difficult to read.

(U) Magazines and journals of opinion tend to allow longer paragraphs that range from 100 to 200 words. This would suit a one-column format more readily than a two-column format. Use your best judgment.

parallel...

(U) Capitalize when referring to specific geographic lines, as in 38th Parallel.

(U) See the entry for coordinates.

parallelism...

(U) Readers can more easily absorb a series of words, phrases, or clauses in a sentence or paragraph when they are expressed in grammatically equal (parallel) form.

Poor: He went running, for a bike ride, and to swim.

Improved: He went running, biking, and swimming.

(U) Make sure that each element in the pair or series is grammatically the same. **POOR:** Betty liked to watch Paul dance and his singing. **IMPROVED:** Betty liked to watch Paul dance and listen to him sing or Betty liked Paul's dancing and singing.

(U) When the series consists of lengthy or complex phrases or clauses, repeating the preposition or conjunction that introduces them often ensures clarity: The new auto line is marked by months of careful planning, by continuous surveys of the market, and by close attention to quality during construction.

(U) Make the elements of each bullet item in a series parallel in structure, (all nouns, all infinitives, etc.) For example, We need to follow this procedure.

- discuss the goals

Source: <http://www.grammar-monster.com>

- plan the steps to be taken
- organize a working group
- implement the program

parameter...

(U) Parameter originally was a specific term used in mathematics to describe a characteristic element. It is often confused with "perimeter," which means a boundary line or the area immediately inside the boundary. Before deciding which to use, think about whether you mean a trait, a factor, a criterion, or a boundary or limited area. See perimeter.

parenthesis...

(U) The plural form is parentheses. A **set** of parentheses consists of an opening parenthesis and a closing parenthesis. Use a **set** of **parentheses** to:

- establish an abbreviation or acronym: air defense exercise (ADX)
- include coordinates in a report: Gotham City (0001N 00001W)
- set off parenthetical material: Zenkai Freedom Movement (a Maoist guerrilla group founded by Jokiz Blog in 1992)
- refer the reader to an appendix or figure: Exports have nearly doubled since 1988 (see figure 2).
- set off paragraph classification: (S-E-OC) [redacted]
- set off analytic comments within or at the end of a paragraph: (COMMENT: This is an analytic comment.)

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- place a comma **after** the closing parenthesis, not before
- place a period **after** the closing parenthesis when referencing a figure or chart
- place a period **after** the closing parenthesis when the phrase in parenthesis is dependent on the surrounding material. The table shows increased spending (by 50 percent).
- place a period **after** the closing parenthesis when the material inside is not a complete sentence (such as this fragment). (A complete, independent parenthetical sentence, however, takes a period **before** the closing parentheses.)

(U) See brackets.

part...

(U) Replace on the part of with "by" or "among" whenever it improves the sentence.

partially, partly...

(U) Use **partially** to mean "to a degree" when referring to a condition or process. partially frozen.

(U) Use **partly** when referring to a part as opposed to the whole, especially of physical objects. The building is partly brick.

(U) Partly is also more common before a clause or phrase offered by way of explanation. Our defeat occurred partly because General Doe's forces executed an unanticipated flanking maneuver.

participle...

(U) Present participles, all of which end in "ing," and past participles, most of which end in "-d" or "-ed," are forms of the verb in that they are used with auxiliary verbs to make compound forms. As I was saying, you have delayed enough.

(U) Both participles may function as an adjective: a shining light, a boiled egg. Participles used as adjectives generally precede the noun they modify, identify a "permanent" condition, and may take an object or be modified by an adverb.

(U) Present participles also may function as nouns. (See the entry for gerund.)

parts of speech...

U S G S

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(U) Parts of speech are categories created by grammarians for use in analyzing a language. The number of categories in English has ranged from four to nine through the years, with eight as the accepted number (although not always the same eight) since the late 18th century.

(U) The categories we use are not based on English but rather are taken from Latin grammar, in English they actually describe **word functions**, not categories, since English words can function as more than one part of speech. (In Latin, a word functions as only one part of speech.)

(U) Many usage "problems" arise from the insistence by some grammarians and purists on trying to restrict English words to absolute Latin categories.

party...

(U) The use of party as a synonym for 'person' has been traced back to the 15th century and remains standard today. It became a usage issue in the 19th century when the term was associated with shopkeepers and tradesmen. Its use was considered an indication of lower social class, and some commentators of the time argued against its use in formal writing. Their argument is spurious.

(U) Party as a term in legal usage goes back to at least the 13th century: He was indicted as a party to the conspiracy.

(U) See the entry for political parties and philosophies.

passive voice...

(U) Do not make a fetish of avoiding the passive voice. There are a number of very good reasons to use it:

1. When the actor is not known: "Their business was robbed."
2. When the actor is unimportant and the result is what counts: "The MiG-21 was hit by ground fire."
3. When the relative value of actor and patient are greatly different: "A bus ran over Bob" vs. "Bob was run over by a bus."
4. To avoid ambiguity: (compare the titles "Officer Kills Man With Knife" and "Man With Knife Killed By Officer").

(U) See the entries for active voice and bureaucratese.

pass-over point...

(U) A point on the earth's surface that an aircraft flies over. Although the chances are slim that it could be confused with the

Jewish holiday "Passover," use a hyphen to prevent confusion.

1. 1.1.1. 05-15

pastime...

(U) It is a single word and only takes one "i" when referring to something that amuses and serves to make time pass agreeably. Baseball is the national pastime. But, it is past time to fix this.

PDDG...

peaceable, peaceful...

1. 1.1.1. 05-15

(U) Use peaceable, which means "disposed toward peace," to describe people.

(U) Use peaceful, which generally means "characterized by peace," to describe actions and things.

(U) Although peaceable and peaceful have been used synonymously since the 14th century, the above meanings are the most common today.

pendant, pennant...

(U) Use the American form pennant number rather than the British form pendant number.

(U) Do not use a pennant number to refer to a ship unless you do not know the ship's name or hull number.

(U) See ships and ship names:

1. 1.1.1. 05-15

5/7/2019

people...

(U) Use **people** to refer to a large group collectively and indefinitely. Many **people** were killed or injured. In modern usage, **people** can be used with any plural number: Six **people** were injured. Over 50,000 **people** were there.

(U) When referring as a collective noun to a single race or nation, **people** takes a plural verb. The American **people** are united. When referring to two or more distinct political or cultural entities, use **peoples**: the **peoples** of Africa.

(U) The possessive forms are **people's**, in the singular, and **peoples'**, in the plural: the **People's Republic of China**, the **Slavic peoples'** history.

(U) See the entries for **person** and **personal**.

per...

(U) Use **per** freely in statistics and units of measurement: miles **per** hour, barrels **per** day.

(U) Use it sparingly to mean "in accordance with," as in **per** the Minister's instructions.

perceive...

(U) Originally **perceive** meant only "become aware of something as it really is," i.e., external observation; Karen **perceived** the nature of my brewing method. Its newer use deals with the mental conception or interpretation of what something is, regardless of reality: Washington was **perceived** as hostile toward the new government of Zerkia. The newer usage is usually in the passive voice.

percent, per cent...

(U) The one-word form is more common in American use, but either form is correct. Since it is a measurement, always use figures: 18 **percent**, 2 **percent**.

(U) **Percent** takes a singular verb when standing alone or when a singular word follows "of". The teacher said 60 **percent** was a failing grade. Only 5 **percent** of the membership was present.

(U) Use a plural verb when a plural word follows "of": Only 15 **percent** of the members were there.

U. S. G. P. L. 50, 10.

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(U) When giving a range, you need not repeat the word "percent" after each figure: He estimates 35 to 45 percent of the electorate will not vote.

percentage...

(U) When preceded by the article "the," percentage takes a singular verb: The percentage of failures is down.

(U) When preceded by the article "a," it takes a singular or plural verb, depending on the noun in the "of" phrase that follows: A large percentage of the students have failed the exam. A large percentage of the crop has spoiled.

peremptory...

(U) It means "putting an end to debate or action": a peremptory command.

(U) See the entry for preemptory.

perfect...

(U) The idea that perfect is an absolute adjective originated in 1795. Perfect, however, has been used in both comparative and superlative forms since the 14th century, including the preamble to the Constitution. In such cases, what is being stated is that the "thing being described" has more of the characteristics of what is perfect than "some other thing." The comparative or superlative form is quite acceptable except when perfect is used in its most literal sense.

perimeter...

(U) the boundary line or the arch immediately inside the boundary (synonyms: margin, border); a line enclosing a plane area: the size of something as given by the distance around it. See parameter.

period...

(U) Use a period:

- at the end of a declarative sentence
- after the initials of a person's name

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- when omission of the period might confuse the reader after an abbreviation or acronym (e.g., c o d.). If the reader would not be confused, the period is not needed
- in the abbreviation U.S.
- with decimals

{U} Always place the period within quotation marks. If a sentence ends with an abbreviation that takes a period, do not add a second period: Prime Minister Renee spoke to each of the delegates from the U S.

{U} See the entry for initials and Appendix 1 on abbreviations.

period (of time)...

{U} Avoid using period in expressions of time. Instead of during the period from 7 to 15 October, just say from 7 to 15 October.

perishability...

{U} Perishable information is information that is of limited or no value to users of intelligence after a particular date, usually one that is very near. Issue perishable information at a higher priority than non-perishable data.

{U} An example of perishable information is knowledge that two nations will sign a secret treaty on trade on December 1. Isolating the information on November 28 means getting a report to users very quickly so that they can prepare their response or take some action. If the information about the treaty is isolated on October 1, however, it is not perishable. Users will have ample time to act.

{U} Be aware that perishable information is useful to more than high-level officials. Also, even though it may be too late to take any action, the information may still be valuable to some users. Don't avoid reporting useful information simply because a date has gone by.

person...

{U} Use person when speaking of an individual or of a specific and relatively small number of individuals: Three persons were killed. In the second sense (a relatively small number), people is equally valid. Three people were killed.

{U} See the entries at people and personnel.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

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-PERSON.

(U) Avoid coined words such as *chairperson* and *spokesperson* when describing known individuals. Instead, use *chairman*, *spokesman*, etc. if referring to a man, or *chairwoman*, *spokeswoman*, etc. if referring to a woman.

(U) Whenever possible use a neutral word, such as leader or firefighter, to refer to someone whose sex is not known or to mixed groups.

(U) When speaking of a specific office, use the official title of the office. Use chairperson or similar words only when it is the formal title for the office.

(U) See the entries for gender and chair and its compounds.

personal names...

(U) See the entry for names, personal

personnel...

(U) A collective term for a group of people or for an administrative group concerned with a group of people: the personnel department.

{U} Avoid using a number directly before the word personnel. POOR: Six personnel were injured. IMPROVED: Six people were injured

(U) A number is acceptable, however, when another qualifying word modifies personnel: Fifty armed forces personnel tested the new weapon.

(U) See entries for people and person.

phone...

[U] "cell phone" vs. "mobile phone": It is true that most mobile phones now do not use cell technology and that therefore "mobile phone" is more accurate. It is also true that most Americans call all mobile phones "cell phones" now, and our Commonwealth partners tend to stick with "mobile." Some target countries use one term, and some the other. Decide whether this is really an issue in your reporting before you ask for arbitration: is it just a matter of translation, or is it an indicator of the type of technology.

1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10. 11. 12. 13. 14. 15. 16. 17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24. 25. 26. 27. 28. 29. 30. 31. 32. 33. 34. 35. 36. 37. 38. 39. 40. 41. 42. 43. 44. 45. 46. 47. 48. 49. 50. 51. 52. 53. 54. 55. 56. 57. 58. 59. 60. 61. 62. 63. 64. 65. 66. 67. 68. 69. 70. 71. 72. 73. 74. 75. 76. 77. 78. 79. 80. 81. 82. 83. 84. 85. 86. 87. 88. 89. 90. 91. 92. 93. 94. 95. 96. 97. 98. 99. 100. 101. 102. 103. 104. 105. 106. 107. 108. 109. 110. 111. 112. 113. 114. 115. 116. 117. 118. 119. 120. 121. 122. 123. 124. 125. 126. 127. 128. 129. 130. 131. 132. 133. 134. 135. 136. 137. 138. 139. 140. 141. 142. 143. 144. 145. 146. 147. 148. 149. 150. 151. 152. 153. 154. 155. 156. 157. 158. 159. 160. 161. 162. 163. 164. 165. 166. 167. 168. 169. 170. 171. 172. 173. 174. 175. 176. 177. 178. 179. 180. 181. 182. 183. 184. 185. 186. 187. 188. 189. 190. 191. 192. 193. 194. 195. 196. 197. 198. 199. 200. 201. 202. 203. 204. 205. 206. 207. 208. 209. 210. 211. 212. 213. 214. 215. 216. 217. 218. 219. 220. 221. 222. 223. 224. 225. 226. 227. 228. 229. 230. 231. 232. 233. 234. 235. 236. 237. 238. 239. 240. 241. 242. 243. 244. 245. 246. 247. 248. 249. 250. 251. 252. 253. 254. 255. 256. 257. 258. 259. 260. 261. 262. 263. 264. 265. 266. 267. 268. 269. 270. 271. 272. 273. 274. 275. 276. 277. 278. 279. 280. 281. 282. 283. 284. 285. 286. 287. 288. 289. 290. 291. 292. 293. 294. 295. 296. 297. 298. 299. 300. 301. 302. 303. 304. 305. 306. 307. 308. 309. 310. 311. 312. 313. 314. 315. 316. 317. 318. 319. 320. 321. 322. 323. 324. 325. 326. 327. 328. 329. 330. 331. 332. 333. 334. 335. 336. 337. 338. 339. 340. 341. 342. 343. 344. 345. 346. 347. 348. 349. 350. 351. 352. 353. 354. 355. 356. 357. 358. 359. 360. 361. 362. 363. 364. 365. 366. 367. 368. 369. 370. 371. 372. 373. 374. 375. 376. 377. 378. 379. 380. 381. 382. 383. 384. 385. 386. 387. 388. 389. 390. 391. 392. 393. 394. 395. 396. 397. 398. 399. 400. 401. 402. 403. 404. 405. 406. 407. 408. 409. 410. 411. 412. 413. 414. 415. 416. 417. 418. 419. 420. 421. 422. 423. 424. 425. 426. 427. 428. 429. 430. 431. 432. 433. 434. 435. 436. 437. 438. 439. 440. 441. 442. 443. 444. 445. 446. 447. 448. 449. 450. 451. 452. 453. 454. 455. 456. 457. 458. 459. 460. 461. 462. 463. 464. 465. 466. 467. 468. 469. 470. 471. 472. 473. 474. 475. 476. 477. 478. 479. 480. 481. 482. 483. 484. 485. 486. 487. 488. 489. 490. 491. 492. 493. 494. 495. 496. 497. 498. 499. 500. 501. 502. 503. 504. 505. 506. 507. 508. 509. 510. 511. 512. 513. 514. 515. 516. 517. 518. 519. 520. 521. 522. 523. 524. 525. 526. 527. 528. 529. 530. 531. 532. 533. 534. 535. 536. 537. 538. 539. 540. 541. 542. 543. 544. 545. 546. 547. 548. 549. 550. 551. 552. 553. 554. 555. 556. 557. 558. 559. 560. 561. 562. 563. 564. 565. 566. 567. 568. 569. 570. 571. 572. 573. 574. 575. 576. 577. 578. 579. 580. 581. 582. 583. 584. 585. 586. 587. 588. 589. 590. 591. 592. 593. 594. 595. 596. 597. 598. 599. 600. 601. 602. 603. 604. 605. 606. 607. 608. 609. 610. 611. 612. 613. 614. 615. 616. 617. 618. 619. 620. 621. 622. 623. 624. 625. 626. 627. 628. 629. 630. 631. 632. 633. 634. 635. 636. 637. 638. 639. 640. 641. 642. 643. 644. 645. 646. 647. 648. 649. 650. 651. 652. 653. 654. 655. 656. 657. 658. 659. 660. 661. 662. 663. 664. 665. 666. 667. 668. 669. 670. 671. 672. 673. 674. 675. 676. 677. 678. 679. 680. 681. 682. 683. 684. 685. 686. 687. 688. 689. 690. 691. 692. 693. 694. 695. 696. 697. 698. 699. 700. 701. 702. 703. 704. 705. 706. 707. 708. 709. 710. 711. 712. 713. 714. 715. 716. 717. 718. 719. 720. 721. 722. 723. 724. 725. 726. 727. 728. 729. 730. 731. 732. 733. 734. 735. 736. 737. 738. 739. 740. 741. 742. 743. 744. 745. 746. 747. 748. 749. 750. 751. 752. 753. 754. 755. 756. 757. 758. 759. 760. 761. 762. 763. 764. 765. 766. 767. 768. 769. 770. 771. 772. 773. 774. 775. 776. 777. 778. 779. 780. 781. 782. 783. 784. 785. 786. 787. 788. 789. 790. 791. 792. 793. 794. 795. 796. 797. 798. 799. 800. 801. 802. 803. 804. 805. 806. 807. 808. 809. 810. 811. 812. 813. 814. 815. 816. 817. 818. 819. 820. 821. 822. 823. 824. 825. 826. 827. 828. 829. 830. 831. 832. 833. 834. 835. 836. 837. 838. 839. 840. 84

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and, if the latter, does it make a difference to your intelligence product?

placename...

(U) Placename has been spelled in several forms: one-word, two-word, and hyphenated. Merriam-Webster's form is hyphenated, both as a noun and as an adjective. GPO says in rule 6-8 to "print solid two nouns that form a third," especially when the prefixed noun consists of one syllable. What do you do?

(U) English language trends show that most compound words move from two-word to one-word form, sometimes going through the hyphenated stage, sometimes not. In the interest of standardization in SIGINT reporting and as an exception to the general instructions on spelling, therefore, follow the GPO rule and use the one-word form.

(U) For placenames themselves, follow the spelling given in the NSA Standard Placename Telegraph List (SPNTL). If the placename is not listed in the SPNTL and a U.S. Board of Geographic Names (BGN) transliteration system applies, use the spelling in the BGN gazetteer. If the placename is not listed in the gazetteer, check with E312 (963-5585).

In cases where a special SIGINT transliteration system must be used to transliterate a non-roman alphabet, consult the proper annex of USSID 406 for the correct method of transliterating the name.

(U) See the entries for coordinates and for altitude, longitude.

plaintext, plain text...

(U) Use the one-word form as an adjective: plaintext message.

(U) Use the two-word form as a noun (as in "cipher text"): What is the underlying plain text?

plough, plow...

(U) Americans use plow. Plough is chiefly British.

plurality...

(U) Use **plurality** to signify the highest number of votes received, but only when that number is less than half of the total vote. (NOTE: In 1960, Kennedy won a plurality of the popular vote and a majority of the electoral college vote.)

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(U) Also see the entry for majority

plurals...

(U) Form most plurals as outlined in the Merriam-Webster dictionaries. If the dictionary doesn't provide the answer, check the GPO Style Manual. Keep in mind that two plural forms, in some cases, are equally valid. When that is the case, use the one listed first in the dictionary.

(U) In forming the plural of compound terms, the significant word takes the plural form: brothers-in-law, attorneys general, judge advocate generals. (The addition of an "s" to the first word in a compound term (e.g., attorney generals) is a feature of speech, not writing.)

(U) To follow modern style in serialized SIGINT reports, append an "s" to form the plural of all acronyms and decades: SAMs, the 1990s.

(U) For proper nouns, do not change a final y to ies: Germany, Germanys; Reilly, the Reillys. Exception: the Rockies

plus addressees...

(U) See the box for distribution

point in time...

(U) Although many people think this phrase was born in the Watergate hearings of the 1970s, it has been around since the late 19th century. It is wordy, and generally you will do better to use either "point" or "time" by itself when writing of past events or "now" when speaking of a current event.

point-of-contact line...

(U) Add a point-of-contact line to every serialized report. In an electrical report, place it after the text and any footnotes. In a hard-copy report, place it on the distribution page.

(U) The point-of-contact entry is a service to the reader and should be the person who can answer questions about the report. It need not be the author. It is not intended to be, nor should it serve as, a means of providing a "byline" or credit for analysts, linguists, or transcribers.

continued on...

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(U) Place the flag "POC:" at the left margin. Beginning in the 10th space, list the organization designator, the name, and the NSTS telephone number on one line and the STU-III numbers (if needed) on a second line. If more than one line is necessary, begin each line in the 10th space.

NOTE: (U//FOUO) Field stations will enter the site SIGAD, NSTS number, and a STU-III number (only from the Defense Switched Network). Do not provide a name or internal designator.

(U) Provide only one organization or name unless the report is the combined product of two organizations whose areas of expertise are so diverse that no one person can answer all possible questions. In such cases, list two names and indicate the area of expertise for each.

NOTE: (U) Field stations may list numbers for a day shop (including day-shift hours in ZULU time) and a watch

political parties and philosophies...

(U) Capitalize the name of the party and the word party when they are used together: the Communist Party. Capitalize party when it stands for a specific political party: The Party controls the country.

(U) Capitalize Communist, Socialist, etc., when referring to individuals who are members of a specific political party.

(U) Use lowercase to refer to the political philosophy or to someone who advocates a philosophy without being a member of a specific party: communism, socialism, capitalism, socialist, capitalist.

pope...

(U) Capitalize when used before a name or when referring to a specific pope: Pope Pius XII. The Pope will visit France and Spain soon.

(U) Use lowercase for other references: Only males may be elected pope in the Roman Catholic Church.

(U) Use lowercase for all related words such as papal, patriarch, and pontiff.

port...

(U) Nautical term. From the helmsman's point of view, the left side, as opposed to starboard, the right side.

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portrait orientation...

(U) Portrait orientation refers to a page that is longer than it is wide. Most narratives are in portrait orientation.

(U) Also see the entry for landscape orientation.

possessives...

(U) To form the possessive of:

- most nouns, add an apostrophe and an "s": my aunt's pen
- common nouns ending in "s," add an apostrophe and an "s": That is the boss's pen
- compound words, make only the last word possessive: the Attorney General's brief
- a multi-syllable word ending in an "s" or "z" sound and followed by a word beginning with an "s" or "z" sound, add only the apostrophe for convenience's sake
- plural words ending in "s," add only an apostrophe: the boys' team, the Joneses' new car

(U) Do not use an apostrophe:

- with personal pronouns: ours, yours, his, hers, its, theirs
- after the names of states, countries, or other organized bodies ending in "s": League of Nations mandate
- after words that are used as descriptives rather than possessives: states rights, writers guide. Do use the apostrophe if the intent is clearly possessive: The state's right to levy income taxes is based on the state constitution.

(U) See the entries for apostrophe and double genitive.

possible, possibly...

(U) Possible is an adjective and modifies nouns, but the usage "a possible scenario" is a SIGINT idiom that has no parallel in ordinary English. In everyday English, no one would say "The baby swallowed a possible penny," but reporters often write that a

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military unit "conducted a possible exercise." It is argued that this usage has the advantage of brevity and is well understood by the customer. This is true, but other considerations may override the argument: for years now, reporting classes have instructed analysts to write reports in a more "journalistic" style that is less stilted and closer to standard English. This is partly to get reporters to hone their communications skills, to enable them convey more accurate information and to present different aspects of a report to different audiences with ease. For instance, journalistic style would use "The unit conducted what may have been an exercise" or "The unit may have conducted an exercise." Note the difference in nuance here: the first sentence conveys certainty that the unit conducted something and uncertainty about what that something was, the second conveys a lack of certainty about what the unit was doing.

(U) Possibly is an adverb modifying verbs, adjectives, and other adverbs. Do not use it to modify nouns. Instead of "a possible regiment," use "a unit, possibly a regiment."

(U) The same guidance applies to probable and probably. Also see the entry for validity marker.

pound...

(U) Always use figures when using pound as a measurement of weight. To convert to kilograms, multiply the number of pounds by .453.

(U) Always report weights in metric terms unless you are quoting directly. Do not use the abbreviation for pound in a serialized report. See the box for measurements.

(U) Do not abbreviate pound when speaking of a unit of currency, such as pounds sterling or Lebanese pounds.

(U) See the entry for money.

pounds sterling...

(U) Do not use this phrase in serialized reports. Instead use British pounds

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practicable, practical...

(U) Something practicable can be put into effect. Something practical is that which is sensible and worthwhile. It might be practicable to bicycle from Baltimore to Phoenix, but it would not be practical if you had to be there tomorrow morning.

practically ..

(U) Practically in the sense of "nearly," "almost," or "all but" has been in use since the mid-18th century. Although it is quite standard in this sense, some usage commentators have objected to it because other words can do the job as well. You may use it if you wish. John had practically (or nearly or almost or all but) finished the test when the bell rang.

precipitate, precipitately...

(U) Use these words primarily to identify rash, overhasty human actions: The precipitate commitment of his entire reserve force was a major error by General Zog.

precipitous, precipitously...

(U) Although used primarily in the sense of physical steepness, these words can be used in a figurative sense to demonstrate a sudden or abrupt change, a precipitous decline in sales.

predicate...

(U) Predicate in the sense of "base upon" or "establish" has been in use since at least 1766. George Washington, William James, and Reinhold Niebuhr, among others, have used it. It also has the older meaning of "affirm" or "attribute."

predominant(ly), predominate(ly)...

(U) The adjective/adverb is predominant/predominantly.

(U) Predominate is a verb, but has been appearing increasingly as an adjective, a confusing usage that should not appear in SIGINT reporting. Stick with predominant and predominantly.

preemptory...

(U) Preemptory means "displacing something." The verb preempt generally carries the meaning of one thing taking precedence

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over or taking the place of another; The President's speech preempted normal television programming.

(U) See the entry for peremptory.

prefix...

(U) Most prefixes form a single word without hyphens. When you use two prefixes with one base word in a sentence, you may write the base word only once, after the second prefix. But follow both prefixes with a hyphen: two- and four-year colleges; pre- and post-war eras.

(U) See the box on hyphens.

prepositional phrases...

(U) Often the culprit in wordy prose. Rewording the sentence usually solves the problem. Instead of John Doe, the Minister of Agriculture in Zandia, complained about the problems of the Committee on Livestock, try rewording it as Zandian Agriculture Minister John Doe complained about the Livestock Committee's problems.

prepositions...

(U) The alleged rule about ending sentences with a preposition was invented in 1672 by English writer John Dryden, who criticized such usage by Shakespeare, Ben Jonson, and others. Dryden apparently developed this rule because such a construction was not possible in Latin.

(U) Although many people were taught in grammar school and high school that this "rule" existed, nearly all respected commentators and dictionaries have noted that, as H. W. Fowler put it, this is a "cherished superstition." Such beliefs die hard, however, and purists will insist today that the "rule" is true.

(U) Merriam-Webster notes that this construction, known as the postponed preposition, was a regular feature of some constructions in Old English and is required by various constructions (such as the restrictive clause introduced by that) even today.

(U) Usage shows that in speech the natural placement of the preposition often comes at the end of the sentence. The same is true in questions. There is no valid grammatical reason to move it elsewhere in writing. Use it without fear, despite the howls of purists.

prescribe...

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(U) It means set down as a rule or guide. In a medical sense, it means order or recommend the use of a drug or other treatment.

(U) See the entry for proscribe.

prescriptive grammar...

(U) A term for an account that sets out rules for how a grammar ~~should~~ be used. Such a grammar establishes an arbitrary "correct" form and often does not take into account changes and variations in language.

(U) See proscriptive grammar.

presently...

(U) Use it with a present tense verb when you mean "now". The unit is presently deployed on the Zandian border. This use has been standard since 1485. Ignore those usage commentators who warn against it.

(U) Use it with a future tense verb when you mean "soon". I will be with you presently.

president...

(U) Capitalize when used before a name or referring to a specific president at the national level. President Lincoln, the President signed the crime bill.

(U) Use lowercase letters in other circumstances.

preventative, preventive...

(U) Both forms have been in ~~reputable~~ use for more than 300 years, but preventive is much more common.

previous to...

(U) A compound preposition used since the 16th century. The preposition "before" is a more common choice, but previous to can be used for variety.

(U) See the entry for prior to.

principal, principle...

(U) Principle is a **noun only**, meaning a basic and fundamental truth, law, doctrine, or standard; principles of economics, moral principles.

(U) Principal as a **noun** refers to one holding high position (especially the head of a school) or to a sum of money. The principal spoke to the students. Lynn reduced the principal on her mortgage to less than \$10,000.

(U) Principal as an **adjective** means "chief" or "most important": The principal causes of business failure are inadequate cash reserves and poor record-keeping.

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principal components...

prior to...

(U) Generally used in formal or impersonal contexts. In less formal writing, use the preposition before.

(U) See the entry for previous to.

probable, probably...

(U) Follow the guidance outlined in the entry for possible, possibly. Also see the entry for validity words.

product...

(U) SIGINT product is the foreign intelligence information derived from signals intelligence processing in response to stated or implied requirements.

(U) SIGINT product is disseminated to intelligence users primarily in written serialized reports, but can be disseminated in audio, written, or visual form.

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(U/POH)

profanity...

(U) See the entry for obscenity.

pronouns...

(U) Pronouns that are the **subject** of a verb or clause should be in the **nominative** case: I, you, he, she, we, they. He and I met to discuss the situation.

(U) Pronouns that are the **object** of a verb or preposition should be in the **accusative** (also called **objective**) case: me, him, her, us, them. Janet turned the matter over to us. Place the bottle between him and me.

(U) Remember that in addition to personal pronouns, we have **relative pronouns**, **reflexive pronouns**, **indefinite pronouns**, and **demonstrative pronouns**. All but indefinite pronouns require an antecedent.

(U) See the entries for antecedent, gender, notional agreement, **he**, and **they**, **their**, **them**.

propellant, propellent...

(U) The preferred spelling, whether noun or adjective, is **propellant**.

(U) According to Merriam-Webster, recent evidence for the alternate spelling **propellent** is primarily British.

proscribe...

(U) Means "condemn" or "prohibit."

prescriptive grammar...

(U) A term for a rule that forbids a particular use of language on the grounds that it is incorrect or undesirable. Many such rules are based on factors other than correct or historical usage. Some of these factors are social status, etymology, level of education.

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and personal likes.

proved, proven...

(U) As a general rule, use *proved* for the past participle and *proven* for the adjective. Both forms are acceptable in either situation, but the general rule shows the more common use.

(U) The regular form *proved* is the preferred form of the past participle. He has *proved* his point. It can also be used as an adjective meaning "successfully tested or demonstrated": a *proved* theory.

(U) *Proven* is descended from Scottish English and comes to us from legal usage: The charges were not *proven*. When used as an adjective, *proven* has the meaning "tested by time": a *proven* remedy, a *proven* talent.

provided, providing...

(U) When used as a conjunction meaning "on the condition that," use *provided* rather than *providing*. While either form is correct, *provided* is the more common.

proximity...

(U) Generally sufficient by itself. Do not use the idiom in close proximity unless you are trying to distinguish among various degrees of proximity.

punctuation...

(U) We use punctuation in writing to make what we say clear to the reader. Consider how difficult it is to understand any lengthy piece of writing that is not punctuated. It takes several readings to be confident that you know just what the writer was trying to say.

(U) Punctuation in written work tends to serve the same purpose as pauses, inflection, body language, and emphasis in speech. The *Oxford Companion to the English Language* notes that until the 18th century punctuation was closely related to spoken delivery, but now is more often based on grammatical structure.

(U) While many people think that punctuation is based on rules of grammar, it actually represents a style choice by printing houses. Many forms of punctuation have become standard, even though described by different terms (period versus full stop), but differences still exist. For example, American publishers generally place the comma and period inside quotation marks; British

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publishers place them outside quotation marks.

(U) Think of punctuation as a courtesy to your readers, designed to help them understand what you are saying when they cannot use your body language or voice to help interpret your meaning.

(U) See the specific entries for apostrophe, colon, comma, dash, ellipsis, hyphen, parenthesis, period, quotation marks, and semicolon.

purist...

(U) A term used to describe those who believe they hold the proper knowledge and view of what is "correct English" and "correct grammar" and who try to impose those forms and beliefs on everyone else. Purists decry the state of current usage and bemoan the future of the English language.

(U) The true purist develops "rules" based on propriety, taste, education level, and **personal** preference, while disregarding the evidence of literature (except to correct it) and general writing, ignoring the historical development of English and refusing to accept anything new in usage or vocabulary.

(U) In most cases, language purists are neither scholars nor great writers. Many are people drilled in particular rules or practices during their schooling who have not kept up with the latest findings about language. While some hold positions in journalism or in academic fields other than English, a large number do not.

(U) Perhaps Henry Shaw said it best in *Errors in English*: "A purist seems to feel that man was made for language and refuses to acknowledge that language was not only made for man but that it is determined and shaped by his use--and nothing else."

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Content Steward: Reporting Board, S12RB, 963-5645
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12RB, 963-5645

 **Reporting Page**

Last Modified: August 14, 2009
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2011

Continued from HHS/OSHA Memo 1-5, dated January 2007, last revised 10/20/2008
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Friday, May 7, 2010



The Reporting Page
One stop shopping for all your reporting needs!



(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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Q

qualifiers...

(U) See the entry for validity marker.

quarantine...

(U) The verb quarantine has the meaning "isolate politically or economically."

(U) See the entries for boycott and embargo.

quart. .

(U) Use metric measurements in SIGINT reports unless you are quoting directly. Multiply the number of quarts by .946 to get the equivalent in liters.

QUEBEC..

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "q."

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question...

(U) When preceded by a qualifier like "maybe" or "no," question often is followed by a clause beginning with *that*, *but that*, or *but what*. All three forms are standard. There is no question *but that* Julius ~~will~~ be pleased.

quick, quickly...

(U) Quick has been used as an adverb since the year 1300 and appears as such in the works of authors such as Shakespeare and Milton. Nowadays such use is more likely in speech than in writing and almost always follows the verb it modifies: Come quick!

(U) Quickly is more common in writing and may precede or follow the verb it modifies: The murderer quickly left the scene of the crime or The murderer left the scene of the crime quickly.

(U) See the entry for *ital* adverbs.

quid pro quo...

(U) A Latin phrase meaning "an equal exchange." Use it sparingly in SIGINT serialized reports. It does not need to be italicized.

quotation, quote...

(U) In most cases, the noun *quotation* is a better choice in SIGINT reporting than the noun *quote*, which appears in more informal or casual uses.

quotation marks...

(U) Quotation marks may be single or double. The American convention is to use the double quotation marks ("...") as the standard and to use single quotation marks ('...') only when quoting within a quotation.

(U) Use quotation marks:

- to indicate the exact words of a speaker or writer: The sign said, "Repent! The end is near!"
- to suggest irony: It was a "lucky" break.

quotation marks

- to introduce an unfamiliar term: Fred was diagnosed as a chronic "somnambulist."
- in an electrical report, to indicate a foreign term: Gorbachay introduced the concept of "glasnost." (But: Use italics rather than quotation marks for foreign words or phrases whenever possible.)

(U) When using quotation marks, place other punctuation marks as follows:

- Commas and periods go **inside** quotation marks.
- The colon and semicolon appear **outside** quotation marks.
- The question mark, dash, and exclamation point go **inside** the quotation marks when they apply to the quoted matter ("What is truth?") and **outside** when they do not (Have you read Poe's "The Raven"?)

NOTE: (U) The common American practices regarding punctuation do not necessarily match those of the Second-Party nations.



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Content Steward: Reporting Board, S12PB, 963-5615
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12PB, 963-5645



Reporting Page

Last Modified: April 3, 200
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2011

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Friday, May 7, 2010

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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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R

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Doc Title: Style and Usage Manual: R (Confidential)

radar names...

(U) See the entry for ELINT.

RADINT...

(U) RADINT is a form of collateral and consists of intelligence information collected by U.S. or Allied Forces radar.

(U) Do not confuse RADINT such as COBRA SHOE, with ELINT.

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railroad, railway...

(U) In American English, railroad is more common when referring to the transportation system, but either is correct. In American English, railway is more likely to refer to a set of tracks.

raise, rise...

(U) Raise takes an object; rise doesn't. She raised her hand. The moon rises.

range...

(U) Express ranges as follows: 0800Z to 1200Z, 10 percent to 20 percent, or 5 June 1986 to 6 July 1988.

(U) When using pairs of prepositions to express ranges, express them as "from x to y" or "between x and y": from 1983 to 1991, between June and November.

NOTE: (U) When giving dates, you may omit the month and year after the first element if they are the same as in the final element: 10 to 12 September 1988; 5 June to 15 August 1990.

rare, scarce...

(U) Both mean "uncommon," but scarce carries the additional implication of insufficient quantity: rare books, scarce grain reserves.

rarely ever...

(U) An established colloquial idiom, in use since at least 1684. The more common form in print, however, is rarely if ever, which dates to 1756.

(U) In the idiom rarely if ever, the if ever sometimes is set off by a pair of commas. Other phrases are hardly ever and rarely or never. All are standard.

ratio..

(U) Always use figures when expressing a ratio. The odds were 50 to 1. The teacher-student ratio was 1:12. The measure was approved by a 90 to 3 vote.

U.S. : 10.1.1. 10-16

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reason...

(U) Although in use since the 17th century, the phrase the reason is because is routinely condemned by teachers and language purists as a redundancy. They do so by defining because as "for the reason that," an argument that has been traced to Robert Baker in 1770.

(U) In fact, the meaning assigned out of context by the critics to because in this construction is no more valid than the meaning "the fact that" or just "that." What the purists are doing is defining the word because in a way guaranteed to support their objection.

(U) The objection made by purists is also inconsistent with their approach to similar phrases. Many of the same people who object vociferously to the reason is because have no hesitation about using it is because, which introduces the same kind of grammatical construction but is rarely criticized.

(U) Merriam-Webster notes three things about this construction. First, there are usually intervening words between the reason and is because. Second, the phrase is not one evoked by good writers. Third, the reason that (the suggested alternative) occurs in print about twice as often as the reason is because. In speech, the ratio is reversed.

(U) If you use the reason is because—you certainly don't have to—you will be in the company of authors such as Bacon, Swift, Faulkner, Frost, and E.B. White. Nevertheless, it can be dropped, in many cases, without changing the meaning of the sentence: [The reason] they have difficulty with physics [is] because they have no interest in it. The choice—keeping or dropping the phrase—is yours.

reason why...

(U) The idiom the reason why goes back to 1225, according to Merriam-Webster, and has been used by writers such as Swift, Johnson, Dickenson, Carroll, Shaw, and Thurber. Like the reason is because, it is condemned by some teachers and language purists.

(U) The theory that the reason why is incorrect is a 20th century American one, and it doesn't hold water. Use it freely.

rebellion...

(U) Rebellion is the defiance of authority in general or open (but unorganized) disobedience. In the political sense, rebellion usually is applied to an open, armed, and organized insurrection against authority that fails to achieve its aims. Shays's Rebellion, Whiskey Rebellion.

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(U) See the entry for revolt, revolution.

rebut...

(U) To rebut means "set forth counterarguments against an assertion."

(U) See the entry for refuse.

recall / revision...

(U//FOUO) In August 2005, the Director of National Intelligence issued orders for all members of the Intelligence Community to comply with new community-wide standards when they correct or cancel a report. Much of the new requirement mirrors the process that NSA/CSS has used for many years. In fact, the new process, which went into effect on 1 January 2006, is based on the original NSA/CSS one.

(U//FOUO) The new process did, however, require several changes.

- (U//FOUO) The term "REVISION" is now used instead of "CORRECTION," and "RECALL" is now used instead of "CANCELLATION" except in the SERIAL line of all product reports. Our legacy systems require the continued use of the terms "CORRECTION" or "CANCELLATION" in the SERIAL line.
- (U//FOUO) The new terms are added as the first words of the title (or subject) of all recalled/revISED reports.
- (U//FOUO) The explanatory paragraphs that we have long used must now use the new terms. The wording otherwise remains the same.
- (U//FOUO) There are now various categories of revisions and recalls, which are explained in the working aid "SIGINT Reporters' Guide to Revisions and Recalls".

reciprocal...

(U) Applies to the relationship between two or more members of a group, with the added sense of an exchange of goods or favors: reciprocal trade agreement.

(U) See the entry for mutual.

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reconnaissance...

(U) Two n's and s's. Avoid abbreviating it as "Recon" except as part of a unit designator in a listing or in a narrative report where it occurs repeatedly. Also avoid the abbreviation "recco," which is chiefly British. The verb form of reconnaissance is reconnoiter.

recur, reoccur...

(U) The verb recur (and the noun recurrence) can suggest a periodic or frequent repetition as well as the simpler notion of "happening again."

(U) Reoccur tells you that something happened again without implying anything about the number of occurrences.

(U) In SIGINT reporting, use recur and recurrence.

Red...

(U) Capitalize as part of a title: Red Army Faction, Red Cross. Do not refer to Communists as "Reds" except in direct quotes.

redundancy ..

(U) Merriam-Webster distinguishes between two kinds of redundancies: useful and wordy. Useful redundancy is much more prevalent in speech than in writing, and it often involves adverbs and prepositions: And both return back to their chairs (Shakespeare, Richard II); . . . begin with a true and authentic story (Thackeray).

(U) A grammar written by Lindley Murray in 1795 first expressed the notion that redundant words should be taken out of writing. Writers and grammarians since then have argued over the validity of Murray's precept. Journalists and school grammars tend to follow Murray; writers very often do not.

(U) Some writers and usage commentators argue that there are times when redundancy is needed for reinforcement or emphasis and that in such cases being concise is not the ultimate goal. They would also argue that redundancy limits the chance of error in communication. In the words of Bergen Evans: "In writing, as in conversation, an economical use of words is not always what we want."

(U) Redundancy is rarely useful in serialized reports, but don't be afraid to use it if necessary to ensure your reader's understanding. Redundancy is not a crime.

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(U) See the entry on wordiness for a discussion of wordy redundancy.

reference of pronouns...

(U) See the entry for antagonist.

reference works...

(U) Cite freely, either in text or as a footnote, any unclassified reference works used as a collateral source. In a footnote, include enough information to identify the work: *Saying What You Mean*, Robert Claiborne, 1986, W. W. Norton, p. 392.

(U) Identify a U.S. media source only when citing factual material: According to *The New York Times* (UNCLASSIFIED) of 28 February, the new Prime Minister is not a native-born citizen.

(U) Do not cite editorial or columnist opinions from U.S. press. Doing so violates Operations Directorate policy.

(U) For guidance on citing the identity of Second Party press, see the U.S. Identities in SIGINT manual, published by P052.

(U) See the entry for collateral.

referendum...

(U) Referenda is more common, but referendums is equally acceptable as a plural form.

refute...

(U) To refute means "prove or show your opponent's assertion to be false or invalid." This sense is not in dispute.

(U) In the 20th century, however, it also has taken on the sense "deny the truth or accuracy of." This sense is very common today and appears most often in journalism, where it is used to record the denials made by those accused of illegal or unethical behavior. Most usage commentators think the sense erroneous.

regard...

(U) The proper form in writing is in regard to. The form in regards to is generally restricted to speech.

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(U) In regard to, with regard to, regarding, or as regards are all acceptable, but in regard to is preferred.
regardless...

(U) Regardless means "in spite of": Regardless of the efforts of the players, the team lost.

(U) See the entry for irregardless.

regime...

(U) Regime is a synonym for a political system, not an administrative system: a fascist regime.

(U) Regime is often used in a pejorative sense to denote a government that the speaker or writer disapproves of: the Pinochet regime, the Castro regime. Use the term with caution.

(U) See the entry for government.

regions...

(U) See the entry for directions and regions.

[Redacted]

(U) See the entry for security control markings.

releasability statement...

(U) Expand in the "TEXT:" line of an electrical serialized report any releasability entry used in the report as a security control marking.

(U) If the report must remain within U.S. channels, place the label NOT RELEASABLE TO FOREIGN NATIONALS ahead of other security control markings except the expanded ORCON statement.

U S F O S

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religious titles...

(U) Capitalize a religious title used before or in place of a name. "Rabbi O'Leary," she said, "the Archbishop has arrived."

(U) Use lowercase when the title is used generically: The pope appoints all bishops in the Roman Catholic Church. Also see the entries for cardinal and pope.

reoccur...

(U) See the entry for recur. reoccur

repel, repulse...

(U) Both mean "drive back" or "drive off," but only repel is used in the sense of "causing distaste": His eating habits repelled us.

repetition of words...

(U) Repetition may help hold a passage together, emphasize an idea, or simply avoid a hunt for multiple synonyms: It also may be needed to introduce a series of parallel phrases or clauses. If you must repeat a name or title, do so. Repetition is not an error.

(U) Unnecessary repetition, however, is of two types. Reuse of the same word several times when another will not affect the understanding of the sentence is one. Don't bore your reader. Use of the same base word in two senses is another. POOR: My marks showed a marked improvement. IMPROVED: My grades showed a marked improvement or My marks improved significantly.

(U) See the entry for elegant variation.

report...

(U) See the entries for serialized report, SIGINT report, and technical report.

represents...

(U) A formal word that often can be replaced by "is": This represents the first time; this is the first time. Where possible, replace represents with "is" or some other active verb.

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request...

(U) Use **either** a noun or a noun clause introduced by "that" after the verb request. She requested more time. She requested that I not speak to her again.

(U) Avoid using request immediately before the infinitive. Use the verb ask instead. AWKWARD: He requested to go sailing with us. IMPROVED: He asked to go sailing with us.

(U) See the entry for ask.

requirements...

(U) Requirements are statements of the need for intelligence information levied on the U.S. SIGINT System by intelligence users. Each report must note the requirements it satisfies. Current requirements are in the National SIGINT Requirements List (NSRL).

(U) There are two kinds of requirements. Bridging requirements list general areas of strategic interest, either by geography or by subject. Standing requirements identify specific areas of interest by target and topic.

(U) List requirements after the prosign "REQS:" in the form 0x0000, where the first number is the priority, the letter or letters indicate the source (A for COMINT; AF for FISINT; AT for technical ELINT; and RD for operational ELINT), and the last several numbers identify the specific requirement.

(U) Do not include leading zeros as part of the specific requirement. The correct form is, for example, 3R123, not 3R0123, 2RF16, not 2RF0016.

(U) Padded bridging requirements take the form 0R0000. The padded NATO requirement takes the form 0RNN0000. Other padded requirements take the form 0x0000, where x is the source letter or letters.

restive, restless...

(U) Restive implies either "resistance to some sort of restraint" or "impatience under restriction or restraint."

(U) Restless means "unable to keep motionless or still."

restrictive elements...

10-11-2010 10:00

(U) ~~Restrictive elements~~ are words, phrases, and clauses that follow and restrict the meaning of the words they modify:

- The word ~~poobah~~ comes from the name of a character in the Mikado. (~~Poobah~~ is a restrictive appositive.)
- The two presidents most widely known are Washington and Lincoln. (~~Most widely known~~ is a restrictive phrase.)
- We are going to convict and punish those who break the law. (~~Who break the law~~ is a restrictive clause.)

(U) Do not use commas to set off restrictive elements--sometimes called essential elements--in a sentence.

(U) ~~See the entries for~~ appositives, nonrestrictive elements, ~~that~~, and ~~which~~.

~~resultant~~...

(U) Instead, use the more natural form ~~resulting~~

~~révenge~~...

(U) Suggests malice or resentment rather than justice and is used to indicate a real or imagined attack against oneself: "the hope of revenging himself on me was a strong inducement. . ." (Jane Austen, *Pride and Prejudice*)

~~revert back~~...

(U) Used much less frequently in edited prose than ~~revert~~. As a speech idiom, it can be considered an example of useful redundancy.

~~revolt, revolution~~...

(U) A ~~revolt~~ is widespread opposition to current standards. Politically, it refers to an armed attempt to change authority.

(U) A ~~revolution~~ is a radical alteration in a system or in social conditions. In the political sense, it is the overthrow by open and organized armed force of an established government and its replacement by another.

(U) ~~See the entry for~~ rebellion.

~~right~~...

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12

(U) Capitalize when referring to the group of people professing "right-wing" political views: the Right.

(U) Be very careful in assigning terms such as Right and Left to political movements. Such applications may be misunderstood or incorrectly applied. As a rule, use them only in direct quotations.

(U) See the entry for left

right turn...

(U) Use right turn, not right-hand turn.

right-of-way...

(U) Always include the hyphens. The plural form is rights-of-way

ring, ringed...

(U) Use ring or ringed when you mean "surrounded". Police ringed the warehouse

river...

(U) Capitalize when part of a name: the Nile River. But: cruising down the river on a Sunday afternoon.

rocket...

(U) A self-propelled vehicle whose trajectory or course, while in flight, cannot be controlled.

(U) See the entry for missile.

Romania...

(U) Not Rumanian or Roumanian.

roman numerals...

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(U) In the traditional outline format, roman numerals indicated the major headings when one or more of the headings contained subheadings:

- I. Summary
- II. First Event
 - A. First Item
 - B. Second Item
- III. Second Event
 - A. First Item
 - B. Second Item
 - C. Third Item
- IV. Conclusions
 - A. Conclusion 1
 - B. Conclusion 2

(U) In modern reporting, avoid the outline format in favor of clear subtitles.

(U) Use uppercase roman numerals in the TUD of an army corps: VII Corps

(U) Use lowercase roman numerals in a hard-copy report for the page numbers of the CONTENTS and PREFACE, if any.

roundtable...

(U) For the sake of standardization and consistency in SIGINT writing, use the one-word form: The peace talks were held up until all sides agreed to engage in a roundtable discussion.

rules of grammar...

(U) The following is taken from Writing With A Purpose, by James McCrimmon:

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SECRET//SI



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S

SALT...

(U) Abbreviation for Strategic Arms Limitation Talks. Need not be expanded. Avoid the redundant phrase SALT talks.

same...

(U) Same has been in continuous use as a pronoun since the 14th century, usually in the expression *the same*: I'll have the same. It is most common in business contexts but also appears in literature.

same as...

(U) This adverbial phrase, while less common in writing than either "as" or "just as," is standard.

sans-serif...

(U) A type style without small horizontal strokes at the top and bottom of each letter. Generally used with larger point sizes, as in titles or headings.

satisfy...

SECRET//SI

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(U) Has been used in a sense synonymous with "convince" since at least 1620. Be careful of the context, however, or you may get some ambiguous statements: The family was satisfied that Rick had been murdered.

scan...

(U) Scan has two senses. The older is "examine thoroughly and carefully." The newer (dating back to the 1920s) and more usual sense today is "glance through or look over quickly."

(U) The easiest way to ensure that the sense is clear is to use an appropriate adverb with scan: Eileen thoroughly scanned the material. Mimi quickly scanned the text.

scarce...

(U) See the entry for rare, scarce.

scotch...

(U) The verb scotch originally meant "disable," not "destroy." Although some usage writers still contend that "disable" is the only acceptable meaning, the current meaning is "put an end to." Lew scotched the rumors about his resignation.

Scotch, Scottish, Scots...

(U) Use Scottish for people, Scotch for things: the Scottish children. Scotch pine.

(U) Use Scots in referring to law or language. Scots words and phrases.

Scud...

(U) A missile, not a rocket. Scud missile. See the entry for missile.

season...

(U) Lowercase the seasons and their derivatives unless part of a proper name: this summer. Summer Olympics.

seasonable, seasonal...

... ..

(U) Seasonable means "what is appropriate to the time of the year" or "timely": seasonable clothing. Its antonym is unseasonable, unseasonable weather.

(U) Seasonal means "dependent on or controlled by the season of the year": a seasonal increase in vacation travel, seasonal migration.

secretary general...

(U) No hyphen. Capitalize when it precedes a name (former UN Secretary General U Thant) or when it refers to a particular individual at the national or international level (The Secretary General is here).

section headings...

(U) See the entry for headings.

secure...

(U) Use ~~enciphered~~ rather than secure when describing communications. The term secure describes the vulnerability of a signal to cryptologic attack.

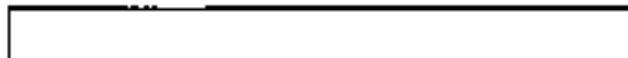
(U) An enciphered signal is always enciphered, but whether it is secure depends on the cipher used.

security control markings...

(U) Words or phrases added to restrict the dissemination of a sanitized report. At this time there are five such markings:

- OFCON - Dissemination and Extraction of Information Controlled by Originator
- NOFORN - Not Releasable to Foreign Nationals
- PROPIN - Proprietary Information Involved
- REL - Releasable to (name of the country)
- EYES ONLY - (used only on electrical reports in place of REL due to existing software limitations)

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(U) The marking PROPIN generally comes from collateral that is being used in a serialized report.

see where...

(U) The idiom see where is used to introduce a noun clause serving as the object of the verb. It is considered a characteristic of informal speech and writing. Avoid it in serialized reports.

seldom If ever, seldom or never...

(U) Both idioms are in common use in the 20th century, according to Merriam-Webster. The idiom seldom over, which has been around since about A.D. 1000, today is more frequently used in speech than in writing.

self...

(U) When self is a prefix added to another word, use a hyphen: self-defense, self-confessed. When self is the root word, omit the hyphen: selfless, selfsame.

semantics...

(U) The study of meaning. In general usage, semantics refers to the meanings of words, including their denotations, implications, connotations, and ambiguities.

semi...

(U) Use a hyphen after the prefix only to avoid doubling a vowel, especially "i," or tripling a consonant: semi-invalid, but semitinal; shell-like, but selfish.

semiannual...

(U) For clarity's sake, say twice a year. See the entry for biannual.

semicolon...

(U) Use a semicolon to link independent clauses not linked by and, but, or, nor, for, so, or yet: The package was due last week; it arrived today. Use the semicolon sparingly in this situation.

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(U) Use a semicolon to separate a series of items which themselves contain commas: Important figures in American literature include James Fenimore Cooper, author of the Leatherstocking Tales; Walt Whitman, author of Leaves of Grass; and Sinclair Lewis, author of Main Street.

(U) Make sure that the semicolon is used between elements of equal grammatical rank. Do not use a semicolon to separate a clause from a phrase.

(U) Place the semicolon outside quotation marks.

sentence...

(U) Sometimes the easiest way to solve a problem in a sentence is to get rid of the problem element. Ask yourself if the word or phrase or clause is necessary. Often you will find it isn't. Make every element--and every sentence--fill some useful function or get rid of it. Write with nouns and active verbs, not adjectives and adverbs.

(U) Do not follow blindly advice such as "Keep sentences short." Doing so often results in choppy writing. Avoid numerous complex clauses, but do vary the sentence length and structure to create a readable report. When a sentence does go on and on, try cutting it into two or more sentences.

sentence adverb...

(U) An adverb or adverbial phrase connected to an entire sentence rather than to a single element. The sentence adverb commonly expresses an attitude of the writer or speaker and permits the writer or speaker to express in a single word or phrase what would otherwise take a much longer form: Basically, Samantha is the most extroverted of my cousin's children. Hopefully, I will win this week's lottery.

(U) Sentence adverbs most often come at the beginning but may appear in other parts of the sentence as well: "This is one of the words that turn up: predictably, in the sports pages." (Harper Dictionary of Contemporary Usage, 1985, 2nd edition.)

(U) See the entry for hopefully.

sequence of tenses...

(U) See the entry for verb tense.

serial number...

4010 0000 0000 0000

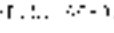
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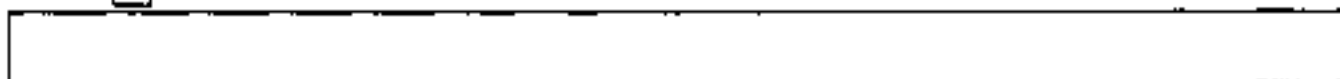
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~~(FOUO)~~  Serial numbers are assigned to NSA reports on a one-up annual basis according to the PDDG issuing the report. Every serial includes the classification level, the PDDG of the originator, and a one-up annual number, as in the following examples:

- 2/00/500123-10
- S/123-09
- S/00/50085-09
- E/00/10486-09
- 1/00/10023-10
- Z-3/123-10

(U//FOUO)  

(U//FOUO)  



serialization block..

(U) Place a serialization block on all hard-copy and video reports.

~~(U//FOUO)~~ Consult USSID CR1400, section 10, and the Desktop Publishing Standards for SIGINT Reporting manual for the format and placement of the serialization block on cover sheets and internal pages of hard-copy reports.

~~(U//FOUO)~~ USSID CR1400, section 11, contains full instructions on the format and placement of the serialization block in video serialized reports.

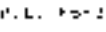
serialized reports...

(U) The primary means by which we provide foreign intelligence information to intelligence users, most of whom are not part of the SIGINT community. A report can be in electrical, hard-copy, video, or digital form, depending on the information's nature and perishability.

~~(U//FOUO)~~ The USSID CR14xx series (primarily USSID CR1400) governs the preparation and format of SIGINT serialized reports.

(U) See the entries for dissemination, product, SIGINT production information, target signals information, and technical report.

series...

(U//FOUO)  



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(U) See the comma entry for guidance on punctuation of items in a series.

serif...

(U) A type style that has small horizontal strokes at the top and bottom of letters. This style is more suitable to text than sans-serif.

serve, service...

(U) Use *serve* for "supply goods or services to": Our firm *serves* customers throughout New England.

(U) Use *service* for "repair or maintain": Mr. Handyman will *service* your appliances at the lowest price in town.

set, sit...

(U) Persons or things *sit*. Janet is *sitting* on the deck. The exceptions to this rule are *jelly*, *plaster*, and *concrete*. All these *set*.

(U) The sun and hens either *set* or *sit*, depending on the context: the sun *sets* in the west or the sun is *sitting* on the horizon; the hens are *sitting* on their eggs.

(U) When you mean "place," use *set*: The children *set* their books on the table when they came home from school.

sexism...

(U) See the entry for *gender*.

shall...

(U) The traditional rule for *shall* is to use it for the simple future in the first person: I *shall* go, we *shall* win. This continues to be the rule in British English, but has long been modified in American, Irish, and Scottish English.

(U) The "rule" was first stated in the 17th century by John Wallis in a grammar written in Latin for foreigners. But the "rule" did not reflect the general practice of his times or of earlier times. Merriam-Webster's evidence shows that *shall* and *will* have been used interchangeably since Middle English to express the simple future by writers ranging from Chaucer to Samuel Johnson to Byron.

(U) In modern American usage, there is no real distinction between *shall* and *will* in expressing the future except that *will* is more common: I *will* leave tomorrow.

(U) Nevertheless, there are some constructions where ~~shall~~ is more appropriate than ~~will~~. Use ~~shall~~:

- with pronouns of all persons to express determination: We ~~shall~~ overcome. You ~~shall~~ use good English in SIGINT reports.
- in laws, resolutions, and directives: All employees ~~shall~~ begin work at 8 a.m. and remain until 5 p.m.
- in questions that ask for an opinion, a preference, or a decision: ~~Shall~~ we stay or leave?

(U) See the entries for ~~should~~, ~~will~~, and ~~would~~.

~~she~~...

(U) Do not use this pronoun to refer to ships or nations. Use "it" instead.

s/he, ~~(SHEET)~~he...

(U) These are artificial forms intended to eliminate the gender-neutral problem in English. According to Merriam-Webster, s/he is chiefly American and ~~(SHEET)~~he is primarily British.

(U) Their use has been limited primarily to specialized journals in the fields of English language and linguistics. Both forms are unpronounceable, which works against their use becoming widespread.

(U) In signaled reports, avoid both forms. See the entry for gender.

~~ships~~...

~~(CAREL)~~ On first reference to ships of a foreign navy, give as much information as possible in the following order:

- country (unless already established)
- vessel class and type
- pennant number
- the ship name (see next entry)

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- hull number (in parentheses)

~~(S//REL)~~ Example: Zentian Kilo-class patrol submarine 135 Zigzag (Hull 945). In subsequent references, use the name or hull number, or if necessary the pennant number, but be consistent.

~~(S//REL)~~ On first reference to **merchant ships**, provide the following:

- country of flagging
- type of vessel
- name of ship (see next entry)
- gross tonnage (in parentheses)

~~(S//REL)~~ Example: The Zentian-flagged roll-on/roll-off ship Sea Horse (13,500 GT). In subsequent references, use the name only. If the ownership or chartering of a merchant ship is significant, include it in the body of the report.

~~(U//FOUO)~~ Refer to ships and submarines of the U.S. Navy or Coast Guard by vessel type and name. If additional information is necessary, place that information in a footnote.

[Redacted]

(U) See list and ship names.

100-100-100-100
100-100-100-100

ship names...

(U) In reports, italicize the name of a ship whenever possible. When italics are not possible, enclose the name in a pair of double quotation marks: "USS Nautilus," the "Flying Dutchman." Do not italicize a ship class: Delta-class, not *Delta-class*.

(U) In keeping with current journalistic style, capitalize only the first letter of the ship name or of a class of ships: USS Nautilus, Delta-class.

~~(U//FOUO)~~ For naval vessels, use the spelling given in Jane's Fighting Ships. For merchant vessels, use the spelling given in Lloyd's Registry. For vessels not listed in either Jane's or Lloyd's, spell the name as intercepted, using the annexes of USSID 406 if a special SIGINT transliteration system exists. Otherwise use standard BGN transliteration.

100-100-100-100

[Redacted]

5/5/2010

(U) Refer to a ship as "it," not "she."

short title...

(U) This term is sometimes used to refer to the report serial.

should...

(U) Use should:

- as an auxiliary to express a mild sense of obligation: I should go. We should help the needy.
- in all three persons in a conditional clause: If you should decide to go, call me.
- to indicate some doubt or uncertainty about what is being said: My sister should be home for Christmas.

(U) Also see the entries for shall, will, and would.

should of...

(U) The correct written expression is should have. Should of is an oral idiom.

[sic]...

(U) "Sic" is the Latin for "thus" and is used after a printed word or passage to indicate that it exactly reproduces the original and that the author realizes it may be perceived as an error. Ex. "We realized it would have a severe affect [sic] on the situation." Brackets rather than parentheses are used because the expression is that of the reporter and not of the original speaker. Ex. "The president said, 'I am proud to introduce the Prime Minister of India [sic], Benazir Bhutto.'" It can also be expressed as "The president introduced Benazir Bhutto as the Prime Minister of India (Ms. Bhutto is in fact the Prime Minister of Pakistan)."

(U) In serialized reports, avoid [sic] and use a footnote instead. This will prevent the problem of the reader not knowing whether [sic] was in the original or inserted by the reporter.

SIGAD...

(U//FOUO) Expands to SIGINT Activity Designator and is used to identify elements of the SIGINT system. USSID: SP0200

REF ID: A65102-01

5/3/2010

promulgates the SIGINT Address Book (SAB), which contains a full record of active SIGADs and PDDGs. To view a sorted PDDG or SIGAD list, check the S111 PDDG Listing.

(UNFOUO) SIGADs appear in the FM and TO lines of electrical reports and electrical PRECIS, and in the DISTRIBUTION section of hard-copy and video reports.

(U) See the entry for PDDG.

SIGINT...

(U) SIGINT (signals intelligence) is intelligence information derived from signals intercept comprising, either individually or in combination, all COMINT, ELINT, and FISINT, however transmitted.

SIGINTase.

(U) Try to avoid terms such as "co-located" in sanitized reports. You are reporting to people outside the SIGINT community who might not understand the special meaning of the word. Stick with standard American English as much as possible.

(UI) If you must use a term with a specialized SIGN meaning that will not be familiar to your readers, explain the term in the text or, preferably, in a footnote.

SIGINT product...

2014
 2015
 2016

(U) See the entries for product and for serialized reports

SiGINT production information (SPI)...

$$\frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{1}{2} \dot{\theta}^2 \right) = - \dot{\theta} \frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{1}{2} \dot{\theta}^2 \right)$$

5:72910

SIGINT report...

(U) See the entry for serialized reports.

similar...

(U) One thing is similar to another in a particular way. Two or more things are similar in certain ways.

simplicity...

(U) Simplicity is natural, direct expression. It allows the reader to understand, without struggle, what we are saying. Obstacles to simplicity are ornate words, jargon, passive voice, etc.

(U) See the entry for wordiness.

sink, sank, sunk...

(U) Both sank and sunk are used as the past tense of sink. Sank is more common, but sunk is not rare. In serialized reports, use sank.

situation...

(U) The general rule is to eliminate the word situation from coined phrases like weather situation and emergency situation. This is a greater concern in British English than in American English.

(U) Although a crisis situation is not quite the same as a crisis, readers will understand what you mean if you use the word crisis by itself.

(U) The phrase no-win situation, however, describes a complex idea in just a few words and is a common American idiom. Use it freely.

skeptic, skeptical...

(U) Skeptic and skeptical are the forms in American usage. The British spelling is sceptic, sceptical.

For more information:

5/7/2010

slant, slash, virgule...

(U) Avoid the use of a slant between terms in serialized reports. A coined term such as day/night training, for example, is not clear. Instead use one of the following: day or night training, day and night training, day training or night training or both.

(U) See the entry for and/or.

slow, slowly...

(U) Slow may be used as an adjective or adverb. Slowly is only an adverb.

(U) Slow was used as an adverb by Shakespeare and Swift, among others, but generally has a more restricted range of applications.

(U) Use *slow* after a verb of action or motion. The war moves *slow* if it moves at all (Robert Frost). *Slow* also can be used in hyphenated compounds with present participles: *slow-moving* vehicles.

(U) Slowly can precede or follow a verb and is more widely used in edited prose. Slowly also modifies participial adjectives. The slowly moving cars crept past the scene of the accident.

(U) See the entry for *Mal edwardsi*.

so-called...

(U) The use of quotation marks following so-called is not an error, but it is unnecessary: so-called friends, not so-called "friends." Omit the quotation marks.

30000

(U) Some is usually an indefinite pronoun or an adjective: Some arrived late. Some people are extroverts.

(U) Notional agreement determines whether pronoun *some* takes a singular or plural verb in the expression *some of*. *Some of them* were already here. *Some of the news* is not all so grim.

44) See the entry for national agreement.

1. $\frac{1}{2} \leq \frac{b}{a} \leq \frac{3}{2}$

5:72010

some and its compounds...

(U) Somebody, someone, someplace, someway, somewhat, and somewhere are written as one word. Someday is a single word when used as an adverb.

(U) For a discussion on the use of pronouns to refer to a compound form of an indefinite pronoun, like some, see the discussion at every and its compounds and the entry for notional agreement.

sometime, some time...

(U) As an **adjective** it is a single word, the original meaning of which is "former": a sometime cook, a sometime champion. Its newer meaning, dating back to the 1930s, is "occasional": a sometime thing.

(U) As an **adverb** it is a single word, meaning "at an unspecified or indefinite time": My parents left sometime yesterday on their trip to Paris and London.

(U) The **noun phrase** is written as two words: She needed some time alone. An easy way to determine if sometime should be one word or two is to insert the word "quite" before some. If the passage still makes sense, use the two-word form.

sortie...

(U) A military term meaning "an operational flight by one aircraft." Make sure that your meaning is clear.

- The aircraft flew six sorties during the exercise. (One aircraft flew six different times.)
- Six aircraft flew sorties during the exercise. (Six aircraft flew one time each.)
- Six bombers flew a total of 35 sorties. (The number of sorties per aircraft is unknown or insignificant.)

sort of...

(U) A common speech idiom. In written work, it appears most often in fictional speech or light prose.

(U) See the entry for kind of.

Soviet...

For more information, see

(U) An adjective pertaining to the former USSR and its elements. Do not use it to represent individuals. In today's world, always use it with the adjective "former": the former Soviet Rocket Forces, the former Soviet leadership.

Soviet Union...

(U) Acceptable in all references for the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics. USSR is also acceptable. The collapse of the Soviet Union has made these terms obsolete except for historical reference.

(U) No single term has evolved as of this writing to refer collectively to the group of republics formed out of the former Soviet Union, but consider something like "the successor states to the USSR."

spacecraft...

(U) The plural is also spacecraft.

spacing...

(U) As a general rule, leave a single space between the elements in a prosaic line and after each punctuation mark in text. Do not leave spaces, however, on either side of a dash or hyphen.

(U) In DTP formatting, spacing is more important because of proportional spacing and automatic justification features.

(U) Skipping a line after each paragraph is now the rule for the text of all reports. Skip two lines, however, before a subtitle and one line after.

(U) See the entry for indentation.

special...

(U) As an adjective, special is often used euphemistically by NATO to refer to nuclear weapons or intelligence operations. Thus, avoid phrases such as special weapons shipments and special intelligence reports.

(U) Others which should be used carefully are special purpose, which can refer to SPETSNAZ, and its U.S. equivalent special operations.

special characters...

11 12 13 14 15 16

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(U) See the entry for symbols.

U//FOUO, 3841218, 8/1/10

SPECIAL FOLLOW-UP...

(U) No series closure is necessary for SPECIAL FOLLOW-UPS.

specially...

(U) Use *specially* when referring to a particular purpose: *specially* trained troops.

(U) See the entry for *especially*.

species...

U//FOUO, 3841218, 8/1/10

(U) This word is spelled the same in both singular and plural.

SPECTRE...

speed...

(U) Report speed in kilometers per hour (kph), Mach (aircraft only), or knots (ships only). Use figures because speed is a measurement: The *Mirage* flew at a speed of 850 kph. The XY-53 tank has a top speed of 90 kph. Hyphenate the adjectival form: a 10-knot wind.

(U) Do not use traditional English measurements (e.g., miles per hour) or other nonmetric forms unless you are quoting directly. In such cases, include the metric equivalent in parentheses: 50 mph (80 kph) winds.

U//FOUO, 3841218, 8/1/10

5/7/2010

spelled, spelt...

(U) An example of *divided* usage. Spelled is more common in American usage; spelt in British usage.

spelling...

(U) See the complete entry for *spelling*.

spilled, spilt...

(U) Divided usage. Spilled is American; spilt is British.

split infinitive...

(U) The construction in which an adverb comes between the preposition "to" and the infinitive is called a split infinitive. In the ancient languages of Latin and Greek, the infinitive was a single word and thus could not be split.

(U) In English the infinitive is also a single word, even though many think of it as a two-word form including the preposition "to." Split infinitives have been traced back to the 14th century, but did not become an object of criticism until the mid-19th century.

(U) The split infinitive is *not* a grammatical error, but it is often unnecessary. Much of the time the adverb does not add anything useful to the sentence. For example, there is no real difference between "to understand" and "to truly understand." Even so, the split infinitive is no longer a major issue among grammarians.

(U) The best way to change a split infinitive is to delete the adverb unless it adds something useful to the sentence.

UNNECESSARY: Phil wanted to [really] understand my reasons for dropping out of school. USEFUL: We expect to more than triple our sales this year.

(U) Another way is to move the adverb to another position, particularly when emphasizing the adverb: Roger vowed to serve his country loyally. Do not avoid splits at all costs, but do avoid awkward or useless ones.

(U) If a split infinitive comes in a sentence after a negative, particularly "never" or "not," do *not* "split the infinitive". I intended never to return, but Paula said not to go.

spokesperson...

See also *Public Official*

(U) See gender and -person.

standard English...

(U) As defined by Merriam-Webster, standard English is "the language of business, literature, and journalism. It has evolved over the centuries as the means by which speakers of diverse dialects of English can communicate effectively with each other."

(U) When most usage commentators use the term, they tend to identify as standard English only those forms, words, and expressions of English that they personally agree with. Therefore, look on it with caution, just like the term "careful writer."

(U) See the entries for style and usage.

starboard...

(U) Nautical term. From the helmsman's point of view, the right side, as opposed to port, the left side.

state...

(U) It has been an article of faith since at least 1870 among some usage commentators that the verb state is overused. The editors at Merriam-Webster, however, have little evidence of such overuse. Their records show only that state is used "to imply a formal, precise, or emphatic declaration or report."

(U) There are, of course, many alternatives for the writer. You can use say, assert, comment, demand, declare, or other verbs whenever you wish to vary your word choice. But there is no valid reason to avoid using state.

statute mile...

(U) Measures 5,280 feet and is used for land measurements. Since it is a measurement, always use figures. The word statute is assumed and thus may be omitted when referring to land measurements.

(U) Convert statute miles to kilometers in serialized reports. To convert to kilometers, multiply miles by 1.6 (5 miles X 1.6 = 8 km). To convert to approximate nautical miles, multiply by .869.

(U) Use miles in serialized reports only when quoting directly. After miles place the metric equivalent: 50 miles (80 km).

(U) See the entries for mile and nautical mile.

U//FOUO

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strait...

(U) Capitalize when it is part of a proper name: the Bering Strait. The term is singular unless there is more than one passageway: the Danish Straits.

(U) Do not add the word *strait* after the Bosporus, the Dardanelles, the Kattegat, and the Skagerrak. All are preceded by "the": the Dardanelles.

style...

(U) See the complete entry for *style*.

sub...

submarine
submarine

(U) Never acceptable in serialized reports as a shortened form of the word "submarine."

subheading...

(U) A minor subject heading in the text of a report. Also referred to as a subtitle. Use subheadings in a lengthy report to help the reader's comprehension.

(U) Begin each subheading at the left margin. Skip one line before a subheading and one line after. Capitalize the initial letter of each word. Do not underline the words or insert any unnecessary spaces.

subject/topic component...

| |
|--|
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| |

(U//FOUO) If you need a new component, forward the request for the new component to PD521, OPS #1, 963-1931s. Include in the request your proposed element and a definition.

subjunctive...

(U) Although pundits have been proclaiming the death of the subjunctive for more than a century, it still exists in written English.

(U) Use the subjunctive mood in "if clauses" for "speculation or conditions contrary to fact": If it were to rain, it would ruin my plans. I would not do that if I were you.

(U) Since "if," "as if," and "as though" do not always introduce a "hypothetical or unreal condition," the subjunctive is not necessarily required after these terms: I do not know if he was a carpenter or a cardiologist.

(U) Use the subjunctive to express doubts or wishes: I wish it were true. I doubt if more money would be the answer.

submarine...

(U) Do not use the abbreviation "sub" for this word. See the entries for ships and ship names.

subordination...

(U) Unless military unit subordination is essential to understanding the report, put it in a footnote.

subsequent to...

(U) Normally used in very formal writing. It usually can be replaced by "after" but be cautious. Subsequent to can imply that something not only follows but also in some way grows out of or is closely connected to what precedes it. Subsequent to Mary's appointment as supervisor, office morale improved greatly.

substandard...

(U) In most dictionaries, substandard refers only to speech patterns and is an indicator of social status, not correctness.

(U) In much usage commentary, substandard is applied to words and constructions that do not accord with the commentator's notion of good English.

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(U) See the entry for nonstandard

such...

(U) Such has been used as a pronoun since the time of King Alfred the Great. It is standard English, but is more common in writing than in speech.

such as...

(U) When introducing examples, such as usually follows a comma. Fred prefers team sports, such as baseball, football, and basketball.

surtable...

(U) Most commonly followed by the preposition "for" and less often by "to."

superlative of two...

(U) One of the great shibboleths of modern purists. The "rule" against using the superlative when dealing with two was created in the mid- to late 18th century and has never reflected actual usage. It serves no useful purpose since no one will misunderstand the sentence no matter which form you use. Consider the following examples: Who is the older of the two? Who is the oldest of the two? Both forms are clear.

(U) According to Merriam-Webster, writers since the time of Shakespeare have used both the superlative and comparative in comparing two things. The superlative seems to be most likely when the judgment, measurement, or characteristic denoted by the adjective or adverb is the primary point being considered. "dingily, dingey. The first is best" (H. W. Fowler).

(U) The comparative is required only when it is followed by "than": Janet is smarter than Lynn. In any other construction, either the comparative or superlative form may be used without confusing the reader.

superscript...

(U) Use superscript numbers as footnote indicators whenever possible. Place the superscript number immediately after the item it references.

(U) Begin the footnote with the superscript number, then indicate the abbreviated classification, and enter the actual footnote

U.S. PUBLIC LAW

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(U) See the box for footnotes.

sure, surely...

(U) Both are used as adverbs. Sure is used as an intensifier, particularly of verbs, when the writer expects the reader to agree: Paul sure is in a bad mood today.

(U) Surely is used as an intensifier in more formal contexts, often with a more speculative or hopeful tone: That approach will surely lead to a solution.

surveil...

(U) A back-formation, dating to 1949, from the noun surveillance. The verb form has been recognized as early as Merriam-Webster's 8th New Collegiate Dictionary (1979 edition) and the American Heritage Dictionary (1992).

(U) Like most new words, surveil draws criticism and writers are urged to avoid it. The real question, however, is whether it fills a unique need. Is there another word that conveys the same meaning?

(U) Since the suggested verb alternatives (watch, observe, note) do not convey quite the same idea of something more than passive watching, surveil seems to be a worthwhile addition. Go ahead and use it, but be prepared for the howls of purists.

suspended hyphens...

(U) See the box on hyphens.

sustain...

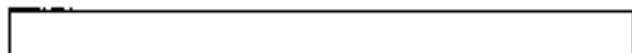
(U) Since 1866, when the first objection was noted, some commentators have criticized sustain in the sense of "suffer or undergo." This sense of sustain, however, has been traced back to the early 1400s and was included in the dictionaries of Samuel Johnson and Noah Webster. It is standard.

symbols...

(U) The following list comprises the only symbols authorized for inclusion in the text of SIGINT reports:

- A1 @

CONFIDENTIAL



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- Apostrophe '
- Colon :
- Comma ,
- Number Symbol #
- Dash -
- Dollar Symbol \$
- Exclamation Point !
- Parentheses ()
- Period .
- Quotation Mark "
- Semicolon ;
- Slant /
- Question Mark ?

(U) Word processing capabilities and unique character sets may be available to reporters; the ability to create a word such as *Ataché* or 10% does not mean it can be used in end product reports. Punctuation or symbols included on some keyboards or instruments may not be used; spell out the word or use an abbreviation instead.

(U) For clarity, the following list includes some, but not all, of the prohibited symbols:

- Ampersand &
- Plus +
- Asterisk *
- Percent sign % (see percent per cent)
- Tilde ~
- Accent grave `

(U//~~FOUO~~) Webbing, Wingding, Dingbats, Bookshelf symbol, or any other font to include Arabic, Greek, Cyrillic, Chinese, Korean, Hebrew, and diacritical marks to include umlauts, accents, and circumflexes, may not be used in SIGINT end product reporting.

synagogue...

(U) Capitalize only when it is part of a name: Beth Israel Synagogue, but the synagogue.

(U) See the entry for church.

FOUO FOUO FOUO

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Content Forward: Reporting Board, S12RB 953-5545
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12RB 953-5545

 *Reporting Page*

Last Modified: December 26, 2009
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2010

Classified On: N/A/2010 Mar 01 - 10, 04/08/2010 Security on: 2010 Jul

~~SECRET~~ (S)

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10. 10. 10. 10. 10. 10.

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[Redacted]

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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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T

table...

(U) Because the verb "to table" means opposite things to U.S. and to Second Party readers, do not use in SIGINT reporting. U.S. usage indicates a delay or postponement ("this agenda item was tabled until the next meeting pending further investigation") while British and Commonwealth usage is the converse - ("the committee tabled the new proposal during the negotiations over the border demarcation"). Suitable alternatives include "delayed," "set aside," "postponed discussion" - or, if you are a Second Party reporter, "brought up for discussion," "laid out," or "presented."

table of contents...

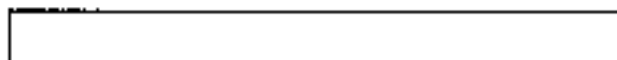
(U) Use a table of contents for lengthy, hard-copy reports. They rarely are needed on electrical or video reports.

(U) Use the modern label "CONTENTS" rather than "TABLE OF CONTENTS." Otherwise follow the guidance in USS D CR1400 and in the Desktop Publishing Standards for SIGINT Reporting manual.

tabular material...

(U) When making a table as a graphic element in a serialized report, follow the principles of good layout and design.

(U) Place the caption above the table and the classification, if needed, in double parentheses below the table and any footnotes



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(U) Use abbreviations as needed to make the material fit the format, but expand the abbreviations in a footnote or appendix.

(U) See USSIP CR1400 and the Desktop Publishing Standards for SIGINT Reporting manual.

TAGs...



(U) See the entries for ISI, subject/topic component, and principal component for more specific guidance.

take...

(U) Use take when the movement is away from the speaker: Take your money and get out of here

(U) Use either take or bring when the direction of movement is unknown or unrelated to the speaker: She brought him to the doctor's office or She took him to the doctor's office

(U) See the entry for bring.

TANGO...



5/2/2010

(U) Phonetic spelling for the letter "t."

U//FOUO, 05/10

target digraphs...

[REDACTED]

(U) See the entry for TIS.

target signals information...

[REDACTED]

(U) Do not include TSI in a sanitized report unless the TSI is of intelligence value to all the recipients, which is not usually the case. Generally, TSI appears in tailored reports with a limited distribution.

(U) See the entry for SIGINT production information.

U//FOUO, 05/10

Technical Identification System...

(U) See the entry for TIS.

technical report...

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

(U) SIGINT technical reports are not intended to be--and should not be--another way of doing all-source analysis and passing that to intelligence users. That is not within NSA's charter.

U//FOUO, 05/10

[REDACTED]

5/7/2010

technical weapons...

(U) [REDACTED]

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 DocID: 3847218

telephone...

(U) "cell phone" vs. "mobile phone": It is true that most mobile phones now do not use cell technology and that therefore "mobile phone" is more accurate. It is also true that most Americans call all mobile phones "cell phones" now, and our Commonwealth partners tend to stick with "mobile." Some target countries use one term, and some the other. Decide whether this is really an issue in your reporting before you ask for arbitration, or is it just a matter of translation, or is it an indicator of the type of technology, and, if the latter, does it make a difference to your intelligence product?

temperature...

(U) Report temperature in Celsius and use figures for all readings except zero. Use the word "minus" rather than a minus sign to indicate temperatures below zero. The low was minus 20 C. "Degrees" is not needed except after "zero."

(U) Place a capital "C" after a number; spell out Celsius when no number is used and in the phrase "zero degrees Celsius."

tend to...

(U) Tend to in the sense of "pay attention to" is standard American usage: Tend to your own business.

tense...

(U) See the entry for verb tense.

text...

(U) The text of a report includes a summary statement or paragraph, known as the lead; full details of the activity and any analytic comments, known as the body; and any footnotes.

(U) The text is normally written in narrative style, but when a formatted or mixed format approach is more useful to the reader, go ahead and use that style.

than...

DocID: 3847218

(U) Use the nominative case after *than* when *than* serves as a conjunction introducing the second element of an unequal comparison: Pauline is a better athlete *than I*.

(U) When used as a preposition, *than* often follows "more" or "better," and a following element is in the accusative: He disliked no one *more than her*. She liked him better *than me*. (NOTE: *Than* has been used as a preposition since the 16th century.)

that...

(U) *That* as a relative pronoun may refer to either persons or things. Use *that* to introduce a restrictive clause when the sentence sounds or looks awkward without it.

(U) Although there are no hard-and-fast rules about when to omit *that*, you may omit it after forms of the verbs *believe*, *hope*, *say*, and *think*: I believe *(that)* you are correct. I hope *(that)* you will join us. The President said *(that)* he will sign the bill. You also may omit *that* when it serves as the object of the verb in a relative clause: He is a man *(that)* I know well. Elton is the candidate *(that)* I support.

(U) It is easier to state when you *must* use *that*.

- when a time element comes between the verb and the dependent clause
- when the dependent clause comes at the beginning of the sentence
- when the dependent clause comes after certain verbs, such as *assert*, *declare*, *estimate*, *point out*, and *propose*
- before dependent clauses beginning with conjunctions such as *after*, *because*, *before*, *until*, and *while*
- at the beginning of each of a series of parallel clauses
- in appositive clauses after nouns like *wish*, *desire*, and *belief*

(U) Keep in mind that including *that* is not always necessary, but never wrong. Omitting *that* when it should be there can confuse the reader.

their...

(U) *Their* is a possessive pronoun and normally has a plural antecedent: They went to *their* jobs every morning. The plural

antecedent is sometimes implicit rather than explicit, as with collective nouns or compounds like everyone and everybody: The couple said their vows. Everybody should pick up their hat and coat.

(U) Also see the entries for gender, notional agreement, and they, their, them.

there is, there are...

(U) Begin sentences with these expressions sparingly, not because there is anything wrong with them grammatically, but rather because many people object to them as wordy.

(U) In this structure, there is an "anticipatory subject," a very old and very common form in English. In most cases, the proper verb form is determined by the number of the following true subject. There is a time for all things. There are many people here.

they, their, them...

(U) These pronouns have been used as common-gender pronouns at least since Chaucer to refer to persons of either sex or of unknown sex: Every one of them demonstrated their musical skill. This is based on the principle of "notional agreement" and the lack of sexual identification in the plural pronouns.

(U) When used with singular nouns such as person, human being, and fool, these pronouns function as a common-number pronoun when the singular noun to which they refer stands for and includes any or all, even if gender is obvious: No man takes a job expecting to be fired, but sometimes they do get fired. Any fool can show their ignorance in public. Both uses are standard.

(U) See the entries for gender, notional agreement, and their.

they're...

(U) Do not use this contraction in serialized reports.

think...

(U) Avoid this verb in serialized reports unless quoting directly. We rarely know what a target "thinks." Also, do not say "we think" in a comment or in the conclusions of a report. Just state the comment or conclusions.

Third World...

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15

5/7/2010

(U) Refers to the economically developing nations of Africa, Asia, and Latin America. These countries are also known as "less developed countries" (LDCs).

(U) Do not confuse this political term with the political term non-aligned, which with the collapse of the former USSR now may be obsolete.

threesome...

(U) Generally used as a golf term. Avoid it in serialized reports.

thus, thusly...

(U) Thusly is more common than thus when the adverb follows the verb and precedes a colon. Paul directed him thusly: "Go straight about 2 miles, then turn left." More common than either thus or thusly is a phrase such as "In this way" or "as follows."

(U) Thusly is not wrong, but it is uncommon. It is a distinct adverb used in a distinct way. If you prefer not to use it, try one of the more common expressions.

till...

(U) Both till and until are acceptable. Till is the older form and has been traced back to the 9th century. Till is less common at the beginning of a sentence or clause, but can be used in such constructions. Do not use the variant spelling 'til.

(U) See the entry for until.

time...

(U) Use ZULU time in all reports: 1345Z, 0800Z. In the Universal Time System, which is the basis for ZULU time, both 0000 and 2400 are valid. You can use either form at your discretion. (NOTE: modern computer systems tend to require the use of 0000 rather than 2400.)

(U) The phrase ALL TIMES ZULU may precede the summary of a report containing a large number of time entries to avoid adding the designator "Z," which is always capitalized, to every time entry. If you are not using the phrase ALL TIMES ZULU, add the "Z" to each time entry. Bombing runs occurred at 0815Z, 0827Z, 0840Z, and 0858Z.

(U) Do not use a hyphen to express time ranges except in listings. Phrases like during the 0800 ZULU hour are acceptable, but

avoid indefinite ones, such as during the morning ZULU hours. Express time in the shortest possible form, avoiding phrases like "during the period from" and "time frame."

(U//FOUO) Enter local time when it has intelligence value to the reader. Such entries are particularly useful in local support efforts and can include itineraries of officials and events occurring at unexpected times. If you include local time in a report, place the ZULU time immediately after within a pair of parentheses or, if many times are given, in a footnote with a statement such as "all local times are ZULU plus four."

(U) See the entry for date.

$$1 - \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{1}{2} \right)^n = 1 - \frac{1}{2^{n+1}}$$

times less...

(U) Some people object to the phrase "ten times less" and similar wordings on the grounds that times in mathematics is used to compare a greater amount to a lesser one. This objection is an attempt to apply mathematical logic to the understanding of language.

(U) In language, however, there is no confusion about what is meant, and phrases like this one are perfectly acceptable and readily understood.

T|S...

“ : l. l. 15. ”

5:25:32.1

(U//FOUO) Analysts and reporters who seek additions, changes, or deletions to TIS-approved standards must work through their Group representative. Contact P3521 if you do not know who that is.

title...

(U) Some intelligence users base their decision on whether to read a report solely on the title. Make yours count. Use the title to get your reader's attention.

(U) The title should contain the most important SIGINT fact and, if possible, its significance. Keep it accurate, specific, short (preferably no more than two lines), and in the active voice. Include a date or time only when it is both well-defined and important to the intelligence fact.

(U) Most titles are in headline or telegraphic style, i.e., they omit articles, connectives, and other words not necessary for understanding. EXAMPLE: Pandora Declares Independence; Asks U.S. Military Aid

(U) Capitalize only the first letter of significant words: Doe Elected Speaker of the National Assembly; General Zag Calls for Calm after Earthquake.

(U) Remember to place the abbreviated classification of the title at the end in parentheses. Base the classification on the information in the title, not on the overall classification of the report, even though they may coincide.

(U) In titles, use punctuation as follows:

- a comma to represent "and"
- a semicolon to represent an "end of thought"
- a colon to represent "equals"

title after a name...

(U) Capitalize only national-level titles (Cabinet-level or above) that appear after a name. Jane Doe, Minister of Defense

(U) Lowercase and set off with commas most other titles that appear after a name. John Doe, the deputy assistant minister of culture, arrived yesterday.

3/7/2010 11:11:37 AM

3/7/2010

(U) See the entries for courtesy titles, military rank, and religious titles.

title before a name...

(U) Capitalize a formal title appearing before a name: President Jane Doe, Assistant Secretary John Jones.

(U) Do not capitalize a title that serves primarily as an occupational designator: astronaut John Doe.

(U) Capitalize the word acting in Acting President, but not elect or designate: President-elect.

(U) See the entries for courtesy titles, military rank, and religious titles.

title caption...

(U//~~FOUO~~) A title caption is a short preface assigned by NSA or one of its SIGINT partners for general subject matter. Title captions are optional on serialized reports. The proper format for title captions is target/ topic, with no more than two targets listed in alphabetical order and separated by a hyphen. Example: France-Italy: Trade Negotiations.

(U//~~FOUO~~) The group-level staffs will assign all title captions. Outside normal duty hours, the SRO in NSOC will assign temporary captions if a need exists.

title slug...

(U//~~FOUO~~) A short, coined title preface assigned by NSA for a specified event or activity of short duration, or to a very specific and narrowly-defined topic. Use a title slug to tie several reports together or to alert the intelligence user to a subject of specific interest.

(U//~~FOUO~~) Title slugs should be no more than a few words to identify the subject of the report. EXAMPLES: Black Plague Epidemic, Valkyrian Invasion, Zendian Crisis, Widget Import Negotiations.

(U) Slugs are not required on serialized reports, but once established should be used on all reports related to that slug. The group-level staffs will establish all title slugs during normal duty hours. Outside normal duty hours, the SRO in NSOC will assign temporary title slugs.

(U) Capitalize only the initial letter of significant words in a title slug.

... ..

5/7/2010

ton...

(U) A metric ton equals 1,000 kilograms or about 2,200 pounds. List metric tons in a serialized report. Abbreviate it as MT after a first reference, especially in listings. Abbreviate gross tons as "GT."

(U) A short ton equals 2,000 pounds or .91 metric tons. A long ton, also known as a British ton, equals 2,240 pounds or 1.02 metric tons.

too...

(U) In the sense of "also," it is set off by commas: This, too, shall pass.

(U) The use of too at the beginning of a sentence or a clause is correct, but it is not common.

total...

(U) Use the phrase a total of at the beginning of a sentence or when its omission might confuse the reader: A total of 1,534 people participated. Three aircraft flew a total of seven sorties. In most cases, just use the actual number within the sentence: There were 350 T-72 tanks at Fort Moniem, 250 at Fort Webster, and 225 at Fort Oxford. The aircraft flew four sorties.

(U) The adjective total is used for emphasis with nouns such as "annihilation" or "destruction." It can be omitted, but be aware that the sentence will not have quite the same rhythm.

totalitarian...

(U) Avoid. See the entry for authoritarian.

toward, towards...

(U) Divided usage. Toward is American; towards is chiefly British.

trademark...

(U) A one-word form designating a sign or name secured by legal registration and used to distinguish one product from another. Capitalize the initial letter of a trademark. Xerox, Pontiac, Windows.

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5/7/2016

(U) Many words that originated as trademarks have now passed into English as part of the common vocabulary. Such words are not capitalized: e.g., aspirin, kerosene, nylon.

(U) Some trademark names are used as verbs. In such cases, the trademark is capitalized while the verb form is not: e.g., Xerox (name), xerox (verb).

traffic...

(U) Add the letter "k" before the "-ed" and "-ing" verb forms and before the "-er" in the noun "trafficker."

training...

(U) Training is military activity associated with developing or increasing individual or unit combat efficiency.

(U) See exercise and operations

transit...

(U) While some commentators suggest avoiding transit as a verb, there is no objective reason for doing so. It has been a verb since the 15th century.

transition...

(U) A word or phrase used at the end or beginning of a sentence or paragraph to increase the readability or flow of a report. Words and phrases such as meanwhile, therefore, in other activity, and the next day serve as aids to the reader. Use them, but don't force them.

transliteration...

(U//~~FOUO~~) Transliterate, in accordance with the guidelines in USSID 406, foreign words and names used in a serialized report. For most (but not all) languages, use the Board on Geographic Names transliteration system for that language.

(U) Also see the entries for foreign phrases and words and for placename.

trillion...

12-01-11 16:16

5/7/2010

(U) When listing large amounts, always spell out trillion rather than writing out the numerical form: U.S. \$5 trillion, not U.S. \$5,000,000,000,000.

true unit designator...

(U) The abbreviation TUD is acceptable in listings, but expand it on the first reference in text.

(U) See the entry for arbitrary unit designator.

try and, try to...

(U) Try and has been in use since the 17th century and may be older than try to. It has been common in print for about 150 years. The use of and between two verbs when "to" might be expected has been traced back to the 13th century.

(U) The basis for the objection to try and is the assumption that try must be followed by the infinitive form, which supposedly includes the preposition to. But to is not part of the infinitive form. (See the entries for infinitive and split infinitive.) Infinitives are used in many constructions without to, usually following verbs like go, come, and try (e.g., go play outside).

(U) Try and appears in fixed form and is always followed by the infinitive: Try and join us for lunch. Among the authors who have used try and are Austen, Dickens, Thackeray, Melville, Eliot, Twain, Fitzgerald, and White.

(U) If you inflect try or insert an adverb, however, you must use try to: He is trying to behave. You must try never to treat others badly. A negative may precede try and, but a negative after try requires to: Don't try and cheat me. Try not to cheat her.

(U) Try and is more informal than try to and appears more often in speech and casual writing, but it is not wrong. For very formal writing, use try to.

TUD...

(U) See true unit designator.

type, type of...

(U) Many handbook writers object to the use of type as an attributive modifier (e.g., a summary type report) on the grounds that type is a noun and should not be used as an adjective. However, attributive nouns (such as apple in apple pie) are common in English and there is no grammatical reason why type should not be used in this way. (See the entry for attributive.)

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(U) Strangely, the use of a hyphen in technical and general contexts makes this kind of structure more acceptable to most usage commentators: a summary-type report. The construction is more common in speech and in technical and business usage than in academic or general prose.

(U) Most commentators recommend using type of in place of the attributive type in writing. Type of is most appropriate when reference is made to a well-defined or sharply distinct category. This type of sentence contains a compound verb. Make sure that type of is necessary to the sentence. It often can be omitted.

(U) See entries for kind of and sort of.

type size...

(U) Always given in points. In printing there are 72 points per inch. For DTP-formatted reports, the standards for titles, text, footnotes, and other parts of a report are listed in the Desktop Publishing Standards for SIGINT Reporting manual.



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Content Steward: Reporting Board, S12RB, 963-5645
 Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12PB, 963-5645



Reporting Page

Last Midnight: September 21, 2007
 Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2007

Classified for SIGINT by NSA on 12 March 2007. Declassify on: OADR/FOI

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Friday, May 7, 2010

The Reporting Page
One stop always for all your reporting needs!

ga reporting

(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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U

UI, UNID...

(U) In serialized reports, use the common SIGINT abbreviations for unidentified (UI and UNID) only in a listing. In narrative text and footnotes, always spell out unidentified.

UK, United Kingdom...

(U) Use the abbreviation for the United Kingdom either as a noun or adjective. The UK participated in the exercise; UK policy. In most cases, use British for the adjective rather than UK.

(U) In titles and ordinary text, it is sometimes better to spell out United Kingdom as a noun: Zenshan President Doe to Visit United Kingdom.

un...

(U) Add a hyphen when it precedes a capitalized word: un-American.

"un" words...

(U) Avoid indiscriminately using negative terms such as undisclosed, unspecified, unknown, unlocated, etc.

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(U) See negative modifiers.

unaware, unawares...

(U) Unaware is most often an adjective, but also can function as an adverb. Unawares is solely an adverb.

(U) Both forms have been used as adverbs since the 1600s, but unaware is far more common in adverbial uses.

under secretary...

(U) The GPO Style Manual and older editions of the Merriam-Webster dictionaries list under secretary as a two-word form, which is how it appears in the United States Government Manual. This title, however, is shifting to a one-word form in general use. The Merriam-Webster Collegiate Dictionary, 10th edition (published in 1993), lists undersecretary as one word. For serialized reports, however, continue using the two-word form.

(U) Capitalize this title only when it is used before a name: Under Secretary Jane Doe, but Jane Doe, the under secretary for natural resources.

(U) When under secretary is preceded by a modifier, such as "deputy" or "assistant," keep it as a two-word form. Deputy Under Secretary Glenn Barry.

under way ..

(U) One word when used as an adjective: underway replenishment. Two words as an adverb: We are under way.

NOTE: (U) Merriam-Webster reports an increasing tendency over the last 20 years to print under way as a single word, but finds the two-word form still more common as of 1988.

unequivocally ..

(U) Avoid the form unequivocably, which is nonstandard. The standard form is unequivocally.

UNIFORM...

(U) Phonetic spelling for the letter "u."

U//FOUO//NOFORN

5/7/2010

uninterested...

(U) The original meaning of uninterested in the 17th century was "unbiased." This meaning was replaced by the modern sense "lacking any interest in," which first appeared in 1777.

(U) Avoid using it in its original sense of "impartial" or "unbiased," where it has been replaced by disinterested.

(U) See the entry for disinterested.

unique...

(U) Purists tell us that unique means "having no like or equal" and that it cannot be modified by adverbs of degree. The evidence shows, however, that unique has been so modified for more than 150 years in speech and general prose by authors such as Charlotte Brontë, Lewis Carroll, and Arthur Millar.

(U) There are four senses in use today, the least common of which is the original sense of "the only one, single": Is that a unique copy?

(U) The use approved by purists is the second sense of "having no like or equal". It was a unique performance. In this sense, unique can be modified by adverbs such as "almost," "nearly," and "practically": a curious, almost unique turn of affairs (New Yorker, August 1983).

(U) In the third sense, unique is used with "to" and has the meaning "distinctly characteristic" or "peculiar": a condition unique to winter exercises.

(U) The fourth sense, and most controversial one, is the sense of "unusual," "distinctive," or "rare." It is the one most often modified by adverbs: an extremely unique approach to the problem. It often means not only "standing alone" but also "having unusual excellence."

(U) Many writers and editors (but by no means all) strongly disapprove of unique in the sense of "unusual," even though such usage is quite common in general prose and very common in speech. For that reason it is probably better to avoid using it, but it is not wrong.

(U) Editors who revise passages where unique is modified by an adverb should not delete the adverb but rather should replace unique with an uncontroversial synonym, such as "rare" or "unusual."

UNCLASSIFIED

5/7/2018

United Nations...

(U) Do not use any periods in the abbreviation UN. Be sure to add a hyphen when appending UN to another word, such as a UN-sponsored relief mission.

(U) Always use uppercase letters for acronyms for UN organizations: UNICEF.

United States...

(U) May be spelled out in full or abbreviated as either a noun or adjective. The United States, the U.S., United States policy, U.S. policy. The full spelling is more common as a noun, the abbreviation more common as an adjective.

(U) For consistency with past practice, use periods. Do not insert a space between the letters of the abbreviation.

unknown...

(U) Enclose unknown in a pair of parentheses when it is used after a noun: Zeddie instructed Ambassador Zed to purchase up to 20 tons of raw materials for "slave" (unknown).

(U) Avoid the abbreviation "UNK" except in listings.

unlocated...

(U) Enclose unlocated in a pair of parentheses when it is used after a placename: Metropolis (unlocated).

(U) Avoid the abbreviation "UL" except in listings.

until...

(U) Both till and until are acceptable. Until is a more recent word, dating back only to the 12th century. Until is more formal than till, and it is more likely at the beginning of a sentence or clause.

(U) See the entry for till.

up...

10 20 30 40 50 60

(U) The idiomatic particle *up* follows many verbs, such as *bring*, *hurry*, *rise*, and *climb*. Some commentators consider *up* to be unnecessary in most of these combinations and recommend dropping “*up*.”

(U) The “*savings*” to you and the reader will be all of two letters and one space. Don’t worry about it; let “*up*” fall where it will idiomatically.

upcoming...

(U) Formed in the same way as *ongoing*, *upcoming* has never been as widely disparaged by usage commentators. As is the case with *ongoing*, there is no objective reason to avoid using the word. It is standard.

uppercase...

(U) One word. Another way of saying capital letters.

usage...

(U) See the complete entry for *usage*.

user...

(U) Generally paired with the word “*intelligence*” in the phrase *intelligence user*. It is the preferred designator for the recipient of serialized reports.

(U) See *consumer*, *customer*, *user*.

user letters...

U.S. persons...

FOUO
12131-P-1 95-26

~~FOUO~~ ☐ U.S. persons may be identified by name or personal identifier in serialized reports only in life-threatening situations or when their inclusion has been approved by the DDO or the DDO's designee.

~~FOUO~~ ☐ Senior officials in the executive branch of the U.S. government may be identified by title if that title is necessary to understand or assess the intelligence information. Use only those titles listed in the most recent edition of the United States Government Manual.

(U) In all other cases, use a generic term such as U.S. person, U.S. official, or U.S. company. The identities of those identified in generic terms (such as U.S. person) may not be disseminated in any form (i.e., written or oral) to users except in response to specific requests, and even then only with the approval of the DDO or the DDO's designee. Refer any request for a U.S. identity to P0522 (963-3968s).

USSID SP0018...

(U/FOUO) This USSID defines who is a U.S. person for collection, processing, reporting, and dissemination purposes.

USSR...

(U) Acceptable in all references for Soviet Union or Union of Soviet Socialist Republics. This term is now obsolete except as a historical reference and generally should be preceded by the adjective "former", the former USSR.

utilize...

(U) Utilize is a distinct word that suggests a deliberate decision to employ someone or something for a practical purpose. It often implies making productive something that had not been productive before or finding a new use for something. In serialized reports, however, it is rarely used in these specific senses.

(U) Utilize suffers from two "sins". It is two syllables longer than use and it ends in -ize (see -ize). As a result, it draws the wrath of many usage commentators, who see it as wordy and pretentious.

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(U) As in many usage issues, it is easier to go along than try and overcome strongly held, though erroneous, opinions. Therefore, follow the cliché: don't use ut4ize, utilize use.

UTM Grids...

(U) If required by the intelligence user, include UTM (Universal Transverse Mercator) grids along with geographic coordinates. List the grid or site number after the coordinates and separated by a space. Do not include spaces, hyphens, or decimal points within the UTM coordinates.

(U) When the practice better serves the user, list the UTM grids before the geographic coordinates



Content Steward: Reporting Board, S12RB, 963-5845
 Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12RB, 963-5845



Last Modified: February 23, 2001
 Last Created: Site Review: January 4, 2001

Classified in accordance with 1.2.2.2 dated 10/1/2001. Declassify on: AFR 2025

SECRET//SI

U.S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE
 1:2001 O-211-70-000

U.S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE

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Friday, May 7, 2010

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IRAN "go reporting"

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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

SECRET//SI
DOCID: 3841218
PUBLISHED: 11/1/95

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DOCID: 3841218

V

validity...

(U//FOUO) In SIGINT reports, use validity words (possibly, probably, etc.) to express ideas that are not known to be complete, accurate, and reliable.

- When information has been established beyond a doubt, state the fact.
- When there is evidence almost sufficient to permit certainty, use words like probably, likely, and evidently.
- When the evidence is less complete, use possibly, may, or might.
- When there is little evidence, but it points to valid information, use words like suggests, tentuous, or suspected.

(U) See possible, possibly.

validity marker...

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various of...

(U) Various is sometimes used as a pronoun and is followed by of. The usage dates back to at least 1877, and many pundits have condemned it, claiming that turning the adjective various into a pronoun is not acceptable. The pundits, however, do not explain why various differs from adjectives like several, some, all, many, few, and certain, all of which are used as pronouns.

(U) If you use various as a pronoun, you can be sure that some of your readers will regard it as a mistake, even though it isn't.

verb...

(U) Verbs are the most important words in the sentence. Use them carefully and precisely. Put your verbs in the active voice to make them carry the strength of your report.

(U) Try not to use passive voice, which weakens a sentence, more often than necessary. Remember, however, that passive voice is sometimes the proper choice.

(U) See the entries for notional agreement, split infinitive, active voice, passive voice, and verb tense.

verbal.

(U) The definition of verbal in the dictionaries of Samuel Johnson (1755) and Noah Webster (1828) was "spoken, not written." This sense has been traced back to at least 1591, about 35 years earlier than the synonymous sense of oral.

(U) The first objection to this sense, based on the etymology of verbal, was raised in 1881--almost 400 years after the sense was established. Most modern commentators prefer oral in this sense over verbal, usually arguing that the multiple meanings of verbal can be confusing.

(U) Verbal in the sense of "spoken" has been used by Pepys, Fielding, Swift, and Dickens, among others, and its use is rarely ambiguous or confusing. If you see that a particular context may be ambiguous, you may use oral instead, but such instances probably will be rare.

(U) See the entries for oral and for etymological fallacy.

verbal noun...

(U) See the entry for gerund.

verb tense...

(U) In a SIGINT report, tense should be based on three factors:

- when the traffic was transmitted
- what it says
- when the reader will see the report.

b. 1.
 b. 1.1.1. 4.1.1.1.

→(S [redacted]) Don't say a meeting will occur on 7 November if it is already 7 November or later. On the other hand, don't say a meeting was held on 7 November if the traffic was intercepted on 3 November and you are writing and issuing the report on 4 November.

(U) Avoid distorting the facts or confusing the reader by using improper time sequence or by shifting tense unnecessarily in a sentence or paragraph.

→(S [redacted]) In titles, use present or future tense (or the infinitive) rather than past tense. *Zenith Elects Doe* (not *Doe Elected*) in

b. 3. 3.1.1. 4.1.1.1.

5/7/2010

Zendia), or Zendian President Will Visit (or To Visit) France.

versus...

(U) Do not abbreviate *versus* in a sentence. The abbreviation "vs." is acceptable in listings.

very...

(U) Use sparingly. Like most intensifiers, it loses force when used too often.

vessel...

(U) See the entries for *boat* and *ships*.

vice...

(U) Avoid it as a synonym for "not" or "instead of."

(U) *Vice* is a separate word in titles or ranks: *vice president*, *vice admiral*. Capitalize it when it is part of the formal title of a national-level figure: *Vice President Jane Doe* left today on a trip to Asia. But: *John Doe*, the *vice chairman* of the committee, resigned.

vicinity...

(U) Use *near* rather than *in the vicinity of*. Restrict its use to locations, rather than to degree or amount.

VICTOR...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "v."

virgule...

(U) Printer's term for slash or slant. See the entry for *sign*, slash.

vis-a-vis...

U.S. GOVERNMENT

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(U) Always include the hyphens. It need not be italicized as a foreign word.

voice...

(U) See the entries for active voice and passive voice.

voluntarism, volunteerism...

(U) Voluntarism first appeared in print in 1838. It is the older term and has two senses: first, the principle of doing something by relying on voluntary action; second, a belief in the supremacy of the will. Today voluntarism is used mainly in its second sense.

(U) The first sense is more often conveyed by the term volunteerism, which has been traced back to 1844. It is now standard in most new dictionary editions.



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Content Steward Reporting Board: S12AB, 963-5615
Page Publisher Reporting Board: S12AB, 963-5615



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Last Modified: April 3, 2007
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2011

Generated by: ASIA (S12AB, 963-5615) on: 10/10/2010 10:10:10 AM

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W

-ward, -wards...

(U) In American English, use the suffix form -ward for adjectives and adverbs: a backward glance; move forward.

(U) British English omits the "s" for the adjective and includes the "s" for the adverb.

(U) There is no need to use the construction "to the" before the adverb. POOR: Columbus sailed to the westward. BETTER: Columbus sailed westward.

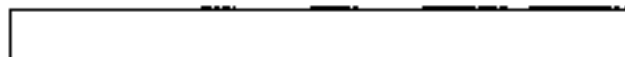
warn...

(U) The use of warn as an intransitive verb is common and acceptable in American English, particularly if the warning is intended generally rather than to a specific individual or group: The President warned against an unrealistic view of the world.

warning statements...

(U) Warning statements precede the text of the report and provide specific cautions regarding the sensitivity and releasability of the information.

Warsaw Pact...



5/7/2010

(U) Now disbanded, avoid the term except in a historical context

way, ways...

(U) Both are standard in American English. Ways as a synonym for way has been traced back to 1588. Although it occurs regularly in speech and writing, most commentators look on ways as more colloquial than way.

weapon system designators...

(U) See the entry for ASCC designator

weather activity or conditions...

U.S. GPO: 1964 O-511-16

(U) The word weather usually will suffice without any qualifying words, such as condition or activity.

(U) See the entry for bad weather

Webster's...

(U) Originally used to identify dictionaries based on Noah Webster's American Dictionary of the English Language, it is now a generic term for American dictionaries and related works.

(U) For serialized reports, the authority for spelling ordinary words is Merriam-Webster's Collegiate Dictionary, 10th edition, or for older or less common words Webster's Third New International Dictionary, published in 1961. Both are products of Merriam-Webster of Springfield, Massachusetts. When variant spellings are listed, use the first one given.

(U) Other dictionaries using the generic "Webster's," such as Webster's New World Dictionary, are not considered authoritative for serialized reports.

well...

U.S. GPO: 1964 O-511-16

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(U) "Well" is both an adjective and an adverb. Use it freely after a linking verb. The idiom "feel well" always refers to physical health.

(U) "Well" at the beginning of a sentence (Well, I don't think so) considered informal and more characteristic of speech than of writing. Do not use in SIGINT reporting.

when...

(U) Avoid using the phrase *is when* (or *is where*) if you are giving a definition. Such use was common among grammarians in the 18th and 19th centuries, but has fallen out of use today. The phrase is acceptable in other contexts. AVOID: A "fudge factor" is *when you leave some room for error*. ACCEPTABLE: That is *when* Brutus kills himself.

where...

(U) *Where* often follows *see*, *forget*, *tell*, *hear*, *find*, *read*, and *remember* in informal speech and writing. The phrases are not part of formal writing. Avoid them in serialized reports.

wherever...

(U) One word, no double *s*.

whether...

(U) Used to introduce a noun clause; generally used in more formal contexts than "if," especially when alternatives exist that are expressed using the infinitive: Carol could not decide *whether* to join Longine for dinner or return home.

(U) See the entry for *if*.

whether or not...

(U) When a clause beginning with *whether* serves as the subject of the sentence or as the object of a verb or preposition, the "or not" may be omitted: *Whether to accept the nomination was not an issue*. Beatrice did not know *whether* to accept Lucien's proposal.

(U) Retain the "or not" when the clause functions as an adverb: *Whether he won the prize or not*, Roger always gave his best effort.

U.S. POLICE

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which...

(U) In modern English, which may be used to introduce both restrictive and non-restrictive clauses. It is the only acceptable choice for non-restrictive clauses. Use which to refer to things.

(U) See the entries for nonrestrictive elements, restrictive elements, and that.

while...

(U) The use of *while* in *senses* unrelated to time has been established since the time of Shakespeare: *While* Alice may have little money, she is very happy. It is rarely ambiguous.

WHISKEY...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "w."

who, whom...

(U) Use **who** and **whom**, and the less common pronouns **whoever** and **whomever**, to refer to either humans or animals.

(U) Who is correct when the pronoun is the subject of a sentence or clause:

- Who is responsible for the error?
- The man who wanted to buy the house is here. (Who is the subject of "wanted.")
- The Prime Minister, who Patricia said would arrive tomorrow, will meet with the President Thursday. (Who is the subject of "would arrive.")

(U) When the pronoun is the object of a verb or preposition, use whom:

- To whom should I mail this?
- The man whom we had met left Metropolis yesterday. (Whom is the object of "had met.")

(U) When *who* or *whom* introduces a parenthetical clause within a sentence, set the clause within a pair of commas.

who's...

(U) Avoid the contraction for "who is" in serialized reports.

whose...

(U) Whose is a possessive form and refers to ~~either~~ persons or things. It has been traced back to the 14th century.

(U) Among the writers who have used whose for things are Wycliff, Shakespeare, Milton, Pope, Lewis, and Updike. The theory that whose applies only to persons is a superstition.

will...

(U) Use will to describe the simple future in all persons: I will go tomorrow. Also use will in questions that ask for a prediction: Will Bob win the lottery?

(U) See the entries for ~~shall~~, should, and would.

WNINTEL...

(U) This abbreviated form is no longer a valid security control marking. Do not use it or its expansion, Warning Notice, Intelligence Sources or Methods Involved.

words...

(U) Words have no meanings in themselves; they have meanings in relation to people and in particular contexts. The word "dog" conjures up many different images to people, depending on whether you have one as a pet or know of a particular breed.

(U) Choose words with care. More often than not, use short words rather than long ones. They are easier to read, but don't blindly pick the "common" word or the shortest word. Pick the right word to convey the meaning. Be specific.

wordiness...

(U) Wordiness is common in SIG*INT because of:

- the problems in putting translations into succinct, idiomatic English

Do not use this word.

- the hedging and qualifying around the SIGINT facts
- the need to provide subordinations and simplifying data, such as coordinates
- the excessive use of passive voice in SIGINT reporting

(U) In general, omit "unnecessary" words. The problem, of course, is determining which words are "unnecessary." Delete words when doing so improves and clarifies the sentence. When longer words or phrases suit the rhythm of a sentence better than short ones, feel free to use the longer word or phrase.

(U) Modern grammar and journalism put a premium on brevity, sometimes at the expense of clarity, style, and rhythm. But remember, briefer is not always better or clearer.

(U) Don't get caught in the trap of counting letters, syllables, or words, even though conciseness must be one of your goals. Write in the best way to convey information clearly to the reader. The two goals may coincide, and most often do, but the second goal is more important.

word order...

(U) Normal word order in an English sentence is subject, verb, object. Generally, words that appear outside normal order receive greater emphasis.

(U) As a rule, place modifiers near the words they modify. In English this is most often before the modified word, as with adjectives. Take care that any modifiers separated from the word they modify are not misleading. MURKY: Last year the firm was able to obtain discounts on the products it buys with little opposition. IMPROVED: Last year the firm was able to obtain, with little opposition, discounts on the products it buys.

work havoc, wreak havoc...

(U) Wreak havoc is the more common idiom, but work havoc (generally in the form wrought havoc) also is standard.

worthwhile...

(U) Worthwhile originated as a two-word phrase. It began to be used as a hyphenated, attributive adjective early in the 20th century, but the solid form is now the choice in all contexts.

U//FOUO

(L) Use *worthwhile* when you need a very general word of approval, but a more specific adjective is a better choice most of the time.

would

(U) Use would with pronouns of all persons to express habitual action: In the summer we would spend hours by the seashore. Also use would to form the conditional past tense or to express a wish. If I had not left the stadium early, I would have been caught in traffic. Helen wishes her parents would understand her dilemma.

NOTE: (U) Do not use *would* in an "if" clause at the beginning of a sentence. WRONG: If he would have gone, he would have succeeded. RIGHT: If he had gone, he would have succeeded.

(U) See the entries for shall, should, and will.



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Content Grievance Reporting Board: 512RG-963-5545
 Page Publisher: Reporting Board: 512RB-963-5645



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Last Modified: June 9, 2006
Last Content-Side Review: January 4, 2011

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APPENDIX 11

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X

X-ray..

(U) Divided usage. GPO uses x-ray; Merriam-Webster capitalizes the noun but not the verb. The American Heritage Dictionary prefers lower case, but notes both.

(U) For standardization, use X-ray for the noun and x-ray for the verb.

XRAY ..

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "x."



Content Steward: Reporting Board, S12RB. 963-5645
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12RB. 963-5645



Last Modified: June 26, 200
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2010

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For the Attention of all who report on events

go reporting

(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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Y

YANKEE...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "y."

yard...

(U) Convert this unit of length to meters in serialized reports. To convert to meters, multiply the number of yards by .91.

year...

(U) In the narrative of a serialized report, express the year in four digits only: 1991, not 91 or '91. Two-digit forms are acceptable when expressing the year only in:

- referencing DTGs in the prosign lines of FOLLOW-UP reports, corrections, and cancellations
- referencing in a footnote the DTG of a cross-reference
- listings

(U) When giving a range or series of dates within a single year, place the year after the last element only: from 28 May to 16 July

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1990, on 28 May, 5 June, 11 June, and 26 June 1991.

(U) Always include the year when it is not the current year: from 16 December 1992 to 8 January 1993.

(U) See the entries for date and decade.

yet...

(U) May be used as a conjunction meaning "nevertheless": The play was not the best I have seen, yet I enjoyed the music.

Yugoslav...

(U) Not Yugoslavian: The language spoken by the majority of "Yugoslavs" is Serbo-Croatian. Yugoslav is now most appropriate in a historical sense due to the secessions of Slovenia, Croatia, Macedonia, and Bosnia and Herzegovina from the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia, which is now dissolved.

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Content Steward: Reporting Board, S124B, 963-5645
 Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S120B, 963-5645

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List Modified: April 3, 2000
 List Created Site Director: January 4, 2000

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Z

Z...

(U) Append the letter "Z" (always capitalized) to all ZULU time entries in a serialized report unless you are using the phrase ALL TIMES ZULU at the beginning of the report

(U) See the entry for time.

zeal...

(U) You can have zeal "for doing" something or zeal "to do" something.

zenith...

(U) Refers to the highest point. Its antonym is nadir.

zero...

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(U) The plural form is zeros.

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zloly...

[U] The Polish national currency is spelled the same whether it is singular or plural.

ZULU...

(U) Phonetic spelling of the letter "z"

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Appendix 1

Abbreviations and Acronyms

(U) An abbreviation is a shortened form of a word or phrase used in place of the whole.

(U) An acronym is a **new word** formed from the initial letter or letters of each of the successive parts or major parts of a compound term, e.g. radar (from RAdio Detection And Ranging).

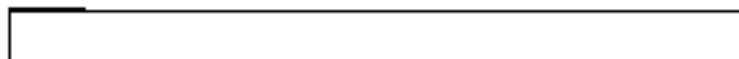
(U) Use an abbreviation or acronym:

- to shorten a report without losing clarity
- to avoid distracting the reader by needless spelling of repetitious words or phrases
- to keep the meaning from being lost in long technical or organizational terminology.

(U) Unless the abbreviation or acronym is readily recognized by the **average** reader (not just the usual recipients of the report), spell out the term in the title and the first time it is used in the body. How does one know when an abbreviation or acronym is commonly recognized? While there is no hard-and-fast rule, the following principles apply:

- a. The abbreviation or acronym must have one primary meaning. This does not mean that an abbreviation may not

have more than one meaning.



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stand for more than one thing; only that one meaning comes to mind for most people.

- An abbreviation that meets the test is CPA, which most people understand to mean Certified Public Accountant, although it can also stand for critical-path analysis.
- An abbreviation that fails the test is CAP, which can be interpreted as Civil Air Patrol, Combat Air Patrol, or Common Agricultural Policy.

b. The term must be known and understood by the average reader. Even if a term is recognizable in context, do not use it if the average reader is not likely to understand it. Spell out (the first time it is used) any term that cannot be understood. Thus, ASAP is acceptable and CAGS is not, as in the following examples:

- Deliver the package ASAP.
- The aircraft flew at a computed average ground speed (CAGS) of 785 kph.

(U) Commonly recognized abbreviations and acronyms may be used in lists. When in doubt, use the full spelling of the term.

(U) Ten Rules for Abbreviations and Acronyms

1. (U) Use an abbreviation or acronym when it is better known than the expansion:

laser, radar, sonar, USSR, VASCAR

2. (U) Use abbreviations for common weights and measures only with figures: (NOTE: The abbreviations of units of measure are identical in the singular and plural. Do not add an "s" to the abbreviation.)

- 1 kg, 12 oz, 8 km, 500 bbl, 6 gal
- Measure the distance in kilometers.
- I need a gallon of milk, please.

(U) Spell out uncommon measurements, such as hectare and pascal. The measurement decibel often is abbreviated as "dB" in technical reports. Be sure your readers will recognize it. If in doubt, spell it out.

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(U) The International System of Units (SI) used by scientists around the world is roughly equivalent to what is popularly called the metric system. All SI units are written in lowercase style when spelled in full. Abbreviations within this system are lowercase except for those derived from proper names. (The exception to this rule is the abbreviation for liter (L), which is always capitalized.) Thus, the abbreviations for hertz and pascal are capitalized and those for meter and candela are not.

Hz (hertz), Pa (pascal), m (meter), cd (candela)

NOTE: Always capitalize the following SI prefix abbreviations:

mega (M), giga (G), tera (T), peta (P), and exa (E)

(U) Omit internal and terminal punctuation in units of measure in accordance with the practice adopted by national and international technical groups. (e.g. Btu, GHz)

3. (U) Spell out the names of countries, except for the USSR, U.S., PRC, and UK. Use the abbreviations as either nouns or modifiers (e.g., Yeltsin to Visit UK; U.S. administration, PRC delegation). Do not abbreviate placename prefixes except those beginning with "Saint" (St./Sto.).

4. (U) Abbreviate civil, religious, and military titles only when the full name is used. (Gen. Ulysses S. Grant, but General Grant) If the title itself is modified, spell out the title (e.g., Very Reverend Elmer Gantry)

5. (U) Use abbreviations of Latin origin (such as e.g. and i.e.) only in parenthetical references and footnotes. The abbreviation etc. (et cetera) is acceptable in text.

6. (U) Insert a space after the period in the initials of a personal name: U. S. Grant, G. Washington. In other abbreviations with internal periods, do not include a space after the period: N.Y., a.m., U.S.

7. (U) Do not expand designators of aircraft and other equipment (especially military equipment), even though they may contain an acronym or abbreviation of a personal or corporate name.

examples: MIG-21, ZSU-23, DC-10, UNIVAC, SA-8, IBM PC

8. (U) Use periods when an abbreviation or acronym might cause confusion for the reader. With the shift in serialized reports to uppercase and lowercase letters, very few abbreviations will cause confusion. Thus, most abbreviations will not require periods.

9. (U) In serialized reports, follow the guidance in the GPO Style Manual for the proper form of standard abbreviations and acronyms not listed below. If the abbreviation or acronym is not listed in GPO, consult the Merriam-Webster dictionary. If neither

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of these sources provides a standard form and the Office of Primary Concern has not created one, follow the rules in the GPO Style Manual on creating abbreviations and acronyms. When a coined word or symbol is formed from only the first letter of each word, use uppercase letters (e.g. MIRV); when proper names are used in shortened form and more than the first letter of each word is used, use uppercase and lowercase (e.g. Conrail, Aramco).

10. (U) Use the indefinite article "a" before abbreviations and acronyms that when spoken begin with a consonant sound or an aspirated "h":

examples: a NATO exercise, a JCS memo, a Conrail ad

(U) Use the indefinite article "an" before abbreviations and acronyms that when spoken begin with a vowel sound or a silent "h":

examples: an AWACS flight, an ETA of 0800Z, an HF signal

(U) Commonly-Recognized Abbreviations & Acronyms

| Preferred Form | Expansion |
|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| AAA | antiaircraft artillery |
| ABM | antiballistic missile |
| Adm. | Admiral |
| ADP | automated data processing |
| AIDS | Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome |
| a.k.a. | also known as |
| AM | amplitude modulation |
| ASW | antisubmarine warfare |
| AWACS | Airborne Warning and Control System |
| AWOL | absent without official leave |
| bbl | barrel |

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| | |
|------------|------------------------------|
| Brig. Gen. | Brigadier General |
| Btu | British Thermal Unit |
| Capt. | Captain |
| CEO | Chief Executive Officer |
| CIA | Central Intelligence Agency |
| Co | company |
| c.o.d. | cash on delivery |
| Col | Colonel |
| Comdr | Commander |
| COMSAT | communications satellite |
| Corp. | corporation |
| Cpl. | Corporal |
| dB | decibel |
| Dept | department |
| doz | dozen |
| e.g. | for example (exempli gratia) |
| e-mail | electronic mail |
| Ens. | Ensign |
| ETA | estimated time of arrival |
| ETD | estimated time of departure |
| etc. | and so on (et cetera) |
| EU | European Union |
| FAV | |

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| | |
|----------|---|
| | facsimile |
| FMT | frequency modulation |
| f.o.b. | free on board |
| FROG | free rocket over ground |
| ft | foot or feet |
| FTP | File transfer Protocol |
| FY | fiscal year |
| gal | gallon |
| Gen. | General |
| GDP | gross domestic product |
| GNP | gross national product |
| HF | high frequency |
| HQ | headquarters |
| Hz | hertz |
| ICBM | intercontinental ballistic missile |
| i.e. | that is (used) |
| IED | improvised explosive device |
| IFF | identification friend or foe |
| Inc. | incorporated |
| INTELSAT | International Telecommunications Satellite Organization |
| INTERPOL | International Police |
| IP | Internet Protocol |
| inc | |

| | |
|---------|---|
| | Joint Chiefs of Staff |
| kg | kilogram |
| kHz | kilohertz |
| KIA | killed in action |
| km | kilometer |
| kph | kilometers per hour |
| KST | known or suspected terrorist |
| laser | light amplitude stimulated by the emission of radiation |
| Lt | Lieutenant |
| Ltd | limited |
| m | meter |
| Maj. | Major |
| MEDEVAC | medical evacuation |
| MHz | megahertz |
| MIA | missing in action |
| mm | millimeter |
| mph | miles per hour |
| NATO | North Atlantic Treaty Organization |
| NCO | non-commissioned officer |
| nm | nautical miles |
| OAS | Organization of American States |
| OPEC | Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries |
| or | |

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| | |
|--------|---|
| | ounce |
| PLO | Palestine Liberation Organization |
| POW | prisoner of war |
| PRC | People's Republic of China |
| Pvt. | Private |
| radar | radio detection and ranging |
| rpm | revolutions per minute |
| SALT | Strategic Arms Limitation Talks |
| SDI | Strategic Defense Initiative |
| Sgt. | Sergeant |
| sonar | sound navigation ranging |
| TCP/IP | Transmission Control Protocol/Internet Protocol |
| TNT | trinitrotoluene (dynamite) |
| TV | television |
| UAE | United Arab Emirates |
| UDP | User Datagram Protocol |
| UFO | unidentified flying object |
| UHF | ultra-high frequency |
| UK | United Kingdom |
| UN | United Nations |
| URL | Universal Resource Locator |
| U.S. | United States |
| vac | |

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|------|------------------------------|
| | very high frequency |
| VoIP | Voice over Internet Protocol |
| VIP | very important person |
| VP | vice president |
| VPN | virtual private network |
| VSAT | very small aperture terminal |
| WHO | World Health Organization |
| Z | ZULU time zone |

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Page Publisher: Reporting Board, S12RB, 963-5645

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Last Modified: Apr 13, 2010
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† χ^2 = 0.000000, χ^2 per d.o.f. = 0.000000, χ^2 test = 0.000000, χ^2 test = 0.000000

1194

“go reporting”

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$$x_1 = 1, x_2 = 0, x_3 = 0$$

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Content Steward: Reporting Board, 512RB, 953-5845
Page Publisher: Reporting Board, 512PB, 953-5845

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(U) SIGINT Reporter's Style & Usage Manual

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Historical Information

(U//FOUO) Some of the manual's more discursive descriptivist entries, which may interest readers from a theoretical or historical standpoint, have been moved to this section of the manual.

dictionary..

(U) See complete historical entry for dictionary

parameter...

(U) Parameter originally was a specific term used in mathematics to describe a characteristic element. It moved into general use in the mid-20th century, generally in the plural form, expressing the sense of 'limits' or 'boundaries': All of the options presented are within the design parameters.

(U) Possible substitutes, if you don't like the word parameter, are range, factor, and criterion

spelling...

(U) In *Van Winkle's Return*, Kenneth Wilson observes that "spelling is mostly a neuromuscular skill in the development of which practice helps, but for which certain innate equipment is the main requirement." His point is that the aptitude for spelling is like that for any skill—practice will help anyone improve, but some people will always do better than others. That's why spelling bees

Printed on 5/7/2010

5/7/2010

always end up with a winner.

(U) "Correct" spelling is a product of the era of printing and dictionaries. It developed, as the Oxford Companion to the English Language notes, "by a social consensus and not through the recommendation of an Academy or other institution." It was not until the time of Shakespeare that anyone even thought about creating standard spelling rules. Printers in the 17th century began the trend toward consistency when varied spacing material made the need for justification less of a factor in the spelling of a word. The arrival of large dictionaries in the 18th century, according to Merriam-Webster, increased the trend toward uniformity.

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Page Publisher: Reporting Board, 512RB, 963 5645

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Last Modified: June 12, 2009
Last Overall Site Review: January 4, 2013

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5/7/2010